国家出版基金项目
NATIONAL PUBLICATION FOUNDATION

THE KIRGIZ'S HEROIC EPIC OF CHINA

ماناس

MANAS

BOOK TWO

SEMTAY

Volume One

Singing: Jusurp Mamay

Editing: Chinese Translation Committee of *Manas*

Translating: Hongyan Li, Gary, Gregory·B·Meeks

XINJIANG PEOPLE'S PUBLISHING GROUP

XINJIANG PEOPLE'S PUBLISHING HOUSE

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Semtay

Book Three

Seytek

Book Four

Kenainym

Book Five

Saiyit

Book Six

Aslebacha and Bekbacha

Book Seven

Sombilek

Book Eight

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Statistics of Cataloging in Publication(CIP)

The Kirgiz's Heroic Epic of China. Manas. Book Two, Semtay, Volume One to Three, English /Publishing, Jusurp Mamay Singing. Chinese Translation Committee of *Manas* edited. Hongyan Li, Gary, Gregory·B·Meeks Translated —Urumqi: Xinjiang People's Publishing House, 2019.12

ISBN 978-7-228-18710-2

Ⅰ. ①Chi... Ⅱ. ① Ma... ②Li... ③Ga... ④Gr... Ⅲ. ①Kirgiz-Epic-China-English Ⅳ. ①I222.7

Archives Library of China Cataloging-In-Publication Data 007946(2020)

Copyright@2004 Kirgiz Edition Manas of Xinjiang People's Publishing House sung by Jusurp Mamay

Publishing Planning: Hui Lin Qijuan Sun
Executive Editor: Qijuan Sun Jin Liu
Designer: Kanhai Liu
Cover Illustrating: Zhenming Kuai

The Kirgiz's Heroic Epic of China Manas

(Book Two Semtay Volume One to Three)

Singing Jusurp Mamay
Editing Chinese Translation Committee of *Manas*
Translating Hongyan Li, Gary, Gregory·B·Meeks

Published Xinjiang People's Publishing Group, Xinjiang People's Publishing House
Issued Xinjiang People's Publishing House
Address No.348 Jiefang South Road Urumqi
Zip Code 830001
Tel (0991)2837939
Platemaking Xingjiayi Graphic Design Co. Ltd Urumqi
Printed Beijing Fucheng Color Printing Co. Ltd
Format 787 x 1092 1/16
Sheet 77.5
Edition No. First Edition in September 2020
Print No. First print in September 2020
Price 225.00RMB

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Jusurp Mamay

(1918—2014)

Jusurp Mamay, Kirgiz, born in Aheqi County of Xinjiang China, was the honorary Chairman and the researcher of Literary Federation of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region, and the member of the Standing Committee of the Chinese People's Political Consultative Conference of Xinjiang. He was a famous singer of *Manas*, the inheritor of national intangible cultural heritage of China and referred to as the "Modern Homer" in the epic field at home and abroad. Chinese state leaders describe him as the "National Treasure"of China, who was once the only inheritor, singer and researcher in the world who can sing eight books, i.e. more than 235 thousand lines of heroic epic *Manas*. He had contributed so much for inheriting, protecting, and developing the epic *Manas*, thus he garnered many honors and praise from the Chinese central government and Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region government. He was invited to visit Kyrgyzstan on three occasions, and was granted the gold medal and the title of "Kyrgyzstan People's Actor".

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Preface

Manas is a heroic epic of Kirgiz folk literature. It is widely circulated among and treasured by Kirgiz people and has been handed down from generation to generation. It is not only one of the three great epics in China, but also a bright gem in the world literature and art.

Manas is the general name of the whole set of the epic, as well as the name of the first epic and the name of the hero. This epic, which originated from ancient tribal battle time, is a masterwork of folk art in the hero-worshiped period. Handed down orally for thousand years, like a running river, this epic is the spiritual pillar and cultural symbol of Kirgiz people and integratedly embodies their knowledge of society, nature, and life. The abundant stories in the epic modeled the ethnic spirit and soul of Kirgiz, and showed an epic spirit of patriotism, bravery, wisdom, unity, and inclusiveness.

The epic is voluminous and rich in content, telling the stories over a long period with many different versions. Only the version from Jusurp Mamay contains 235 thousand lines. The epic presents a moving stories of Manas and his following seven generations, highly eulogizes their extremely hard and bitter battles on defending their people and homeland, and their struggling and heroic spirit in fighting against external invaders, striving for freedom of the Kirgiz people, and for pursuit of their happy lives, and building their beautiful homeland.

The structure of the epic is that of typical ancestry hero saga. From the hero Manas to his later generations, the romantic but moving and tragic feat can be seen in the whole epic. The epic is a masterwork of folk literature

with magnificent and exciting contents, like a dazzling star that has a profound artistic influences. The epic brings the reader into the ancient Kirgiz life with its poetic language and impressive stories. The characters appearing in the stories are of rich varieties, such as wise Khans, brave and wise generals, grand old ministers, eloquent emissaries, heroines, wizards, workers, traitors, and villains. No matter whether they are the heroes or the villains, they are all portrayed vividly and magically with lively characteristics. The hero Manas is brave, valiant, and without a rival in power, like a brave tiger or lion in the battles, as strong as a dragon and as agile as an eagle. When he goes to battle, he is accompanied by fierce tigers in his front, cheetahs behind him, and with great dragons flying over guarding him. He wears the iron helmet and battle gown, with the battle-axe on his shoulder, the long spear in his hand, and the sword on his waist. He fights in the battlefield elegantly. Through the characterization of the epic heroes headed by Manas, the epic presents a folk picture of the ancient Kirgiz life, covering the scenes of weddings, recreation, and various ceremonies.

The epic is a treasure trove of the art of language. Varieties of rhetoric devices, such as comparisons, exaggerations and personifications, are commonplaces in this epic. The brave heroes are symbolized with the images of tiger, black mane wolf, and male camel. The epic lines follow strict poetic rhythm, and as a result, it has a strong sense of tempo. Rhymes are almost in every line, and many of the lines are based on both alliteration and end rhymes, which makes the epic lines catchy when a Manasqi sings them sounding pleasant and beautiful. Each volume of the epic is independent of one another and at the same time the volumes connect closely with one another. This makes the epic a integrated work which are structurally cohesive and integrative in creating its characters, designing its plots and narration of the stories. The epic manifests

the Kirgiz peoples' brilliant art skills and It also fully shows their unique literature expressive capacity and their aesthetic tastes through the depicting images of the characters and animals and the plot narration. *Manas* is a classical work of infinite vitality, and it is a great peak of Kirgiz literature as well as a classic that is handed down for thousand years. It is deeply rooted in the rich Chinese civilization from the beginning and is a great achievement of Chinese culture through communication and exchanges.

Since the founding of the People's Republic of China, especially since the Reform and Opening up in 1978, Kirgiz hero epic *Manas* has been listed as one of the three great national epics of the country with the high value and support of the Communist Party of China and the central government of China, and it was successively listed in China's National and World Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity. Since the Eighteenth National Congress, the CPC Central Committee with General Secretary Xi Jinping at its core accords great importance to the heritage and development of epic *Manas*. On the Central Ethnic Work Conference, Forum of Art and Literature, the Thirteenth National People's Congress and on the signed article published before he visited Kyrgyzstan, Xi Jinping highly emphasized the epic's historical status and the value of its heritage and development. He said *Manas* is a great heart-shaking epic. It does not only provide rich nourishment for the Chinese Nation, but also contributes a splendid chapter to the world civilization. In 2006, the State Council approved epic *Manas* to be listed in the first National Intangible Cultural Heritages. In 2009, it was listed in the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity of UNESCO. In 2015, the State Administration of Press, Publication, Radio, Film and Television (SARFT) recommended epic *Manas* as one of the popularizing books of the excellent traditional Chinese culture. In 2018, the Publicity Department of the CPC and China Federation of

Literary and Art Circles (CFLAC) listed *Manas* as one of the selected books in National Library and Xinjiang Volume of the Epics of Chinese Folk Literature. The cultural authorities of the country offer special funds for supporting the protection and continuity of *Manas*, especially for the translation and publication of this epic. In 2013, under the aid of the National Publication Fund, Xinjiang People's Publishing House published *Manas Book One* (Volume One to Volume Four) in Chinese, Kirgiz, and English. The Chinese and English versions of *Manas Book Two Semtay*, *Book Three Seytek*, and *Book Four Kenainym* were selected in the list of National Publication Fund in 2017.

The CPC Committee and the people's government of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region have always valued the investigating, recording, collating, translating, and publishing of *Manas*. The leaders of the Committee and government and the leaders of various departments in charge of culture affairs of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region have made instructions on how to put more efforts in the protection and continuity of *Manas*. The Region's Cultural Department has given strong backing on protection plans, applying for projects from the country's authorities concerned and it has also provided special funds for the work.

Since Kizilsu Kirgiz Autonomous Prefecture (K Prefecture for short) was founded, its CPC Committee and government have paid special importance to the protection, continuity and development of excellent Kirgiz traditional culture, the protection of the cultural heritages in particular. As the inheritance place of epic *Manas* and the applicant place for World Intangible Cultural Heritage Program, K Prefecture has made great contributions in filing, preserving, inheriting, publicizing, publishing, researching, and developing *Manas*.

Since the founding of the People's Republic of China, the national government and Xinjiang government have made many instructions to the related departments

for collecting, surveying, recording, collating, translating, and publishing epic *Manas*. From 1955 to 1957, CASS Research Center for Ethnic Minority Languages, Central College for Nationalities in Beijing, and the region's Commission for Language Reform co-organized a Xinjiang ethnic minority language surveying team. The team did investigations of Kirgiz language in the areas where Kirgiz people lived and recorded many lines of epic *Manas* but treated them as the dialect data. It was the first time that the written form of *Manas* entered the National Archives of China. In the autumn of 1960, Fajun Liu, Jiaqi Liu and others from Xinjiang Writers Association heard folk artists sing *Manas* when they were soliciting contributions in Kizilsu Prefecture. At that time, the teachers and students from Central College for Nationalities, who were teaching and majoring in Kirgiz language, were doing their language practice there. Under Professor Zhenhua Hu, the teachers and students together recorded some lines of *Semtay and Ayichulek* from Timur, a famous Manasqi in Wuqia county. And what they collected were one part of *Semtay* of *Manas*. Later, they translated the lines into Chinese and Uygur language, and the translated versions were published in literature magazines *Tianshan* (in Chinese) and *Tarim* (in Uygur language) respectively.

In May 1964, the *Manas* Research Group was founded under the direction of Folk Literature Research Association of China, Literary Federation of Xinjiang Autonomous Region, and CPC Committee of Kizilsu Kirgiz Autonomous Prefecture. it was headed by Yang Tao, a researcher of Folk Literature Research Association of China, and Fajun Liu, a researcher of Literary Federation of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region, and they led the group to carry out interviews in the areas of Kizilsu Kirgiz Autonomous Prefecture, recording the lines of epic *Manas*. In 1978, a project leading group was established again by the above three units, and it began to record and translate the lines

of the epic in Beijing. Zhenhua Hu, a professor from Minzu University of China, and Fajun Liu from Literary Federation of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region, were the directors of this group. In June of 1982, Xinjiang *Manas* Project Leading Group was established and the main leaders of the Standing Committee of People's Congress of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region, Literary Federation of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region, and Kizilsu Kirgiz Autonomous Prefecture were the group leader and vice leaders. In November of 1989, approved by the CPC Committee of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region, certain personal adjustments of the Group was made.

The collecting and research of the epic went through a difficult process. From 1960, with the great support from the departments at all levels, under the guiding principle of *overall collecting, key sorting, all-out popularizing, research strengthening, and faithful recording*, the researchers started general surveys. As long as there was a singer, and even he could only sing one or two sections, the researchers recorded them carefully. The researchers were divided into three groups. They went to villages and herding sites by camels and yaks, crossing mountains and rivers to look for local epic singers (Manasqi). In three months, they visited many remote villages and lots of places where Kirgiz people lived in Xinjiang. As a result, they collected more than 200 thousand lines of the epic and some other folk literature works. In their surveys in the villages, they found Jusurp Mamay, a great master of *Manas*. Later, It took Jusurp Mamay eight months to sing the first five volumes of the epic–*Manas*, *Semtay*, *Seytek*, *Kenainym*, and *Saiyit* and what he sang was totaling more than 110 thousand lines, and the researchers recorded them carefully.

From August 1964 to October 1966, the Xinjiang *Manas* Project Leading Group spent more than two years in making surveys of what might not be collected in their previous work in the four counties of Kizilsu Kirgiz

Autonomous Prefecture. This time, they recorded *Koktoy's Fiesta*, *Sent Letters to Seven Khans*, *Expedition*, and other chapters of *Manas*, which contained 124 thousand lines. They also collected 21 manuscript books of *Manas* with about 90 thousand lines. Jusurp Mamay supplemented the content of *Manas Book One* from 38 thousand lines to 59 thousand lines; *Book Two Semtay* from 27 thousand lines to 32 thousand lines; *Book Three Seytek* from 18 thousand lines to 24 thousand lines; *Book Four Kenainym* from 16 thousand lines to 34 thousand lines; *Book Five Saiyit* from 28 hundred lines to 10 thousand lines and then later to 24 thousand lines. During that time, he also sang *Book Six Aslebacha and Bekbacha* which is 45 thousand lines long. It is quite a misfortune that the recording transcripts and the translation copies that dozens of people had worked hard on for more than two years were lost.

In 1978, Jusurp Mamay re-sang the first six books in Beijing, besides, he also sang *Book Seven Sombilek* and *Book Eight Chigetai* for the first time. All of which were carefully recorded.

After the researchers' and Manasqis' hard work for collection and research of epic *Manas* for several decades, the great epic began to take shape. Different versions of more than 80 Manasqi were collected, and the Kirgiz language version of Jusurp Mamay was published in 1995. In 2004, the revised edition was published, and what is more, the edition of the Slavic-letter transliterated version of the epic was published, which evoked a strong and positive responses in Kyrgyzstan, Russia, and other countries.

In order to draw more readers' attention on epic *Manas*, many folk writers and artists took great efforts to publicize it in newspapers, magazines, and books. With their efforts, many well-chosen passages were published. At the same time, Xinjiang People's Publishing House published the Chinese version of *Manas* (Volume One) ,

the translation work was organized by Fajun Liu. And it also published some other books of Chinese version that related with the epic, such as *Kirgiz Folk Literary Classics-Best Parts of Epic Manas*, which were selected and edited by the History and Annals Office of Kizilsu Kirgiz Autonomous Prefecture and Xinjiang Association of Folk Artist. However, due to certain reasons, the translation work of *Manas* from Kirgiz language to Chinese language was not processed systematically.

In 2004, with the advent of China's Cultural Heritage Protection Program, the translation of *Manas* from Kirgiz language to Chinese language embraced an unprecedented opportunity. Under the concern and support of the main leaders from the CPC Committee and the government of Kizilsu Kirgiz Autonomous Prefecture, Kizilsu Kirgiz Autonomous Prefecture and Xinjiang Literary Federation organized a *Manas* Chinese Translating Group, which was later renamed to *Manas* Chinese Translation Committee, and it was an efficient working group whose members came from Sereral ethnic groups.

At this time, the translation work from Kirgiz language to Chinese language began and it was coordinated, and directed by the Chinese government. The Autonomous Prefecture government and Xinjiang Folk Artists Association organized experts proficient in both Kirgiz language and Chinese language to do the work of translating, compiling checking and approving.

First, the Chinese edition of *Manas* was based on the *Manas* version sung by Jusurp Mamay that was republished by Xinjiang People's Publishing House in 2004.

There are three teams under the group: the translating, collating, and annotating team, the editing and compiling team as well as the checking and approving team. The three teams understood their responsibilities and the need for cooperating with each other to accurately translate, compare Kirgiz-Chinese versions, collate, review, validate,

and revise the transcripts. Some basic principles were set up special for the translation work.

Translation: The translation should be strictly in accordance with the characteristics of folk literature. They should stick to the translation principles of faithfulness, expressiveness, and elegance. The translation verses are corresponded up and down. It is coherent and complete in meaning from sentence to sentence, section to section, and paragraph to paragraph. The translation of each word and each sentence should be expressed accurately and appropriately.

Contrasting in both Chinese language and Kirgiz language: this aims to correct the mistakes, errors, and omissions in the translated versions. It also modifies the unclear translation and inaccurate wording. It specifies some unique folk adages and proverbs, describing the sentences with word meaning extension and reverse extension for the usage of adding references and annotations in editing.

Collation: Under the guideline of taking its essence and removing its dross in collating excellent traditional culture, words should be processed precisely on the basis of respecting the original epic. It should meet the code of language, reading habit and taste of Chinese readers, and keep the language features, artistic characteristics, and national traits of the original epic. The wording should be concise, accurate, affluent, vivid and with epic's lingering charm. It should keep the rhythm of Kirgiz folk epic, and not apply the rules and forms of Chinese poems mechanically.

Validation: It also can be called overall proofreading. It is the last process before the translation draft is submitted to the publishing house with the purpose of reviewing the first three rules, especially checking the translation quality, literary expression, and wording. The ethnic relations, region concepts, customs, and beliefs involved in the translation draft should realize the goal of respecting the history and

being in line with harmonious development.

Second, at the beginning of translating *Manas* to Chinese language, the leading group had already instructed the related experts that they should strictly follow the translating principles of "being faithful to the original version, preserving the style, and being common and smooth in its words". It is to achieve the goal of appealing to all by keeping the original flavor of the contents and the characteristic of folk artists' improvisational singing style, and taking into account the majority of Han Chinese readers' tastes. Moreover, *Manas* is a cultural treasure handed down for thousands of years. So the translation not only needs to represent the charm of the epic, but also need to handle appropriately the problems in transferring the vocal songs to written words.

The Character orders were clear in the original language of the recorded version, but some need to have a subject and some need to be marked off with punctuation in translating them into Chinese language. In the scenes of people's dialogues in the epic, some happened in the yurt and some happened out of yurt, so it should be expressed clearly in the words.

Transliteration and annotation are used in translating names of people, horses, places, plants, animals, and tribes. Free translation is used only in very few of them with the purpose of rhyming. The translated words of some places names are the same as that of some current places, but the positions of them are not necessarily the same as the current ones.

The epic does not have sections itself. Sometimes singers could sing dozens of lines in high spirits and rhyme all the way to the end. So the translated Chinese versions of the epic should be paragraphed according to the plot development and for the sake of readers' convenience without affecting the epic structure. According to the collating plan of Kirgiz language version, first level

headings were divided out under major events in each book. There were several second level headings under each first level headings, which made it clear and distinct for the readers.

Translating the epic into Chinese language is also a process of doing research of the epic. After careful studies, the time when *Manas* epic originated was clarified based on the epic contents and the historical records. Therefore, in the Chinese versions, the terms that frequently appeared in the epic and the experts and scholars showed great concern to were defined more accurately. For instance, *Karamak* is the name of a part of Mongolians, also translated as *Karmek*, *Karmark*, etc. It is not correct to simply be translated as Mongolia. In addition, the meaning of theword *Beygin* was debatable in *Manas*. It was translated as "北京" (Beijing) in some parts of the epic. It actually refers to the capital city of Khitan. And some scholars believe it was *Linhuang* (*Shangjing* is the name of the upper capital of Liao Dynasty). In the 2010 edition of *Cihai* (Mini-print) defined *Beijing* as *Shangjing Linhuang* which was renamed *Beijing* in the first year of Tianjuan of Jin Dynasty (Year 1138)and the name was revoked in the second year of Tiande (Year 1150). Its site is southeast to Boluo in Left Bailin Banner of Inner Mongolia. Some scholars believe *Beygin* in *Manas* refers to *Beiting* in history. *Beiting* is in today's Jimsar county of Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region. It was the office site of Beiting Administration Office of Tang Dynasty. Western Liao once built a new city here in Yemili to recruit troops, and later it built a capital in Husordo. Some people mistakenly take *Beygin* for today's Beijing (北京) which does not match what the word means in *Manas*. And today's Beijing was called *Yanjing* in Liao Dynasty. Therefore, in translating the epic into Chinese language, the transliterated word *Beygin* (别依京) was adopted, meanwhile *Shangjing* or *Kangayi* were used for certain sentences.

In order to be faithful to the original epic, translators of the first draft are all Kirgiz people who are proficient in Chinese. For this, about ten Kirgiz experts and scholars were invited to participate in all sections of Chinese translation, especially in the contrast phase between Kirgiz version and Chinese version. They compared Book One twice to make sure the translation to be more precise and accurate.

Under the substantial support of various circles of society and the unremitting endeavor of our epic researchers, the Chinese version will meet the readers in succession. It is still to be discussed whether some Chinese expressions and the understanding of some uncommon words and sentences in the epic are appropriate or not because of the different comprehensive levels of the translating and validating staff members.

Manas is a great cultural heritage created by the whole Kirgiz people. The surveying, recording, collating, translating, and publishing of *Manas* is also the fruit of many people who had been working together. At the time of publishing this book, we want to express our great homage to those who inherited and passed down *Manas* from generation to generation. We would like to show our sincere appreciations to the people participating in the surveying, recording, collating, translating, and publishing of the epic and to the Party leaders and experts who devoted their time to *Manas* for decades.

July 2020

Contents

Volume One

The Family Deserted and the Orphan Suffered Persecution

Kanikai Held a Memorial Ceremony for Her Late Husband in Sorrow, and Jagurp Forced Her to Remarry 003

Aweikai and Kobosh Bullied the Orphan, Killed the Newborn, Robbed and Forcibly Occupied the Property 014

Kanikai and Her Mother-in-law Took Semtay and Fled away 035

Young Semtay Returned His Hometown Talas for the First Time

Kanikai Recounted the Family History to Semtay in Pain 051

Semtay Bade Farewell to His Mother and Went on the Journey Back to the Hometown 070

Semtay Met Bakay 087

Grandfather Jagurp Poisoned Semtay 101

Semtay Contested with Aweikai and Kobosh for the First Time ... 113

Semtay Punished Treasons and Retook the Throne

Kanikai and Semtay Returned Hometown and Punished Treasons Severely and Retook the Throne 147

Semtay Punished Warriors Committed Treason 163

Love Imbroglio among Krichorao, Kanchorao and Ackoyun..... 185

Chinkogeo Intended to Force Ayichulek to Marry Him

Chinkogeo Encircled Akun Khan City with His Troops and Intended to Force Ayichulek to Marry Him 203
Ayichulek Asked Semtay for Help 215
Ayichulek Was Humiliated by Chachykai 249
Ayichulek Caught and Took Semtay's White Eagle 269

Semtay Married Ayichulek

Semtay Searched His White Eagle and Met Ayichulek 297
Ayichulek and Semtay Opened Their Hearts to Each Other 346
Semtay Married the Beauty Ayichulek 392

◎ Volume Two

Semtay Defeated Formidable Enemies Chinkogeo and Toltoy

Krichorao and Toltoy Confronted Each Other for the First Time..... 401
Old Courtier Baytikai Patiently Admonished Chinkogeo to Retreat 439
Chinkogeo Died in Bozwurchuk Battle 459
Three Heroes Fought in Jetsu and Krichorao Killed Toltoy 478
Semtay Returned to His Hometown with His Wife Ayichulek 510

Kunwuerbayi Attacked Kankoler

Toktosart Betrayed and Turned into a Spy 517
Kunwuerbayi Attacked Talas at Night and Semtay Was Encircled 538
Krichorao Sneaked into the Enemy Camp to Get Information at Night 562
The Two Choraos Fought Bravely and Kirgiz Gathered to Face Enemy 595

The Heroes Protected Talas

Two Armies Pitted against Each Other at Kankoler Plain 623
Young Baytaylak Began to Display His Talent 643
Krichorao Cut Kunwuerbayi Wound 653
Semtay Mounted the Horse and Went out to the Battle 675

Kunwuerbayi Fled and Karamark Rendered Tribute and Sued for Peace 689

Kairimubayi Conspired to Revolt in Collusion with Enemies

Kairimubayi Colluded with Karakuli 705

Kairimubayi Borrowed Troops from Jafan in the East to Help Him 713

Kairimubayi United Mardhan to Invade Talas 723

Semtay Went out Alone and Caused the Trouble

Semtay Slept in the Fields and His Horse Was Stolen 739

Karakuli Plotted a Failed Attempt to Kill Khan and He Died..... 748

Two Choraos Were Wrongly Accused and Swore and Bakay Could Not Explain in a Word 764

◎ Volume Three

Four Heroes Protected Talas

Kairimubayi Borrowed Troops and Invaded, Heroes Discussed to Fight against the Enemy 781

Semtay Defeated the Devil Kerzilwuyouk 838

Krichorao Had a Contest with Mardhan 856

Semtay Kept Thousands of Troops out Alone

Mardkuler Invaded Karmanapu 937

Semtay Stabbed One-eyed Mardkuler to Death 947

The Plot between Kunwuerbayi and Wusangan

Kunwuerbayi Played the Same Old Trick Again and Kissed Death 969

Wusangan Made a Sneak Attack of Talas, and Young Taylak Bay Died 994

Krichorao Fought against Wusangan 1022

Giobatay Invaded Talas

Jamgerchy Sacrificed His Family to Righteousness and Went to Die 1045

Krichorao Killed Giobatay Angrily 1067

Personal Animosity between Wumaitoy and Semtay

Wumaitoy Exhausted the Troops and Expected to Fight against Semtay 1089

Wumaitoy Armed Rebellion and Courted His Own Ruin 1105

Semtay Walked into a Trap and Lost His Beloved Steed Buruler 1121

Kanchorao Betrayed and Semtay Disappeared Mysteriously

The Plot between Kanchorao and Chachykai 1129

Kanchorao Colluded with Keyaz and Rose in Rebellion 1151

Kanchorao Cheated Semtay 1161

Kanchorao and Keyaz Rose in Rebellion and Khan Semtay Changed and Disappeared 1169

Krichorao Was Crippled and Hero Sari Khan Sacrificed Himself for Fighting against Enemy 1185

Postscript 1203

The Family Deserted and the Orphan Suffered Persecution

Kanikai Held a Memorial Ceremony for Her Late Husband in Sorrow, and Jagurp Forced Her to Remarry

Half is true, and half is false,
I did not see it with my own eyes.
Let me sing the story to my heart's content,
And to satisfy all your wishes.

Half is true, and half is false,
No one was there to be a witness.
Our singing from generation to generation,
Is for the expectations of our offspring.

For no one had witnessed,
It has no business with the truth or the falsity.
We complicated the story,
To mourn for the spirits of our ancestors.
I wish the spirits of our ancestors could help me,
Let me sing their stories sincere and interesting to listen.

Jagurp Khan's son warrior Manas,
Would never let his horses out in the mountains without worries.
When he was driven into a rage,
Once he smashed Beygin city to pieces.

Invaders trembled with fear on hearing of his name,
Robbers hid themselves to prevent fighting against him.

The lion Manas conquered the city Beygin,
Then he mounted the throne of ruling Karamark people.
Kunwuerbayi, Karamark people's Khan,
How he could bear such a humiliation.

He plotted secretly for the revenge,
And intended to kill the Lion Manas at the back.
In a pitch dark night,
He lifted the poisoned crescent axe and cut Manas secretly.

When the axe cut into the neck of Manas,
He opened his eyes and bright sparkles sprayed out of his eyes.
The renowned hero's life,
Since now turned into a tragedy.

The wound festered, the injury worsened,
The warriors around were all at their wits' end.
Manas, the hero of the age,
Suffered from this sudden and unexpected plot,
Finally died in the arms of his wife Kanikai.

When Manas was in his prime age,
He married extraordinarily smart Kanikai.
Kanikai discussed with Bakay and Koyonaler at this critical moment,
And announced Manas' death to the world,
Planned the great funeral for the lion Manas.

The whole Kirgiz turned out,
To welcome all the mourners.

Kanikai asked servants to boil the goat fat,
Stirred the boiled fat to fire the plaster,
Melted rare metallic minerals.
Countless gold, silver and jewelry were spent.
To build the majestic tomb.

The majestic tomb,
Dazzled all the visitors,
All the guests came to the funeral,
Praised and admired.
Kanikai spent another one thousand silver ingots,
Imitated Manas's white jade seal,

Engraved it on the wall of the hero's tomb.
It shone the white light in cold weather,
And became brightly black in hot weather.
The hero's Gonbaiz① cost so much money and was so mysterious,
It is the comfort the God gave to the hero.

In order to build the amazing tomb,
Kanikai racked her brain and mapped out a strategy.
To prevent enemies destroying the tomb,
They dug a small tomb in that big tomb,
And put the statue of Manas,
Deep in that small tomb.

Kanikai designed with her heart,
She needed to prevent enemies robbing the tomb,
And prevent them burning the hero's corpse.
She discussed with Bakay,
To invite Kezler Aristan to come,
He and Manas were friends that were ready to die for each other.
They concealed from all the Kirgiz people,
In the riverbed of rapid Karasu river,
They built another secret tomb.

They blocked the river water to one side,
Dug a deep vault in the riverbed,
Directed the river water out of the river course,
Then reinforced the inside walls of the tomb.
Fastened the steel net with iron piles,
Reinforced the inside walls with rocks,
And they prepared an air gap,
Dug the exit from a two-day-journey distance,
Then fastened the exit with the iron sticks.

What Kezler Aristan and Bakay Khan did,
Would bury the corpse of warrior Manas,

① Gonbaiz: It means tomb in Kirgiz.

Deep into the rapid river,
No one could ever expect to know.

Mourners from far away places thought:
"We need to go to the tomb of Manas,
To witness his body and worship."
Some mourners were waiting for their families to leave,
Then they would steal the hero's body out of the tomb.

Mourners with evil intentions,
Now kept watching on the tomb,
But when they dug the tomb up,
How could the body of Manas turn into a rock?
They felt so surprised and hopeless:
Konkoer① indeed did not die,
He surely pretended his death and let people attend his funeral,
He just wanted to deceive the bad guys with evil intentions.
What the real thoughts of Manas were,
No one could ever get to know.

The Khans from Karamark,
And two Khans from Khitan,
Immediately ran away.

Kanikai was deeply grieved at the moment,
In a flash,
The figure of Manas appeared in front of her eyes,
The moment when the hero died was still in her mind.

When Majestic Manas was going to close his eyes,
Dense smoke came out of his mouth,
Like the blazing flames,
Warriors around him burst into loud sobs immediately.

"Our captain, our dear companion,

① Kangkoer: It is the nickname Kanikai gave to her husband Manas.

You just departed this life suddenly.
I never regretted even for a second to marry you,
The longing for you fulfilled full in my heart."

Kanikai stood aside and told her sorrows in tears,
She put the holy and pure white silk,
On the face,
Of the beloved hero.

Ten fat mares of empty embryo① were picked,
And killed to serve as mourning food,
To treat mourners warmly,
And let them stay overnight.

After the afternoon of Thursday,
When Friday evening came,
All Kirgiz saw the hero's spirit off to the heaven in sorrow.

Although the rules did not mention,
It was not wrong to break the rules to show our regards.
We could not leave a bad name behind us,
A grand ceremony was needed,
Let the late kinsfolk live in the heart of Kirgiz people forever.

Bakay stood in front of the remains and held the head of the hero,
Let all families see the hero for the last time.

Smart Kanikai,
Planned all these with her wisdom,
In order to deceive others,
She wrapped his statue instead of the real body,
Buried it in the white tomb in the presence of all mourners.

Till the midnight of that day,

① Mares of empty embryo: Kirgiz do not allow to kill pregnant livestock. Mares of empty embryo are the mares that are not pregnant.

Kanikai asked Kezler Aristan,
And old Bakay to come,
They carried the real body of the hero out,
Put it in the tomb built in Karasu river.
Karasu river was still running as usual,
Kanikai finally was fully relieved.

Kanikai, the princess of a Khan,
Without being noticed by any other people,
Perfectly arranged the funeral affairs of the hero.
It's a pity that the hero departed the life,
Kanikai was left and lived lonely in sorrow.

Seeing all the mourners off,
Five or six days after the peaceful days,
Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp Khan,
Plotted together secretly,
Then brothers Aweikai and Kobosh,
Asked to butcher a fat mare and set a banquet.
And they sent a matchmaker to inform Kanikai:
"She must marry one of us brothers,
She must make her decision as soon as possible.

"If she is only willing to accompany the spirit of Manas,
If she refuses to marry one of us,
We will never let her live happily and peacefully.
If she does not agree to remarry,
We will pull all her hair off,
Make her fall low as a servant to pick cow dung,
Make her end on the streets as a punishment.
And we will take all her fortune."

They told these to the matchmaker,
The matchmaker came to Kanikai immediately.
And went straight to the point,
Kanikai was sad about what she heard:

"Oh, madam Kanikai,
Please listen to me carefully,
It is common that the husband died,
But it is not common for the wife not to marry again,
The wife must remarry,
Then she can keep her status and the property she owns.
Now you are still respected by all,
Do not put yourself in the miserable life.

"The brothers Aweikai and Kobosh,
Which one would you like to marry?
Please make your decision soon.

"Kanikai, you are not like you when you were young,
You cannot decide your marriage by yourself now.
If you refuse the marriage,
They will throw you out of the palace now!"

Kanikai got very angry,
She shouted to the matchmaker:
"Get out of here now,
Go back to those two bastards,
Tell every of my words to them.

"Those two bastards' mother,
Was my mother-in-law's servant girl.
They two are baseborn servants,
I will never marry them,
They pick the wrong person.
I will never regret for my decision today,
I despise their baseborn behavior.

"I would die rather than yield to them,
I will not allow it happen even they kill me.
I would go away and support myself,
Rather than bowing to them."
The matchmaker was completely discomfited and left.

Kanikai was a woman of great wisdom,
She predicted what would happen later.
She felt more and more worried,
It seemed the storm would come soon.

Kanikai took a rapid decision,
She should hide her son Semtay first.

Semtay was so young at the moment,
He just had his three-year-old birthday celebration.
Kanikai was good at planning,
She was a great and smart mother.

A servant called Saritaz,
He was a chef,
Kanikai gave the young Semtay to him,
Let him raise Semtay as his son.

After he adopted Semtay,
He took care of Semtay like he was his own son.
Saritaz's son, who was picked from nowhere,
Was taken back by Kanikai,
She also treated him like her own son.
Except old Bakay,
No one else knew this secret.

Kanikai took the boy back home,
She did not spare any of her gold and silk,
Raised and loved the boy,
She always held the boy in her arms,
Everyone thought the boy was Manas' son.

The young kid still could not stand and walk stably,
He waggled when he was walking,
Like an infant who could not leave the cradle.

Kanikai was worried about the boy,
But she still loved the boy and gave him the best,
She dressed him very beautiful.

The matchmaker went back,
Reported to Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp:
"I talked with sister-in-law Kanikai,
Her words made me embarrassed!

"She said although she is a widow,
Aweikai and Kobosh are servants!
She scolded you two angrily,
What she said was offensive to the ears.

"She said she is deep in sorrow,
The widow of Khan Manas will never marry again.
She said the mother of you two,
Was the servant of Qierdy.
She said the two bastards, Aweikai and Kobosh,
Betrayed their mother and ancestors.

"She said do not foul her anymore,
She does not care and not want to marry you.
She said she has no complaints,
But she will never agree to marry a baseborn servant!
She said she despises your shameless behavior,
You two will have no good end if you go your own way!

"I am only a matchmaker between you and Kanikai,
But she scolded me to pieces.
I have reported what she said word by word,
I have accomplished your task."

Heard what the matchmaker said,
Jagurp stamped with rage:
"She cannot refuse on this issue,
We need control this stubborn woman all the while everyday!

We need restrain her with sticks like treating mad dogs,
Slash her severely all the time!"

Aweikai also turned angry from embarrassment:
"Wait and see how I take care of this stubborn woman!
I will stamp her Ayinla flat and rob her,
I will make her be the servant of my servant!

"I will make her cook and do labor work everyday,
I will make the widow Kanikai humiliated,
I will make her suffer mentally and physically,
I will make her leave my home for no way.
I will make her tortured as she is in the hell,
I will make her hard to live as a human!"

As soon as Aweikai finished talking,
Kobosh also stamped with rage.
He shouted resentfully:
"I must take care of this tough widow!"
Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp,
Could not calm down from the great rage,
It seemed they were going to fight against Karamark.
They sharpened knives and pulled the bows,
Shouted in one voice:
"We must punish this slut!"

They three clenched their teeth in hatred,
They were anxious to rush into Kanikai's palace this night,
They waited to start an attack toward Kanikai,
Take the throne of the Khan,
Occupy the property in the palace.

These three cherished evil designs,
All did not fall asleep the whole night.

The three stars set,
It turned white in the east,

They called all their people together right away,
And set out toward Manas's Ayinla.

Qierdy and Kanikai were flustered,
At the moment when they heard it.
But they knew they would act like this long ago,
They gave Semtay to Saritaz to raise.
In order to keep the secret of Semtay's true identity,
They never let him come close to their village.

Kanikai played an artful scheme,
She replaced Semtay with another boy.
She held the boy in her arms,
Took care of him like her own son.
They didn't feel so worried,
For the reason that he was not Semtay.

Aweikai and Kobosh Bullied the Orphan, Killed the Newborn, Robbed and Forcibly Occupied the Property

Aweikai and Kobosh came with a group of ruffians,
They robbed the livestock in Kanikai's pen,
Drove camels on the prairie away,
Left nothing in the treasure house,
Which was full of gold, silver and silk,
They robbed everything they could take.

They expelled Kanikai and her mother-in-law,
From their palace mercilessly.
Qierdy and Kanikai,
Cried in sorrow.

The palace yurt was removed forcedly,
Everything in the yurt was tied together.
They led the robbed male camel,
Carried all the things away.

Qierdy and Kanikai,
Did not have ability to resist.
At the time of blink an eye,
Jagurp rushed to her angrily,
He pointed his finger at Kanikai and shouted:

"You such a shameless woman,
You did not accept our advice,
Refused to marry Aweikai.

"We gave you face, you turned it down,
You think you are still noble,

But you are just like a stubborn bitch.
You arrogantly refuse to marry Kobosh,
You made it, you suffer!"

Jagurp turned and ordered the ruffians:
"Rob it, smash it,
Leave her nothing, even a blade of grass."

Jagurp stood aside aggressively,
Kanikai stopped crying and stood up,
She bowed to Jagurp,
And poured out her feelings.

"Father-in-law, you raised us,
I will always remember this.
When your son was alive and on the throne,
You lived a life as a Khan like in the heaven.

"Father-in-law, though you become old now,
You are still unreasonable and light in the head.
Your son Manas just passed away,
It is less than ten days!

"Your son Manas died,
You should feel sad for your son,
It is the common sense to be a human,
But you feel happy about it.

"Your son died less than ten days,
But you force me to remarry.
Your son's body is not cold yet,
You just bring those two bastards to take advantages!

"I put all my livestock in the pen,
I leave everything to the spirit of Manas.
The spirit of Manas will punish you,
I curse, your family will be ruined and you will have no good end.

"My patron Manas should not die,
How he had the heart to leave me and his son.
Now where I can find the justice and fairness?
My son and I suffered such bad fates.
We wish he could see what happened to us,
And punish these bastards.

"You asked why I did not marry your sons,
They are true bastards with no virtue.
You assisted them and burst into my palace,
What are you?

"You ordered those ruffians to rob your son's property,
You are even worse than those ruffians.
Do not say that let me marry your two evil sons,
I even do not want to look at them.

"For what you have done today,
I have predicted and prepared."
Kanikai cried out her heart angrily,
It was like a sharp knife stabbing toward Jagurp.

Heard Kanikai's angry complaints,
Jagurp did not feel sorry at all,
He even became more furious.
He mounted his steed and ran wildly,
He called more ruffians to come:

"Come and look at this bitch,
Pretend she is poor and cry.
Her child was just three years old,
But she put all the hope on this little boy.

"Although the boy cannot stand stably,
And he waggles when he walks,
His eyes are shining like the morning star,

It's like a little eagle that is thirsty for flying.

"He hides in a cell poorly now,
He cannot stand up straight,
But he may do some earthshaking things in the future,
He will be a disaster if he still lives a life.
His father conquered everything when he was alive,
And left you all no chance.

"While he is still young and ignorant,
You all should kill this root of trouble,
Remove the source of trouble, do not hesitate anymore.
God never takes the bestowed chance back,
We must remove this future enemy now.

"A wolf pup like him,
Will be very dangerous if we keep him alive!
For Kanikai, the stubborn bitch,
We must punish her severely,
We must strike the bitch down,
We must knock her arrogance down!"

Malicious Jagurp shouted:
"Kobosh, why don't you take an action now?
Kill the boy now!"

He shouted with a frenzy of rage,
Like a devil came for the life.
These bastards did not hesitate for a second,
Now they all turned into devils.
They were asked to take the hat off but they cut the head off,
There were no ruffians more ferocious than them.

Jagurp's order cannot be delayed,
These two notorious bastards,
Did not discourage and neglect,
They would kill the innocent kid without hesitation.

Kobosh and Aweikai,
Whipped their steeds and rushed ahead,
Reached out for the poor kid,
Intended to destroy their future trouble.

Kanikai and Qierdy,
These two women untied,
Held the kid who just learned crawling,
Tight in their arms.

Witnessed the situation of grabbing the kid,
People around were in an uproar.
They spared their lives to circle Kanikai and the kid in the center,
Tried to protect the offspring of their heroic Khan.

Malicious bastard Jagurp,
Saw people loving Manas's son,
He felt more jealous,
And turned to be more and more ferocious.

Aweikai and Kobosh,
These two menacing bastards,
Stamped on the people in front of them,
Grabbed the poor kid.
They posed like they were heroes,
They pulled the kid from those two women's hands,
And showed their happy faces.

The two bastards whipped their steeds,
Pulled the kid like a goat,
Sent it to Jagurp.

Jagurp abetted his two bad sons,
Robbed and forcibly occupied the property, and killed the boy,
He himself dashed his own grandson to death,
He was even worse than a beast,
The bad end would finally recoil on him.

After killing the boy,
These malicious bastards,
Began to feel good.

It was sad the innocent was killed,
The evildoers were crude and boorish.
Once the leader passed away,
Family must be suffered from evil treatment.

Kanikai and Qierdy,
Sat on the ground toward the west,
Tears mixed with blood welled up in their eyes,
They cried again when they were missing Manas.

These two poor women,
The wife cried for the husband, the mother cried for the son,
They cried and were overwhelmed by great grief.
Qierdy cried out loudly:
"My lamb, you leave me alone,
My foal, you went to another world,
The disaster then comes down to us.

"My Burum① gown was torn up,
My heart is torn to pieces like my gown.
I am suffering from this endless misery,
Do you know this, my son Manas?

"Our property was robbed,
Your ferocious father is like a merciless wolf.
I would die together with you,
Rather than suffering from the misery!

"Do not let me master your treasure,
Do not let me suffer from it.

① Burum: It is the general name of one thick and valuable fabric and its ready-to-wear.

Please take me with you!
Your bastard father does not allow me to live a happy life,
My grandson was dashed to death in front of me.

"Jagurp is even more ferocious than a devil,
It made me feel regretful and sorrowful!
They robbed the treasure you saved,
It made them happy.
My lamb, I feel so sad!"

Mother Qierdy just stopped crying,
Kanikai even cried sadder.
She wore her mink lapel robe,
The empty sleeves loosely dropped on both sides:

"My noble king!
Let me look at you from the back in sorrow.
My extraordinary king!
I have such a miserable life,
Who can I blame?

"Your father turns into a malicious devil,
It is less than ten days after you left me,
He came and robbed me. It made me so sad!
My majestic king, you just leave me here alone,
I am your poor widow!
Goodness or crime,
Let God make the final judge!

"I swear to revenge as long as I am alive,
I must destroy those three bastards!
I will not shrink back even they kill me,
I will live to the day of revenge."

Kanikai and Qierdy,
Cried loud and sad,
The fellow villagers watched by the side,

Could not restrain from crying.

These two women suffered too much,
Now they were thrown out in the wilderness.
Jagurp, who robbed everything of his son,
Mounted the top of the evil.

These two women cried and suffered,
They were abandoned in the wilderness forcibly.
Jagurp thought they would yield to his authority,
They would come back to him when they woke up to reality.

He thought they would beg him for the food and water,
Because he robbed all their property and livestock,
He thought they would fear his power,
Finally they would bow to him and beg for coming back.

The persecution of those three bastards,
Made Kanikai suffer and hard to stand,
But the brave heroine was not struck down,
Made her mind to even up crimes with them one day.

When the tragedy was going on,
There was one person followed the developing of it.
Clever and resourceful hero Bakay,
Now hid in Timurtao mountain and watched.

Endless conclusions and plans,
Came to the mind of Bakay,
He had a presentiment long ago,
To the plots of Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp.

He was in terrible fidgets for a couple of days,
He lifted the telescope up and watched for several times,
Both lens were facing Talas Plain,
Observed the home of Manas carefully.
The luxuriant palace and livestock all over the mountains in the past,

Now had dimmed and hard to see clearly.
Herds of livestock were robbed,
Bakay only saw grass all over the hills.

Clever and resourceful Bakay,
Became deeply concerned about them.
Far away in his vision at the moment,
There were two figures appeared at intervals.
Now he was sure Kanikai had suffered,
His bloody tears shed over his chest.
Then he thought everything would not go against God's plan,
Bakay tried hard to console himself.

Those two holy and pure women came near and near,
Bakay now could recognize them easily.
He thought they could not stay here for long,
They must go to the place they should go.
He thought he was Manas's bosom friend when he was alive,
He must try his best to keep his promises.

He immediately butchered two fat sheep and boiled,
Filled two big leather bags full with horse milk,
He prepared all these for them to use on the way.
He took two mares and saddled,
Let them avoid suffering from walking,
He had already had no ability to support them more.
He had lost his past honorable status,
Now he was not a powerful Khan anymore.

Bakay carried the mare meat and horse milk,
Tied it on the back of those two mares.
Heard their tearful complaints briefly,
He handed the mares to these two poor women right away.

He advised them repeatedly in sorrow:
"You should go on small path and avoid the big road,
You must avoid the malicious enemies.

It is faster if you go along the gentle hills,
Go and run for your life and do not stop."

Kanikai and Qierdy drank some horse milk,
Pressed forcibly their anger down in the heart.
They went forward under the direction of Bakay,
Moved toward Manas' grand tomb.

They came to the front of Manas' tomb,
Bade the last farewell to the spirit of the hero.
In order to let the hero's spirit bless and protect them,
They prayed devotedly.

Bakay and them consoled and sent good wishes to each other,
Cried for each other and then departed.

Two women, one Khan,
Their miserable lives connected together tightly.

The wall of the tomb was very tall,
No people nearly came after it was built.
Kanikai was full of tears,
She bowed down and cried:

"The lucky star God granted me has gone,
My hero Manas died,
I sang the longing songs for you,
I managed to assemble people to come to your funeral.

"You died only less than ten days,
I have already suffered from the great disaster.
I am asking your advice under the sky,
What can I do if I do not yield?

"It is your fatuous father Jagurp who made the disaster,
My king, it is he who hated you.
His cunning plots and tricks,

Have been already exposed in public.

"God made your father black heart and liver,
From the hard black rocks.
My majestic Manas, after you died,
All your tribes mourned you,
All your villagers cried for your death.
But your father and your brothers,
Robbed all your property mercilessly.

"Your brothers Aweikai and Kobosh,
Gave away their ugly faces finally.
I do not know whom I can depend on now,
I have been driven desperate.

"Your old advisor Bakay,
Is also at the end of his resources!
Vast Talas, once you lived there,
You were their commander and patron.
You were an intelligent and courageous hero like a lion,
You were the Khan all Kirgiz believed in.

"You were my patron, my Suritang[1],
My noble husband, you departed your life unfortunately.
Your mother, your wife and your son suffer for you,
We ask your spirit to bless our safety.

"Our son Semtay,
Is the treasure you gave to me.

"Your steed ran on the hill,
It is hard to distinguish it from many jades.
Now the bad guys give away their ugly faces,
Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp throw down their gloves in public.

1 Suritang: It means Khan and king in Kirgiz. Kirgiz women call their husband Suritang to show their respect.

Your son, he will avenge for us in the future,
He avoided the disaster but he is still too young.
My love, I can only cry my angry to you,
Please take me away with you.

"Your steed is running on the hill,
Jades and steeds mixed together,
It is your son to mount your steed,
And wear your coat armor to fight against enemy,
But he is too young to do it now.
My love, I can only cry my complaints to you,
Do not let me suffer anymore, please take me too.

"Your palace, you decorated with golden and red color,
Now it is robbed and in a mess.
Kirgiz lost their king,
I am absolutely overwhelmed by grief,
Kanikai without you now is living miserably!

"Your blue and white palace, decorated with splendid patterns,
Now turned to be empty without its master.
My king, you are not by my side,
How miserable and sad I am now!

"My king, you just leave us,
Now abundant Talas lost its master,
Semtay is crying for his father,
He is left in the world lonely.

"My Khan, you just leave us,
Now vast Talas lost its master,
Semtay is mourning you,
He is so young and so poor!

"My lion, you just leave us,
Now beautiful Talas lost its master,
Aweikai and Kobosh become its master.

They are going to take your throne,
Your boy is too young to fight back.

"My big tree was cut down in the middle,
My short-lived husband,
Your death made me too sad to live alone.

"My king, you once conquered Beygin city,
Suritang Almanbet and Chuwak,
You made them lose their lives in Beygin city,
You made those Berks① turn to be the sacrifice of the expedition.

"My tree was bent and broken off,
My bad luck hero,
You were also not lucky enough to come back alive!

"My heroic husband, you went on the expedition,
Muzburchak and Sirak,
Also became the sacrifice of that expedition.
You sacrificed so much,
You did not make yourself come back alive!

"You led your troops to the expedition,
You passed the remote paths,
Stepped on the silver wilderness,
Climbed over steep mountains.
You left your troops to Kangayi people,
But you came back with full of injuries on you!

"Once you assembled many soldiers,
You were so ambitious of the expedition,
You said you were going to conquer Beygin city,
But you left it unfulfilled!"

"No one ever went to that place,

① Berks: Refers to officials, tribe captains, ministers and masters.

No one even tried to conquer it.
Even Yiskander[①] did not step on it,
No one has ever conquered it in the history.

"Even the sage Saba[②] did not set foot there,
No one ever conquered it.
It is the unbreakable Beygin city,
My king, you dashed ahead to the expedition desperately.

"I suffered for your son,
You never know how many hardships I suffered!
You went on expedition to Beygin city,
You led your soldiers and suffered heavy casualties,
Too many Kirgiz heroes,
Lost their lives in the expedition.

"My noble king, my lucky star,
You were stubborn and did not listen to both points.
Beygin city, a place you should not go,
Why were you so anxious to do?

"Beygin city, a place people never come out alive,
It belongs to Khitan people all the time,
The first ancestors of human came into the world,
No one could ever conquer Beygin city.

"My king, you went your own way,
Then the disaster descended over your head.
You assembled your troops casually,
You were too arrogant and over confident at the moment.
You ignored people wanted to be the commander there,
Never came back alive.

1. Yiskander: It is said he was Alexander the Great, the conqueror of ancient Greece. He was a great man with supernatural power.
2. Saba: It means the faithful follower of a sage.

"You wore silk and brocade when you were alive,
My lion, you were of awe-inspiring appearance!
You fronted millions of troops,
Conquered the camps of Kangayi,
Sixty tribes of Arashi[①] people,
Were all gathered and commanded by you.
My lion fronted them,
To conquer that destructible Beygin city.

"Ninety tribes of Arashi people,
Were assembled and commanded by you,
You asked them to march on without rest,
But you sent them all to the hell.

"The strange place, no one ever conquered,
Beygin city, no one could come back alive,
You went your own way without listening any advice,
You suffered from a secret attack from Kunwuerbayi,
The poisoned crescent axe cut in your neck.
You lost your life,
And you throw into misery.

"How I can still stay in your Ayinla,
How I can bear the humiliation from Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp!
I cannot let your son suffer from this disaster,
I need to raise him till he grows up.

"As long as our Semtay is living healthily,
I believe he will make them pay their blood debt,
He will not let me suffer anymore.

"You died miserably,
You left your holy and pure wife,
Our son is still too young,
I pray for his safe and healthy growth.

① Arashi: Tribal alliance.

"Countless Kirgiz have no stable places to stay,
Wandering mothers and their people depend on each other for survival.
Your old father Jagurp,
Is the leader of those ruffians.
Once I enjoyed the happiness in the world,
But now I am suffering and humiliated!"

Kanikai cried and complained ceaselessly,
Qierdy and Bakay Khan,
Felt too sad on what she complained.

Right at the moment,
A baby's cry came to their ears,
Kanikai ran out of the tomb immediately,
Saritaz held Semtay on his back,
Walked fast toward them.

Tears went down along his white beard,
Old Bakay rushed up to him,
Wanted to tell him,
The miserable disaster happened in the palace.

Bakay walked in a hurry,
Came up to the front of Saritaz,
Opened his strong arms,
Held the baby tight in his arms.

"My baby, are you all right?"
The old man said and kissed the baby.
The bloody tears of Bakay,
Sweated the front of the baby's clothes.

"You are my nephew, Semtay,
I am your uncle Bakay.
As long as God bless you,
You must return your hometown when you grow up.

"You go back to your hometown when you are an adult,
You need ask enemies for the blood debt of your father,
If you meet ferocious enemies,
I believe you will march forward bravely and defeat them.

"Do not be a coward because you lost your father,
You can find your people and get them back.
I, Bakay, am old now,
But I will try my best to help you then.

"These are words from the bottom of my heart,
I tell you as a souvenir.
If you go back to homeland Talas,
Please meet me with this as a pledge."

While he was talking,
He took his sheath out:
"Madam, please accept this."
He handed it to Kanikai fondly.

Old Bakay guided them onto the secluded path,
Bade farewell repeatedly:
"I will wait here till the boy come back,
I will let him know the truth,
As long as you can keep him alive,
You can find your parents' home.

"This is the only son our Khan has,
You should bring him up carefully.
When he grows up,
I am sure he will find vast Talas.

"You must always straighten the saddle under his bottom,
Do not let it fray the back of the mare.
The journey is too long,
These mares are very valuable to you.

"He is our hero's son,
You cannot make him sad,
Do not allow others to humiliate him,
Do not get him hurt from the Poisoned Eye①.

"Kanikai, you should remember what I said,
If you do not raise him carefully,
You will turn him to be a useless person,
You will get yourself a bad reputation,
You must comprehend my purpose.

"My boy, wish you grow up quickly to a black mane wolf,
Wish him to be a fierce leopard.
Wish God bless you all,
We will say goodbye here,
Wish you all safe in the journey, mount now!"

Tears fell like beads,
Heart was broken to pieces,
Words for departing were endless.
Poor and affable old Bakay,
Held his tears back suddenly and cheered up:
"Get on the mare now, start off early."

Affable and respectable Bakay,
Decided to stay,
Arranged everything ready for them,
Guided them on the safe path.

Bakay sent them two mares,
They said goodbye to each other and started off to the journey,
Bakay then walked back.
Kanikai reined in at the moment,
Warned Saritaz again and again:

① The Poisoned Eye: Kirgiz custom suggests that some heroes' eyes can not look at the baby in the face, it will hurt the baby.

"You never can tell anyone the truth,
That I let you raise my kid at first.
I just protect him according the old tradition,
I will make him be a Khan.

"As long as my only son grows up,
I believe he will be excellent and brilliant,
He will make my wish come true."
For what Kanikai had warned,
Saritaz nodded and agreed.
Kanikai was full of hope,
As if her son had already mounted the throne of Khan.

When they went and rounded a hill,
Bakay was waiting there.

Bakay came up and stopped them,
Said to this chief warder① of the palace:
"Saritaz, come close to me,
You should listen to me carefully,
It is a three-month-journey from here,
To the capital city of Tirmi.

"What can you do if you stay here?
You'd better get away to a faraway place as early as possible.
I will provide gold and silver to you,
I will give you plenty of livestock,
You can do the business and herd the livestock,
Become a real rich man.
You need open up more wasteland for farming,
To make sure your people have enough to eat.

"My Saritaz, you should remember,
Do not forget what I say to you.

① Chief warder: It refers to Saritaz. He was the chief warder of the palace when Manas was alive.

You are an elder with many life experiences,
You need pay close attention secretly,
Make sure Semtay will grow up healthy and strong.

"When you find he has the ability of revenge,
Then find a chance to tell him the truth,
Let him know his life story,
And he can go back to hometown and retake the throne of Khan.

"If he turns into a diligent farmer,
He will like the plough and farm work.
If he is ambitious enough,
He will fly in sky like an eagle.

"If he turns into a coward,
He will dare not walk out of the house.
If he is smart enough,
He will not waste time at home.

"You need watch his personality secretly,
I believe your sharp eyes.
You need let him learn his people and homeland,
I believe you will find the chance to let him know more.

"What I have told you now,
You should remember clearly.
If he can retake his father's wealth,
If he can mount the throne of Khan,
You will walk into that splendid palace again."

Saritaz answered:
"It is fine, Bakay,
I promise you.
When Manas was alive,
I was his chief warder."

"You were his adviser,

Those Khans treated you as an equal,
You made countless contributions to our king.

"Manas entrusted me with an important post,
I did nothing inferior to others!
I am a man of knowing gratitude,
Khan Manas only has one son,
I must give him my full attention?

"Now I am driven into a corner,
I will follow your advice and just watch.

"Once this little tiger grows up to be a useful person,
I will send you the message.
When he is twelve years old,
I will send you his detailed information.

"Bakay, this is my promise to you.
I will contact you when it is the right time.
I believe you will wait patiently,
My sage, do not forget my heart."

Let us put this aside,
Sing from the long and hard journey,
On which Kanikai and Qierdy were going.

Kanikai and Her Mother-in-law Took Semtay and Fled away

Heard Bakay's careful advice,
Cherished in the heart the farewell feeling,
Kanikai turned the mare head in sorrow,
Set out on the journey in a hurry.

Days and nights, the journey continued,
The mares did not stop,
No considering of tiredness and hardships,
Saw off too many sunset and morning stars.

In order to comfort her mother-in-law on the way,
Kanikai forced herself to smile.

She let Qierdy and the baby rest in warm and leeward place,
When they got tired.
Kanikai held tight the halter of the mares,
Let the tired mares eat and drink.

Two mares were exhausted,
The hooves were scratched up by small stones.
In the place people could never think of,
In the wilderness no one could ever come,
They counted the days they were on the way,
It was already one and a half months.

Elichek[①] and scarves were full of dust,
They did not have time to wash.

① Elichek: Kirgiz woman's hat. It is made of white cloth more than ten meters long.

Went across the vast Gobi desert and wilderness,
Two mares were too tired to make even one step forward.
Helplessly, they had to abandon their mares,
They held Semtay in the arms and walked forward.

Another five exhausting days passed,
Old and weak Qierdy could not walk anymore.
Kanikai was a high-born lady,
But she clenched her teeth and persisted.
She carried her mother-in-law on her back,
Continued going forward,
She was exhausted but did not stop,
The decision of revenge gave her inexhaustible strength.

Burum robe was broken to pieces,
Leather shoes on her feet were worn out,
Kanikai's knees were sore,
Her heels were badly worn.
Mother-in-law Qierdy on her back,
Gasped for breath like a weak sheep.

No overshoes, she only wore soft boots,
What a poor and miserable woman!
She was exhausted,
How poor and lonely she was!

If you asked how long the journey was,
Forty five sunsets and forty five sunrises had appeared.

Illness and hunger were endless,
The wilderness was continued in front of them.
Fully suffered Kanikai,
Was dirty all over her face and had no tears to shed.

It was just past midday time,
They had already been chaotic in the mind,
Their bellies were rumbling,

Then they met a passer-by who rode on a horse.

The man came to them and asked:
"You hold a baby in the arms and an elder on the back,
Step forward difficultly and you look worn out,
Why don't you ride a horse?
Where do you come from and where do you go?
Aunt, do not take any offence at my words,
Could you tell me your story?"

He came up and held the halter,
He talked with them affably.
He was a young man,
He asked for the detailed story with true care.

Kanikai started to talk:
"Young man, I will tell you what you asked,
Our homeland is famous Kankoler,
Our people are Nuoyi① and Arashi.

"I seek refuge from the persecution,
My sorrow cannot be expressed in a few words.
You asked me who is my husband,
He is the greatest hero Manas. He just passed away.

"I am a person born to endure hardships,
I am Manas' wife.
I am like the outside of the Kamuka② robe,
I am Kara Khan's dear daughter.

"I suffer terribly for taking care of my son,
I hold him in my arms on this long and hard journey.

1. Nuoyi: Name of a Kirgiz tribe.
2. Kamuka: It is the name of one precious silk fabric that silk thread spun with gold thread or silver thread.

I am going to look for Jedigair[1] people,
And go to Bagersh for shelter.

"You are a warm hearted young man,
Who is the leader in your Ayinla?
Please tell me the truth,
I do not make you any trouble."

Remarkable, elegant,
Noble and smart Kanikai,
Talked neither aggressive nor conciliatory.

The young man exposed his white teeth,
Replied Kanikai respectfully:

"Please listen carefully, majestic sister,
You are not the ditch reed,
If you are the daughter of Kara Khan,
You are our respectable sister.

"Sister, your words are impressive,
Timir is our Khan,
We are so close in relationships,
Kara Khan is the commander of us.

"Let's go, sister, go home with me,
Why do you still hesitate?
Mount my horse now, my sister,
Let's go home as soon as possible.

"Timir's daughter, my good sister,
You trudge and endure hardships,
It makes you so tired,
It makes you exhausted."
The young man's words were exciting,

① Jedigair: Name of one of the Kirgiz tribe.

He urged continually: "Let's go, sister!"
He got into their way after he finished his words,
But Kanikai did not agree to go.

She persisted in going to Jedigair,
She insisted on looking for Bagersh.

"My Khan Manas left the human world,
My heart never becomes peaceful since then,
My parents did not send any mourners,
How could they be my family members?

"Since Manas closed his eyes,
I did not get even a second of peaceful moment.
You all did not come to pray at his tomb,
How can you all be my fellow villagers?

"As long as I am alive,
I can find hero Bagersh,
I am willing to be an ordinary people in Jedigair.
Even you lead camels and apologize to me,
I will still not step in my parents' door!"

She told the young man pleasantly:
"Go, young man, do not delay what you need to do!"

After hearing these words,
The young man whipped his steed,
Turned the horse head,
Went ahead as fast as he could,
Two pieces of his clothes waved in the air,
His two big feet did not pull out from the stirrups.

Facing toward crowded Kara Khan city,
Toward Kara Khan's palace,
He disappeared in a blink of an eye.
The young man was in a hurry,

The young man was short of breath,
He arrived in the city,
Burst into the palace without greeting.

People gathered at the palace gate said:
"Look at this little bastard, he is ill-mannered,
He deserves a punishment of whipping.

"You did not dismount when you go into the palace,
You asked for people's rebuke by yourself.
You run the horse like a mad dog,
You asked bad luck to yourself!"

The officers gathered there,
Without thinking of the reason,
Just ordered warders to whip the young man.

The young man hastened to explain:
"Please listen to me,
I have something urgent to tell Khan,
Please forgive me for offending the palace rules,
I will accept the punishment after I report.

"The cool midday time just passed,
On the way to Beygin city,
I galloped my horse on the road alone,
My horse was startled suddenly,
Because we ran into two distressed madams.

"They walked on the road exhaustedly,
Unwashed, uncombed, and absent-minded,
It seems they got robbed.
They have been tired beyond endurance,
Looking haggard and drawn,
They come for a shelter from an Ayinla far away.

"The young one is like a lady of quality,

She held a baby in her arms and an elder on her back.
The old one is short of breath and coughs a lot,
Lips are dry and eyes are closed.
They walk day and night,
They march forward on foot arduously.

"I went up and asked them,
Then I know their story and situation.

"The young and noble lady said:
'My hometown is Kankoler,
My husband is Manas.
Now my lion passed away,
It is difficult to cry out my sorrow and wrongs.'

"She also said: 'My father is Timir,
My complaints to him are endless.
The old lady with me is my mother-in-law Qierdy,
The boy in my arms is my son.
I am going to Jedigair,
I am going to look for hero Bagersh.'

"She said: 'I will not feel peaceful,
If I do not go to Jedigair.
I will not give up,
If I do not get together with Jedigair people!'

"She said: 'My parents' side has no affection to me,
No one came to mourn my lion,
Even they lead camels and apologize to me,
I will never step into their door.'

"She said Kanikai is her name,
She complained a lot.

"This is all I heard from her,
This is the reason why I rushed.

I got this important information by chance,
But you get angry without asking the reason.
If Kara Khan knows this news,
Can I be spared from your punishment?"

What the brave young man said,
Cleared their complaints up immediately.
Every word the young said was reasonable,
Everyone having heard it was nodding his head.

Arrogant ruler Kara Khan,
Sighed and felt dizzy right away,
His two arms lowered weakly,
Began to cry before saying anything:

"Ah, in such pitch dark night,
Ah, the miserable life!
Does my heroic son-in-law die?
Does he really go to another world?

"Do his father and his brothers,
Really rob his property?
Does the hero leave his son behind him?
Do they flee for protecting his son?

"My precious beloved daughter,
Does she suffer from the crowning calamity?
Is she at the end of her rope?
Does she flee out with no any other choice?

"You all do not look at me, go and welcome her back,
Take nine gifts[1] and servants,
Ride the fine horses and do not rest,
Send them to the princess as soon as possible.

1 Nine gifts: It is Kirgiz custom to send nine gifts to show the sincerity.

"My sweetheart grew up in my love,
My sweet and cute princess Kanikai,
The respectable mother-in-law Qierdy,
She is a noble lady of courtesy!
As long as they are willing to come to my place,
I will appreciate the arrangement of God!

" 'Although the treetop forks,
The root is still connected!'
You all go and talk to Kanikai,
Stop her to go to Bagersh's home.

"Do not refuse to come back home,
For the reason we did not go to the funeral.
You all go and welcome her back without any delay,
Soothe the mother-in-law from excessive grief.

"My Kanikai should not complain about me actually,
Her king died, but no one came to report,
It is not because I do not understand the ways of the world,
The truth is that I did not know anything about it.

"Tell her that I just heard about the bad news,
I am asking for the forgiveness of Qierdy,
Let my daughter Kanikai not hate me.
You all line up and go to meet her soon,
Take all the gifts and servants.

"Pick the fine horse,
For my beloved daughter,
Put the beautiful saddle on,
You all set out right away,
Bring her to me as soon as possible!"

People around did not dare to neglect his words,
Kara Khan's words were the orders.
They all mounted their horses,

Went out of the city immediately.

"Let's present nine gifts,
Then advise her politely to show our sincerity."
They began to discuss on the way,
They came to the same opinion before they got there.

Galloped down the road without the rest,
They came to princess Kanikai instantly:
"Sister, are you alright?"
They greeted her together politely.

There was a wonder called Krimkuler among them,
He was born smart in people's eyes,
He was good at social and getting close to others,
He was eloquent.
No matter what kind of issues he was asked to do,
He could do perfectly.

He began to talk as soon as he saw the princess:
"Ah, my dear sister, please forgive us,
We did not visit you at your home.
We just know the bad news of our brother-in-law's death,
Everyone is very sad.

"My dear sister Kanikai,
We heard you plan to hold your baby in your arms,
Go and seek refuge with hero Bagersh.

"After hearing the words about you,
Your father, Kara Khan, is too anxious to sit,
He would rather kill himself to show his love to you.

"Our heroic brother-in-law,
His death brought us endless grief.
Your father is inconsolable when he heard the bad news,
We talk him out of the thinking of going to die with great effort.

You must be overwhelmed with grief of losing your husband,
Please forgive us for not going to the funeral.

"We all come for you,
We bring the servants and the nine gifts,
We lead the horse to you,
Prepare the fine saddle for you,
Your father picks this fine steed to you,
It is in front of you, please mount.

"We still have a lot to tell you,
But we dare not say for you will get angry.
Sister, we are all your brothers,
Please mount the horse now,
You will stay or go, please tell us,
Sister, please make up your mind."

Showing a few of her white teeth,
Kanikai started to talk:
"Cut out the banana oil,
If my mother-in-law does not agree,
I will not forgive my parents.
I pray to God to bless him,
Only for the sake of my son's safety."

Krimkuler's heart sank,
Kanikai refused to go back to her parents',
People came together crowded on the road,
They came up and circled Kanikai in the center.

Qierdy opened her mouth:
"Kanikai, listen to me,
We cannot go to Bagersh for help!
My late son was a militant man,
A lot of people became enemies with him.

"My dead son Manas is a hero,

He went on expedition for many times.
He has too many enemies in this world,
How could those bad guys welcome us?

"My poor grandson is too young now,
I am afraid they will not let him off easily.
Among those bad guys in other places,
Who will feel pity for your suffering?

"Maybe they will serve cat liver as food,
Force your son to eat it.
We two have suffered a lot,
How could we endure more sufferings in other places?
They will not let Manas' son off alive,
We only can wait for our death with deep sorrow!"

Heard what Qierdy said,
Everyone at presence applauded:
"That is exactly right, her ladyship!
Each word is full of wisdom."

These were words from the bottom of her heart,
People at presence were all happy,
Smart Kanikai,
Did not disobey her mother-in-law.

They were helped up on the horse,
Spurred the horse and galloped forward,
Toward Timir palace,
They got to the palace in a short time.
People were crowded and welcomed them,
Helped them off the horse warmly.
Kara Khan burst into loud sobs as he saw his daughter:

"My sweetheart Kanikai,
Where do you come from after the sufferings?
You lost your king Manas,

I heard you plan to go to other people for shelter on foot,
What makes me sadder is,
You plan to go to Bagersh's for shelter.

"It is not the place your father has gone,
It is not the clothing your mother sewed[1].
It is totally a wrong decision,
That you go to Bagersh for help."

People warmly urged them to stay,
Five fat mares were butchered to welcome them.
Grand ceremony were held to mourn Manas,
It made everyone calm down.

The cute boy was their mental prop,
These two women raised the boy carefully.
For the sake of Semtay's healthy growth,
People weaved a cradle with willow twigs.
They also put up a new yurt,
For these two poor women.

Care and love from families soothed their sorrow,
Clouds in their hearts cleared up gradually,
They began their new lives,
They started comfortable lives there with the help of the families.
Let us put this aside,
Let us start a new chapter,
Semtay grew up and started to know the homeland.

① It is a Kirgiz proverb. It means very familiar and close in relationship.

Young Semtay Returned His Hometown Talas for the First Time

Kanikai Recounted the Family History to Semtay in Pain

After the king Manas was killed,
Jagurp revealed his real nature,
He forced Kanikai mercilessly,
He tried to wipe Semtay off the face of the earth.

In order to protect this only son,
They fled thousands of miles,
Trudged hard and found Kara Khan for their shelter,
They were waiting for the day of revenge to come.

Kanikai and Qierdy,
Lived a peaceful life those years.
They remembered Bakay's advice clearly,
Raised the king's son carefully day and night.

These two ladies focused on raising the boy,
They put soft cotton on the quilt,
Smeared the fat[①] on the bed and on the boy's bottom,
Looked forward to seeing the spirit to come and sleep together.
In order to bring Semtay up strong and brave,
They fed him with sheep neck fat and horse intestines everyday.

In order to let him grow up without equal rival in strength,
They fed him with honey,
Let him drink black tea with full of sugar,
Fed him with nang dipped with milk crème,
Fed him with cooked meat and fat.

1. Smear the fat: It is an old Kirgiz custom. It is said that it can supply calcium.

Did not let him step on cold ground,
Did not dress him with old clothes,
Did not let anyone know who he was.

Kanikai was so careful,
She taught him how to ride a horse since he was little.
Before he was seven years old,
He did not know who he really was.

His grandfather Kara Khan,
Never studied his face before:
"How does my grandson look like?
I need to go and see him."
Kara Khan prayed for his grandson's healthy growth everyday.

He tossed and could not go to sleep every night,
He wanted to see Semtay by himself.
His tears always sweated his clothes,
All his people were touched by his love.

Kanikai had earned all people's respect,
They three lived a peaceful life without disturbing and delaying,
Till Semtay was seven years old,
She did not allow anyone to see her son.

Kanikai got used to everything there,
She took good care of her son together with her mother-in-law,
Till Semtay was seven years old,
He did not suffer even from a wind blow.

In order to satisfy the grandfather's wish,
Kanikai invited her father to come.
Kara Khan came in a hurry as he received the invitation:
"I am so excited today,
Do not let my eyes hurt my grandson."

He took out his collected stone glasses,

Put them on one by one,
He covered his eyes up with those glasses.
He observed carefully his poor grandson,
He thought the boy totally appealed to him,
He felt so happy about his finding.

He thought his grandson was old enough to loose an eagle,
He gave the order to look for a big eagle immediately,
Asked his people to look for it for him.
His grandson was the same as his imagination,
He prayed to God for the healthy growth of his grandson.

His grandson reached the age of riding a horse,
He ordered to pick fine horses for his grandson right away.

"Kanikai, you hide the kid,
Even I do not know his information,
He has passed the age of six to play,
Why don't you let him ride the lilac horse?
Why don't you let him sense the nature of a horse?
Why don't you let him experience the gallop of a horse?
I pray to God for blessing him,
Don't you want him to turn into a great hero?"

Kara Khan looked at Semtay carefully,
He studied from left to right.
When he found the boy totally matched his wish,
He then felt the spring stroked his face comfortably.
He watched over and over again,
Finally he believed the boy was really the hero's flesh and blood.

The hero's son Semtay,
Had bright and energetic eyes,
His face was firm like steel,
His vigor could overpower any enemy.
When he was six years old,
He showed unequaled heroic spirit.

When he was seven years old,
He expressed the wisdom beyond the ordinary.

When he was eight years old,
He was as strong as a mountain,
He could destroy any enemy with his bare hands.
When he was nine years old,
He could climb mountains and wade rivers easily,
He was as agile as a snake.

When he was ten years old,
He was a stronger giant,
No one among Weilat people could equate with him.
When he was eleven years old,
He could ride horse and gallop.

He was born smarter than average,
He was able to read when he was little.
He read extensively and had a wide range of knowledge,
He was broad-minded and ambitious.

Semtay grew up in the sun,
Saritaz watched him carefully by side.
He herded and did the business too,
He always put Bakay's trust deep in his heart.

But Semtay never looked at the fruits Saritaz sold,
He never got close to strangers casually.
He was not like other ordinary naughty kids,
He never had an ordinary mind of buying something.
No chance to get close, no chance to talk,
Saritaz was burning with impatience.

Semtay was twelve years old,
But he always had companions and servants around him.

He wore his gold belt,

Moon-like face was shining.
When girls saw him from a distance,
Their love toward him grew everyday.

He wore his silver belt,
Sun-like face was shining,
When girls saw his strong and tall built,
Their hearts of love and adoration were burning.

He galloped his steed like wind,
He hunted wild ducks and held the hunting eagle,
He was born smart and naughty,
Servants around him always roared with laughter.

He loosed his hunting dog and hunting eagle,
He ran east and west and went his own way,
The young man was rash and impetuous,
He was as energetic as a fiery horse.

When he played in other place free from care,
When he loitered at ease,
Saritaz closed his store, and thought:
"Gold and silver are all rocks,
What can I use them for?
Taking wandering Sentay back to the homeland,
Is my ultimate purpose.

"In order to find a chance to tell him his story,
I need stroll in the wood from dawn till dusk,
Get ready to wait for his coming,
Maybe I will get a chance to meet him."

One day, Semtay played hard,
He loosed his eagle toward the dense wood,
The eagle grabbed a golden chicken,
Flew off into the dense wood.
He could not follow the eagle straightly,

Because of the dense and thorny undergrowth.
Semtay watched helplessly,
He was about to lose his violent and sharp eagle,
It made his heart ache.

He looked around and looked for the way out,
He saw clouds of heavy smoke rose slowly,
In the wood which had been cut down,
It was the smoke from burning wood,
The man who was making charcoal was bald.

When he found the bald man,
Semtay came to the front of Saritaz,
Naughty Semtay greeted Saritaz politely,
Whom he even did not know.

Saritaz returned a salute then at the moment:
Surprising tears filled up his eyes.

Semtay talked to him after they greeted each other:
"Your face is full of black ash,
You are the man making charcoal.
My eagle was chasing a golden chicken,
It flew into your woods.

"You wear cow-leather Chokoy[①],
Thorns cannot stick you in the arch of your feet,
If you can go into the dense thorn bushes,
Find me my eagle,
I will appreciate your kindness a lot.

"You can take the golden chicken,
I only need you to take my eagle back.
The eagle will eat the chicken up soon,
You must go quickly, you poor man!"

① Chokoy: One kind of boots made of cow leather.

After hearing what he said,
Saritaz got angry:
"You ask me to get your eagle back,
Do you think I am your servant?"

Kirgiz hero Semtay,
Shouted in rage as well:
"You get charcoal ash all over you,
Are you a rich man if you are not the servant?

"You watch me lose my eagle,
Do you feel happy about this?
If you do not go and get my eagle back to me,
Do not blame me for my mercilessness!"

He flew into a rage and shouted loudly,
He held the halter tight in his hand,
His eyes looked fiercely,
He threw his weight about it unconsciously.

Saritaz was also very angry at the moment,
He started to talk in a strict manner:
"Boy, you are so arrogant and impolite,
How you can treat others so rude!

"You do not care about the truth,
There is no person you can make gestures and criticize!
How you dare wave the halter high in your hand,
There is no person you can whip casually!
It is not your homeland Talas here,
There are no fellow villagers you can depend on!

"You, a spoiled kid,
Have no help here!
Your people are in Arashi,
Your homeland is Talas,

Your father is Manas.
Pledge to protect his local people,
This is what a hero should do in his life.

"Call your mother sister,
You are kept in the dark all the time.
Please remember what I tell you,
You only can achieve greatly,
With the help of your fellow people.
I look down on what you did just now!

"Kanikai and Qierdy,
Lost all the treasure they had,
Suffered a lot and escaped with bare life.
They fled away in a hurry,
In order to keep you alive,
They left home and came here for a shelter.

"They did not have a horse to ride,
They trudged and almost died.
They climbed over mountains and went across the desert,
Arrived here without any rest.

"Your mother never lowered her head to enemies,
She took you here with great difficulties.
Your grandfather and uncles were planning to kill you,
She took you and hid you here!

"There isn't a wall in the world which hasn't a crack,
There is nothing like an absolute secret either,
Do not be complacent, Semtay,
Nephews never live long in uncle's house.

"When your father just died,
Your grandmother and your mother were still in great sorrow,
But your grandfather Jagurp,
Led his two sons, Aweikai and Kobosh,

Robbed of your father's property and treasure.

"Your mother fled but no place was for her,
So she only could come here.
There is no your subject here,
You are not the person that can give orders here!
You must go to find your subjects if you do not lose your sense,
I have nothing else to say except this!"

Semtay was born brave,
He was a hero like a newborn tiger,
He got the severe rebuke from the bald old man.
The young hero who grew up in gilded cage,
Had never suffered from such injustice.

He heard his homeland was Talas,
He heard his father was Manas.
He was given a lesson in broad daylight,
He was astonished and felt terribly embarrassed.

His face was pale like he was cursed,
He felt so angry about the brutal past.
"I cannot stay here anymore to suffer more humiliation."
He covered his mouth with the hand and did not speak again.

"My poor mother,
She suffered all miseries for the sake of me.
It is they who protected me,
My poor grandmother and mother.
They suffered a lot for the sake of me,
They left home and suffered all kinds of humiliation!"

He did not let his face show any emotion,
Considered all these things in his heart.
He decided to destroy all the enemies,
To make them pay his blood debt.

He dismounted from his steed suddenly,
He was going to get his eagle back by himself.
What the bald old man said,
Was a heavy blow to him.

Semtay had got too much dignity,
He went back home with great rage.

On the platform outside of the city at dusk,
He dismounted there,
Took off the saddle of his steed,
And threw it aside.
He untied the eagle's rope,
And threw it down heavily.

He was fulfilled with anxiety,
He frowned and pulled a long face.
The fire of rage was burning in his body,
He hated Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp,
His eyes burned with rage.

The bald man said he had no fellow villagers,
He felt hurt in his heart.
Born-smart black mane wolf pup,
His face was like crushed grass.

He closed his ears to anyone's words,
He did not eat or drink and could not fall asleep.
He could not put out the flames of fury,
What the bald man said lit his fury.

Kirgiz heroine Kanikai,
Wore the clothes of tight waist.
She read the mind of his son,
Then she went to his father's palace.

Born virtuous Kanikai,

Walked in the yurt with light steps,
She came to the side of her father,
Watched the expression on God's face.

Kanikai thought for a while and began to talk,
She told her father what was in her mind:

"My dear father,
It seems my son got the punishment from God,
He might hear some gossips.

"Run the hunting dog, play the hunting eagle,
Lonely Semtay plays and wanders around.
He stops eating after he came back from the wood one day,
It is already three days that he ate nothing.

"It has been three days,
He stays at home and does not ride a horse.
It has been six nights,
He did nothing except meditating.

"He has no smile on his face during the daytime,
He tosses and cannot go to sleep at night.
The boy is not in a good mood,
He always sighs and cannot calm down."

When Kanikai told all these to Kara Khan,
His mind was weighed down with anxiety:
"My spoiled grandson,
He must become aware of some secrets."
For the kid who had known his emotion,
The grandfather had guessed his mind.

Kara Khan started to talk:
"My Kanikai, please listen to me,
Since the boy has been worried for three days,
You can call some girls and married women,

Butcher the colts and boil the meat.

"Let the boy play with them by himself,
You do not disturb them.
Watch whether your kid will be happy or not,
You hide behind the door and watch quietly."

Heard the suggestion of her father,
Kanikai went back home in a hurry.

She asked to butcher female colts,
Invited young and beautiful girls,
And all the young married women,
Let them play games together.

Then poured milk wine into Kokury[①],
Girls and married women clustered round,
All came to propose a toast to Semtay.
Gathered girls and married women,
All looked at Semtay,
They all wanted to make him happy.

Kanikai looked inside secretly from outside of the door,
Semtay did not accept the toast at all,
He did not even look at those girls and married women,
He still frowned with care.
He suddenly shouted toward Kanikai:
"My dear mom, cook me some wheat,
I feel so hungry!"

Nimble-handed Kanikai,
Cooked the wheat with iron pot immediately.
She heard Semtay's shout again:
"Give me a handful of wheat now!"

① Kokury: Kirgiz language. It refers to the leather-made utensil.

The wolf pup cheated her that he wanted the oil-cooked wheat,
He urged his mother to take it to him soon.
In a hurry,
Kanikai reached her hand to the pot,
Grabbed a handful of hot wheat.

The naughty boy rushed ahead,
Seized the hand with hot wheat in it:
"Mom, mom, do not cry and shout,
Mom, mom, I want to avenge!
Where is my home?
Where are my people?
Mom, you must tell me the truth!"

Semtay asked her forcibly:
"Do not cheat me with lies,
Please tell me the information of my people!"
Semtay burned his mother's hand with hot wheat,
Forced his mother to tell him the truth.

"Where are my fellow villagers?"
Heard what Semtay asked her,
Kanikai guessed her son had already heard something.
Facing anxious Semtay,
Kanikai knew everything suddenly.

The hot wheat made her hard to bear,
Burned hand was grasped tight and could not pull back.
"Little wolf, let my hand go!
You such a lonely black mane wolf!"
All sorts of feelings welled up,
Words ran out of Kanikai's mouth:
"Your mother, I, wish God bless you,
Give you a bright future.

"Your homeland is vast Talas,
Your father is renowned Manas,

The land belongs to you is vast and fertile Kankoler,
You are Manas' only son!

"You have two uncles, Aweikai and Kobosh,
You also have a grandfather Jagurp,
You have poor mother and grandmother,
You also have thousands of subjects live in Talas.

"Because I refused to marry your ferocious uncle,
Your grandfather then whipped and expelled me,
He made numerous subjects of Talas wandered,
We just took you and left!

"In order to kill you,
They killed the boy I adopted from a servant.
I sweetheart Semtay,
In order to protect you, the only son,
I held you on my back and came back here.
I helped your grandmother through the desert,
We suffered a lot and trudged here.

"Aweikai and Kobosh, the two bastards,
I came here because of their persecution.

"Let me tell you your dad's death from the Beyginning,
My boy, please listen carefully.

"I pray to God for you everyday,
I lie all the hopes in you.
I always act on what I say,
I did not tell you the past story until you grow up.

"In order not to hurt you,
I protect you like protecting my eyes.
Now you grow up like Aoboler mountain,
My hope has been fulfilled."

"When your father Manas passed away,
I built him a splendid tomb.
It is under grand Aoboler mountain,
It is on the marsh land of Kankoler Ata[①].

"Climbed over Alemalubrak,
On the road of Shunkartash,
I ordered to bake bricks for building the tomb,
With the fat from nine thousand castrated goats.
I built the tomb as firm as rocks,
It will not break down after even nine centuries.

"Copied jade seal of Manas Khan,
Was carved clearly on the wall of his tomb.
I used thousands of pounds of gold,
Asked Molerdo[②] to write your father's life-long achievements,
With gold powder on the wall.

"The white palace your father had ever lived in,
It was not crowded at all even if six hundred people were in it.
The palace was splendid and gorgeous,
You should listen carefully."

"Look at the felt curtain,
Four-finger wide otter skin was sewed on its edge,
Look at that door head,
It was inlaid with a whole piece of gold.

"Millet carried by ninety camels,
Was not enough for the food of nine days.
Rice carried by eighty camels,
Was not enough for the food of eight days.

"In front of the palace,

① Kankoler Ata: It is the name of a place.

② Molerdo: It refers to the educated and knowledgeable people among kirgiz people.

A lot of people always gathered there.
No matter how loud you shouted near the door,
The seat of honor could not hear it.

"Your father and mother,
Always sat in the middle of the seat of honor.

"I did not exaggerate at all,
The palace was so big and gorgeous.
There were a lot Nuoyi people in the center,
They always played the game Take Palace[①].

"On the right, forty warriors with their horses,
Stationed there happily.
On the left, deft Tazbaymart,
Set up the pot and always prepared food there.

"The king and the officers were at one side,
Gathered and always discussed big issues.
You father Manas and me,
We submerged ourselves in the world of happiness.
The yurt palace was set up,
By the side of Talas road all year round.

"It should belong to you,
Now it is in the hand of Aweikai.
After your father died,
Those dirty dogs all bullied us!

"Let me explain the palace,
It has a lot of wonderful designs:
The pillar pressed against the blue ceiling,
The skylight was wrapped with white tin,
The drawstring of the skylight was made of copper chain,

① Take Palace: Kirgiz folk game.

Ribbons placed on the cover felt they were made from Deyilida fabric①.

"The palace is flawless,
It is beautiful and splendid.
Outside of the wall was clean and white,
Inside of the wall was painted red.
Numerous people described it with poems,
Numerous people praised it with their songs.

"Manas' yurt is decent and dignified,
Singers raised their voices to praise it.
Splendens curtains were weaved gorgeously,
They were all tied with silk strings,
How distinguished the yurt is,
It was all made by your mother alone.

"Where the wood fences connected,
Were fastened with copper nails,
On the skirt of the felt on the top of the yurt,
Otter skin was sewed there.

"The outstanding yurt was like a mountain,
Towered up into the clouds.
Warriors stood by the door with battle axes in hands,
Each of them was twelve-step apart.
Those herdsmen and low-grade servants,
Could not go into the palace without permission.

"Spears, swords, knives, guns and gun powder,
Akorlbok coat armor② and Kurjun③,
The armament your father left,

① Deyilida fabric: It refers to the precious fabric and its ready-made-clothes inlaid with gold and silver threads and usually used to make deluxe long robe.

② Akorlbok coat armor: Silver-white silk coat armor.

③ Kurjun: Kirgiz language. It refers to the bag that carries clothes.

Now part of them has been in the hands of Kobosh.

"You are the son of lion Manas,
You should get all of those weapons.
You should go and take all them back,
You should defeat all those ferocious devils!"

Stretched her white neck out,
The noble face was with an expression of wrath,
Kanikai told Semtay the story of their past,
Tears flew and heart ached.

Heard his mother Kanikai's complaints,
Semtay deeply regretted:
"Grandmother and mother,
You suffered such humiliation.
How I can bear and forgive the crimes,
Those bastards committed!"

When thinking about this,
The young hero said to his mother in rage:
"Dear grandmother and mother,
Please butcher a colt and say blessings to me.
How I can bear such miserable sufferings!
I want to visit my grandfather.

"I do not know whether my grandfather will agree,
To lend his black coat armor to me,
Otherwise I am like never coming to this world.
I have no patron to help me,
I'd better go to die under such humiliation!

"I will go and look for Aweikai and Kobosh,
Let them see I am a man with great power.
I will pierce through the eyes of Aweikai and Kobosh,
I will cut Jagurp's head off,
In front of the public.

"If I do not die in the hands of those two bastards first,
I must clean them up together.
The old devil Jagurp,
I must show him who's the boss.

"I will twist their necks off,
I will knock their legs off.
I will kill them all without exception!"

"I will overthrow their brutal rules,
I must get my subjects back.
I will demand the blood debt for my mother and grandmother,
I must punish these despicable bastards!
Their crimes make me overwhelmed by grief,
I will never forget the miserable past.
The great empire my father once built,
I will carry it and forward it!"

Semtay Bade Farewell to His Mother and Went on the Journey Back to the Hometown

Twelve-year-old black mane wolf,
Had a pair of bright piercing eyes.
As long as anyone said "No" to him irreverently,
He would clench his teeth and fly into a rage.

Semtay made up his mind to go back to his homeland,
He led his two beloved women,
Walked toward his redoubtable grandfather,
They came up to Kara Khan in an instant.

Semtay was in high spirit,
He had grown into a capable hero,
His heroic posture was the same as a king.
In front of his kingly grandfather Kara Khan,
He did not show any fear and panic.

He greeted the elder politely first,
Then he asked with a beseeching tone:
"My majestic grandfather, please listen to me carefully,
Branches grow bigger and taller and separate,
But connect with the root forever.

"My grandmother and mother were born poor,
They suffered everything for the sake of me.
I have heard their miserable experiences,
I have been overwhelmed by grief.

"If I do not go and find my fellow villagers,
How can I clear my mind of hatred?

I am a distressed boy,
I need to go back to my homeland and stay with my people.

"If the chance is coming,
I will take my revenge for my beloved mother and grandmother.
After hearing my mother's complaints,
How I can be completely indifferent to their miseries.

"Arrows cannot pierce through,
Fire cannot burn it,
My respectable grandfather,
I am coming to borrow your black coat armor."

Facing the tearful beseeching of his grandson,
Kara Khan needed to respond immediately.

He could not say he did not want to lend it,
He did not want to hurt his grandson's heart either.
But the robe was his favorite treasure,
He walked out of his yurt without a choice.

Kara Khan came out with worry,
Discussed with his wife:
"I know how magic the black robe is,
I want to wear it when I die."

His wife told him angrily:
"When are you going to die?
You did not lend it to Manas in those years,
I still regret for it now.

"You say you will die all the day,
What is that nonsense for?
Do not talk that much rubbish, give your robe to the boy,
Let him defeat those extremely evil enemies.
Let him set out right away when he wears the robe,
Let the robe give him a big help!"

After the discussion,
They presented the coat armor,
To Semtay seriously.

He was black mane wolf Semtay,
He looked more valiant with the coat armor on him.
Qierdy and Kanikai,
Kara Khan and his wife were all satisfied with it.

Grandfather presented a grey horse for riding,
He would not feel tired for six months if he rode on this horse.

For the expedition of agile black mane wolf,
Qierdy and Kanikai,
And grandfather who was reluctant to part with Semtay,
Faced toward Adermark mountain,
Prayed for him.

Mounted his horse and prepared to set out,
Semtay was going to find his people.
He was militant and thrived a heroic bearing,
The black mane wolf waved and said goodbye excitedly.

When the young hero waved the halter and set out,
The mother Kanikai could not bear his son to leave,
It was always heard to sooth the sadness of leaving,
Depressing clouds climbed all over her red face.

Tears fell and sweated her clothes,
Kanikai held the halter in his son's hand,
Advised Semtay repeatedly:

"Semtay, my luck star,
You still do not fully understand the world,
You never leave home alone,
You never experience the fight in a battlefield.

"You never wore a coat armor out,
You do not know how to deal with complicated enemy's situation,
You do not know how precious the black coat armor is,
You still do not get a clear picture of the temper of your steed,
You have never fagged a horse out,
You do not know the hardships on the long distant journey.

"You will go to find your people from far away,
I wish you come back safe.
My born-lonely son,
I entrust your future to the Creator!
You cannot lose your robe and steed,
Do not leave a bad name behind you.

"I wish God bless you all the time,
I wish your father's spirit could protect you,
I wish sages to go and accompany around you.
Go ahead, my son, wish you have a safe journey,
Destroy each and every one of the ferocious enemies.

"I wish your father's spirit could bless you,
Let your good name live long in people's hearts.
This is what I suggest you,
My boy, remember my words.

"In that vast Talas,
In the high hills and steep mountains,
There is a horse called Tayibruler[①],
It is a magic steed your father prepared for you,
You should ride it when you go to a battle.

"My adorable little colt,
If you set out from here,
At the upper reaches of a lake full of cyperus rotundus,
In the wood beside the lake full of Shabuer grass,

① Tayibruler: It is the name of a horse. It is also called Bruler.

Thousands of mares and colts are fastened there.

"When your noble father was alive,
He arranged gold posts there,
Please appreciate and then go ahead,
It is a mark to show your father's brilliance.

"Not far from the gold posts,
Beside the orchard my late husband built,
At the lower reaches of Tortkoler lake,
At the side of the palace Bakay built.

"Right in the front of Barikoler lake,
Not far from Kaynar spring,
Under that plane tree,
In Yuchykoshaoyi valley,
On the bank of Alakoler lake,
Your father's tomb,
Towers aloft there royally.

"When you arrive there,
You should dismount and mourn your father solemnly.
Pray to the spirits of ancestors,
Let them bless you and make you achieve your goal.

"You should hold up the right ribs,
Dismount with the cry 'My Noble Father',
You should hold up the left ribs,
Dismount with the cry 'My Majestic King'.

"When you mourn at the tomb,
When you cry your hope out,
Your father will answer you 'Go Ahead, My Good Boy',
Wind will blow and sand will flow in clouds around the tomb.
The imposing manner will arouse your admiration,
It will be like the surging waves roar.

"This is what I must warn you of,
My honey, Semtay.
If your father's spirit blesses you,
You can fight the enemies bravely.
If the tomb does not make any sound,
It means the spirit does not allow you to go,
You need turn your horse and come back, do not let me worry!

"When you leave there and go ahead,
In Yuchykankoler valley,
By the side of a lake full of cyperus rotundus,
In deep Timurtao mountain,
There is an elder look forward to seeing you.

"He was your father's advisor,
He is Bakay Khan with extraordinary wisdom.
He and your father were friends that were ready to die for each other,
He is brave and agile sage Bakay,
He lives a life of a recluse in the deep mountain.

"He is waiting for you,
He always watches through his telescope.
Once you walk into the mountain he lives in,
He will appear in front of you right away.

"If your uncle comes to you happily,
You just take out the sheath to show him.
He will take you to find Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp,
You can clear the blood debt up with these three bastards.

"If you go by yourself without seeing your uncle first,
My baby Semtay, all by yourself,
You will suffer greatly.
The only son my king left,
If you do not find your uncle,
Do not mention the revenge,
Even your head is at risk.

"If you do not see Bakay waiting for you on the road,
My baby, do not go ahead on the journey by yourself.

"I tell you this with tears,
I wish you will have everything done smoothly.
You should remember all my words,
I wish that you have a glorious future.

"Just leave your mother here at ease,
My baby, as long as you are brave,
Persist in going ahead toward your father's land Talas,
You can get to the homeland in fifty days.

"Just leave your grandmother here at ease,
As long as you make great efforts, my boy,
Go ahead toward fertile and beautiful Talas,
You can get there in fifty days.

"This is your first time to leave home,
You will understand how important and valuable your horse is,
You move forward and go through hardships,
Then you will know the value of the fire.

"Once you step on the long journey of life,
You will cherish what I have told you,
You will understand and remember my words by heart.

"You will go on a long journey,
You are my smart boy,
You must remember my advice,
You will be safe and sound.

"I guess you will come back in a hundred days,
You have seen my tears,
Mom has endless words to say,
I believe you will remember them all.

"When you leave here and set out on your journey,
You will meet endless rising peaks,
You will see flood running down,
You will arrive at a place full of red deer,
Remember, do not chase these red deer,
You can catch up with them if you want.

"The running red deer will finally stop,
Do not hurt these red deer.
If you hunt the red deer,
The flood will run backwards to you.
Your worried mother and grandmother,
Will cry to death.

"You will meet the rolling hills,
You will arrive at a place full of rock goats,
Do not chase those rock goats,
You can catch up with them if you want.

"The rock goats will stop once they are tired,
Do not hurt these rock goats.
If you kill the innocent rock goats,
The Creator will order your mother and grandmother,
Wander and die,
In Timir castle."

Kanikai said in tears,
Warned him to walk on the small path.
Poor Kanikai,
Continued her talk:

"As long as you find Bakay Khan safely,
As long as you follow your uncle's instruction,
Everything you will do should turn smooth.
"If Bakay can meet you,
If you are lucky enough to arrive in Talas,

When you climb over Boto hill,
At Karabrachatkaler[1] valley,
You will see a rock like the bridge of the nose.

"Right on that black rock,
When your father was still alive,
Without knowing by anyone,
Your father carried gold, gemstone and agate,
With seventy single-hump camels,
Buried them there secretly.

"Between that rock and Talas,
There is one-day journey.
I once observed that rock carefully,
I was afraid that the gold would corrode,
So I left an air vent on the top of the mountain.

"I considered my only son would need in the future,
So I buried your gold for you.
I left an exit in advance,
Ordered craftsman carved on the rock.
I was afraid other people would find it,
So I piled much dirt at the entrance of the cave,
Planted a lot of trees there.

"All these things I did, my boy,
Are for you, Semtay.
I do not cherish my life, it will go away anyway,
I bustle for you all the time.

"Ayi Khan's son Kokbori,
Was your father's bosom friend,

He led your father a camel Kalaliok,
It is not an ordinary animal.

① Karabrachatkaler: Kirgiz language. It means black male camel valley.

"I guess the old camel Kalaliok may be very poor,
It is hard to figure out whether Kobosh is using it,
If it is loosed to the prairie,
It will stay on the hill at the entrance of the valley,
Wait for you there everyday.

"Although it is just an animal,
It has its magic that people do not know,
Maybe it cannot put up weight,
It cannot make its hill-size hump straight.

"Its eyes may be covered with leukoma,
Maybe Kanikai's guess is just ramblings.
But if my guess turns to be true,
It might lie down and be hard to get up.

"If you see Kalaliok crouching there,
Do not step across it dismissively.
'The lion's legacy Kalaliok,
Are you still healthy and safe?'
You should greet it politely.

"If the gold and treasure buried for you,
Are dug out by those guys,
Kalaliok will lament desolately to you.

"If your treasure is still there,
It will roll on the ground and play happily,
It will stretch its neck out,
Run to you with its humps swaying,
It will chase after you without fear.

"When it comes to you,
Do not make it sad,
You need tell it: 'I left home too many years,
I am coming for finding my homeland,

I am eagle Semtay.'

"As long as it hears your voice,
As long as it sees you, Semtay,
Its tears will flow like flood.
The old and muddled black camel,
Will be bursting with youthful energy,
It will lower its head and lament sadly,
It will direct you to the place where Bakay is living.

"When Kalaliok leaves you,
There will be a barking white dog coming to you,
The hunting dog Kumayk is born for hunting,
It will flow out at you.

"Now do not call it Kumayk,
Call it agile white hunting dog.
It will snarl and strike at you,
Before you take precautions against it,
It will chase your grey horse and not leave.

"You need to say 'Do not be wild and arrogant, my dear dog,
I am Manas' only son,
My name is Semtay.'
When it hears Semtay,
'It is the lion's son who is here.'
He will go to report the good news and ask for Suyinchy[1],
It will bark all the way toward the tomb.

"If you follow the dog,
You will arrive at a grand tomb,
That is your father Manas' tomb,
I built it with my extraordinary wisdom,
It is marvelous and it is splendid.

1 Suyinchy: Kirgiz language. It is the gift when the good news is reported.

"In order to praise the great achievements of the lions,
I asked the great craftsmen,
To carve their portrait on the wall.

"The elder with long white beard,
Sitting up straight on the white steed,
Is wise Bakay Khan.

"Behind Bakay Khan,
It is your heroic father Manas.

"He rides on Ackura steed①,
As lofty as Arat mountain.
He wears Akorlbok coat armor,
The front and the sleeves of the gown hang low to the side.

"All the armament you father had used,
Are all drawn on the wall.

"The drawn bow is a hundred and twenty meters long,
Ride on the mountain-size bay horse,
Halter in the hand is made of copper string,
Fierce hunting dog follows.
His expression is not normal.
It looks as vivid as life,
He is sage Koshaoyi Khan,
Everyone feels happy when they see it.

"There is a long spear in front of the saddle,
His redoubtable expression is more conspicuous.
He rides on Tilkezler steed②,
Sparks shine in the eyes,
People see him all feel scared.
He holds pen and ink in his hand,

① Ackura steed: Off-white horse. It is the name of Manas' horse in the epic.

② Tilkezler steed: Dark maroon horse. It is the name of Sirak's horse in the epic.

It means he is a learned Molerdo.
He and your father are brothers with same father,
He is your uncle Sirak.

"Leopard-like heroes,
All died in Beygin city.
Your poor mother Kanikai,
Remember all these heroes in the heart!
If they are all still alive,
How can it happen that we wander and have no home?"

"On the front wall of the tomb,
There are six Khans portrait, Muzburchak, Agersh,
Kelkokuler, YUrb, Senchybek and Toshtuk.
The story of these six Khans,
Was spread widely among the tribes.

"Behind these six heroes,
There is a separate portrait of a hero,
He wears a coat armor with blue embroidered edge,
Rides on a blue horse like a mountain,
That is Ayidar khan's son,
Renowned Kokcher Khan.

"On the left wall of the tomb,
The portrait on the wall shines like a moon,
His heart is as white as milk,
Speak justly, broad-minded,
Red beard and dignified.
Gold belts tied tight on his waist.

"He rides Sariala steed[①],
Wears gold string coat armor.
He can speak seventytwo languages,
Once he led your father,

① Sariala steed: Yellow horse. It is the name of Almanbet's horse in the epic.

Visited Beygin city.

"He has a heart of sage,
He put the gold throne down and left Beygin,
Fight against Karamark people,
He was pursuing the sacred equality.
There was no hope of success of his career,
He left his home and went to your father for shelter.
He is Almanbet Khan, Sorandick Khan's son.

"Beside Almanbet,
The man rides on Koktikai steed①,
Wears coat armor sewed with black strings.
Black eyes are very bright,
His manner is aristocratic.
His shout is earth-shaking,
It is like a burning ball in the battle.

"He started to go to battle since he was nine years old,
He followed your father all the time,
If enemies came and invaded,
He would rush ahead to fight.

"He killed too many malicious enemies,
'I killed!' he never boasted,
He always counted the achievements to your father.
He also killed lots of heroes,
He never praised himself 'I killed!'
He gave the credits to Manas.

"He never draws the spear he poked out back,
He drank enemies' blood like drinking water,
He never fears enemies and flies in the face of danger,
He is Barita's son, commander Chuwak.

① Koktikai steed: It is a horse like wild cyan goat. It is the name of Chuwak's horse in the epic.

"Watch continually,
Behind Chuwak,
It is the portrait of clever and fluent Ajibayi.
He rides on Kartkuron steed①,
He is towered like a mountain.

"He wears otter skin hat and otter skin cloak,
He dresses himself more beautiful than girls.
He can speak more than seventy languages,
Erudite and well informed,
Among Kirgiz who wear white felt hats,
No one could compare with him on knowledge.

"He was your father's envoy,
He traveled a lot of places from south to north.
He never felt constrained in front of Khan,
Always stated his opinions eloquently.

"He once was Khan of six tribes,
He is renowned Ajibayi.
He did not grab grass from sheep mouth②,
He is honest and eloquent Ajibayi.

"Write down on the white paper,
All your father's achievements,
Sing with sonorous voice,
Elaman's son, the singer Erchy③ Wuler,
I will paint him on the wall.

① Kartkuron steed: The name of the steed. It is a brown horse. It is the horse of Ajibayi and it is a famous horse in the epic.

② Not grab grass from sheep mouth: It is a common analogy in Kirgiz language. It means not rush to speak, not overstep one's bounds, not force others to do what he is unwilling to do and not fight for assuming interests.

③ Erchy: Folk singer. It also can be translated as epic singer and the person who can write songs. Erchy Wuler is the most famous singer in the epic. He is also the creator and singer of Manas.

"My baby, you must worship their spirits!
I have hid your father's body,
At a place no other people know."

Kanikai cried and talked,
Limp and weak.
Qierdy was overwhelmed with grief,
People who heard the words also cried loudly.

Born-clever man,
Born-extraordinary Semtay,
Was emotionally touched,
He comforted his mother:

"My mother, do not be sad,
I can find the homeland, I will not lose my way,
The homeland my father left,
I must take it back to us.

"I will fight everyone who challenges me,
I will clear the blood debt with those ruffians.
I will go through the places out of the way day and night,
I will try my best to return in one hundred days.
As long as I can live safely,
For those bastards having committed crimes,
I will let none of them off.

"Your advice and warning,
I will remember every word of them clearly in my mind.

"You are worried that I will kill deer and goats once I see them,
Enjoy being a hunter and forget my purpose.
Mother, please be at ease,
I will not stir my horse for hunting.

"There are wild deer at the corner,

The lonely person has his own sadness.
How can I act like a happy person,
Go and hunt deer on my own way?

"Mother, you are waiting for me here,
How I can go and enjoy myself?
If I see the rock goats on hills,
How can I go and shoot them just for my fun?

"Mother, you wander at an alien land,
How I can stroll about and have fun?
Along the river bank and go upward,
I will go directly on my journey day and night.

"As long as God bestows me with power,
Mother, your naughty son,
Will not hunt rock goats,
I must come back and share the success with you."

The mother and the son bade farewell,
The strong young lion hero,
Stirred his horse and galloped to the distance.

Semtay Met Bakay

Semtay bade farewell to families and mounted his horse,
He did not stop at all.
He whipped his horse forward day and night,
Rising dust followed him all the way along.

Whipped his off-white horse hard,
Sweat flowed down the horse legs.
The lion's son, Semtay,
Galloped forward like wind.

He did not have a company with him,
He galloped his horse down the road fearlessly,
He was alone by himself,
But it seemed he led a powerful army.

If you look at that naughty boy,
He did not show any fear,
He acted like too many heroes around him,
And they galloped ahead in the wilderness together.

The black coat armor was shining,
The young tiger sped on in the mountain.
The young hero Semtay,
Was right at the age of experiencing challenges.

He galloped ahead like an arrow,
He deserved to be called the pride offspring of the leopard.
He was worried but angry,

He passed the place called Yuchykayin[①] finally.

By the side of the lake full of cyperus rotundus,
At the lakeside full of Shabur grass,
It was the pasture his father Manas once lived.
Tens of thousands of mares were tied there,
The gold posts to tie the mares in the pasture,
Now had been covered with thick dust.

Semtay watched the place ahead carefully,
"This is the place mother Kanikai mentioned,
It is my father's hometown!"
He said to himself.

When he arrived in this place,
Young black mane wolf Semtay,
Drifted off course as expected.

There was no sign of human habitation,
He ran left and right and fifty days passed.
Bozdrorko[②] steed under him,
Was exhausted with staggering steps.

He passed a few villages on the way,
He supplemented feed.
For this lucky boy,
What God bestowed him was beyond expectation.

He galloped ahead without any rest,
Was this the homeland Talas?
Many dense wooden lands,
Which of them was the homeland of his father Manas?
Exhausted Semtay and his steed,

① Yuchykayin: Kirgiz language. It means three silver birches, but it refers to the name of the place here.

② Bozdrorko: Turquoise horse.

Did he arrive at Aoboler?
Finally he arrived in vast Talas,
In plain Talas,
By the bank of running river,
At Yuchykoshaoyi mountain pass,
In the upper Barikoler lake,
He saw the grand tomb of his father,
It stood tall and upright like a hill.

The steed ran quickly as the wind,
Little stones kicked up by the hooves flew around,
Made a sound like the fierce wind.
The black mane wolf got close soon,
He dismounted and came up to his father's tomb,
Cried his father in sorrow.

"Father, you left the world long ago,
Your kid was so little, I regret for not seeing you.
I was too young to fight back for the rebellion,
I had to go to another place for shelter with my mother!"

Seeing the marvelous white tomb,
The black mane wolf was extremely grieved,
Cried: "My dear father",
Complained his hardships.

He supported his right ribs with his hand,
Shouted "My father, in the heaven",
Bent over and threw himself on the ground.
He supported his left ribs with his hand,
Shouted "My Suritang father",
Tears wetted the dirt under him.

He loosed the halter right away,
Let Bozdrorko steed off,
He bowed down with great grief,
Cried his sorrows:

"Ah, my father, you left me,
I pray to your spirit,
Please bless me safe and healthy,
Please listen to my heart!"

He mourned and worshiped the spirit,
Before he finished praying,
Right at the moment, from the white tomb,
A gust of wind blew,
Airstream spun with whistling sound,
Roared up to the sky.

Young black mane wolf Semtay,
As if heard the call of the heroes,
He felt excited from the bottom of his heart.
He prayed to God,
Toward his father's tomb,
He rushed and stepped in.

He watched the portrait of his late father:
Strong and tall father Manas,
A great and incomparable hero.
He was a hero blessed by God,
He was a tiger shedding his blood for the justice,
Rode on Achura steed,
Shone white light,
He was painted on the front wall of the tomb.

On the left of the tomb,
It was Sorandick Khan's son Almanbet,
He left his hometown Beygin for his dignity,
He escaped from Karamark people's rule and came here.

Ark Berita Khan's son Chuwak,
He was a fearless warrior,
He never took the spear he thrust back.
He held pen and ink in his hand,

He was learned uncle Sirak.
Almanbet, Chuwak and Sirak,
They were all distinguished heroic Khans,
All of them,
Were painted on the wall vividly.

Sariala steed,
Was Almanbet's steed.
Right beside him,
Two lions Muzburchak and Koshaoyi,
Were painted valiant and heroic in bearing.

The young black mane wolf Semtay,
Watched one by one,
The portraits painted on the wall of the tomb.

He turned and ran out when he finished watching them,
He said to himself: "They all did not die,
They are all alive in my heart!"

He saw his father's portrait,
Young Semtay was so excited.
He untied his steed from the post,
Mounted his steed,
Galloped to the place afar.

He climbed over the hill,
Came to Alemalubrak,
Then climbed over Shonkar hill,
Semtay marched forward on the rugged mountain road.

Many thoughts passed through his mind,
Went ahead and thought.
Suddenly a barking dog,
Sprang out to him.
He did not feel scared at all,
He said he was the son of the leopard.

The dog became meek right away,
Followed him and waved its tail.
It was his father's beloved dog,
The dog knew he would come as expected.

It barked and followed him,
It did not care anything around.
When young Semtay continued on his journey,
The dog recognized him and followed him.

The white hunting dog,
Was called Kumayik,
In the past years,
It was pampered by the elders.

The white dog followed him tightly,
They came to the center of the dense woods.
The black camel Manas left,
Was crouching on the opposite hill.
The old camel was sad for missing its master,
Its eyes were covered with leukoma,
Its hair was covered with dust,
It showed a decrepit appearance.

When the camel heard the noise from horse hooves,
It whined and stood up.
How it knew that was Semtay,
The camel thought: "Where does the thief come from?
He tries to steal the treasure buried here",
So it spat its white saliva on the ground,
Lunged at Semtay.

Semtay recognized the camel at once,
He thought Kanikai had told him,
It was right his black camel.
Then Semtay talked to the camel:
"Black camel, you are afflicted,

It is leukoma that covers your eyes,
My name is Semtay,
I come from afar to look for my fellow people!"

The black camel got excited about his words,
It just frisked like a baby camel.
It touched the ground with its head again and again,
It would not leave but stay close by his side.

Let me put this aside,
Let's sing from Bakay Khan.

Waited patiently and expected all the time,
Experienced and knowledgeable Bakay Khan,
Lived in seclusion deep in Timur mountain,
Let the song began from them two met each other.

Day after day, year after year,
Bakay counted on his fingers every year:
"It has been nine years since Semtay left,
He now has grown into a young hero."
He got a lot of news from Saritaz,
He knew Semtay would come back soon.

Old Bakay climbed on the top of the black hill,
Watched through his telescope around.

He knew clearly there would be a day like this,
He waited anxiously everyday.

On the opposite hill to Timur mountain,
He sat down from time to time and stood up and watched.
Weak and feeble Bakay,
Held his telescope and came to watch again today.
Suddenly, he found a black spot far away,
He thought: "This might be my kid",
Bakay got racing thoughts in his mind immediately,

Tears ran down his face.

Bakay wiped his eyes blurred with tears,
Watched again carefully,
The lens focused on the coming person,
He saw clearly the horse first.

Bakay felt an upsurge of emotion,
His cold heart had waited so many years,
Suddenly he was so excited.

He whipped his short-tail purple horse,
Galloped forward as fast as he could,
Experienced Bakay Khan,
Arrived by the side of Semtay in an instant.

Although he had not seen Semtay for years,
It was like family members that saw everyday.
Although Semtay had never seen Bakay Khan before,
He had a feeling that he lived with the uncle everyday.

He came up and greeted his uncle politely,
His agile posture was like an eagle that was ready to be loosed:
"Uncle, when you see me from a distance,
You whipped your horse toward me right away,
It seems you have a lot to tell me,
My noble uncle!
Why do you burst into tears like this?"

Bakay opened his mouth and asked:
"Boy, where are you from?"
Bakay pretended he knew nothing,
He wanted to sound out how ambitious Semtay would be.
Bakay said to himself,
He wanted to test the boy out.

Semtay responded him:

"Uncle, please listen to me,
My heroic father died unfortunately,
My grandmother and mother suffered a lot,
They were humiliated badly.

"In order to protect me, the orphan,
My old grandmother and amiable mother,
Went far away for a shelter.
Until I am twelve years old,
My mother did not mention anything about my father and enemies.

"One day, I rode a horse and played with my friends,
Till our horses were sweating,
We shouted and played happily,
I rode horse, hunted, loosed dog and eagle,
Played without having any sadness,
My happy voice resounded on the plain grassland.

"Then I knew from other people,
My father is lion Manas,
Diligent Nuoyi people are my fellow villagers.

"Since my subjects are still far away from me,
How I can live there shamelessly.
I follow my mother's advice,
I come and look for my homeland immediately.

"Uncle, you are a respectable elder,
You live in this world faithfully.
An orphan lost father like me,
I should know the revenge and defend the dignity!

"My mother Kanikai warned me again and again,
She said you are wise and have a good source of information,
She said you will welcome me on my way,
She said you will pretend you know nothing and test me.

"I see your eyes are as clear as the spring,
You test me with full of expectation,
You are the uncle my mother told me,
Please allow me to talk straightly."

Bakay began to talk fondly:
"My dear kid Semtay,
How I can stop worrying about you!
My poor kid,
In order to protect your mother and you to leave safely,
I saw you off for a half-day journey.

"I sent two leather bags of horse milk,
I gave them two mares for them to ride.
When we said goodbye at Aorto Aerk hill,
I presented my sheath as a gift to them.

"Where is the sheath? Let me see it,
Then I will be sure who you are!
If you are Semtay, my noble kid,
I will serve for your father's faith all my life.

The little black mane wolf Semtay,
Was just twelve years old,
It was like the lucky star descended over his head.
"Uncle, this is your sheath!"
Semtay presented the sheath with both hands deferentially.

Bakay saw the sheath,
He could not help his tears flowing down,
He dismounted and came up in an instant.
Facing Bakay Khan,
As fast as an arrow,
Semtay also came up to him.

The old man embraced Semtay in his arms,
Tears ran down like the spring.

He frowned but felt excited,
Started to pour out how he missed her:

"My kid, do you live safely?
When I am thinking of you, you come to me.
Do you know how much I suffered for you?

"My kid, are you healthy?
How many hardships do you endure on the way?
My dear beacon!
You make the worries in my heart disappear.

"When I see your figure,
How can I not whip my horse to go faster?
I sent Saritaz to find out your information,
I expected for your return everyday.

"I expect, I wait,
Like a baby in the wilderness,
I talk to myself all the time and always forget myself,
Just for waiting for you to return.

"I have no way to complain my grief,
I am anxious and wait for you.
After your father Manas died miserably,
Aweikai, Kobosh and other bastards,
Humiliated me outrageously.

"I keep myself alive disgracefully,
I wandered in wilderness and herded camels,
I climbed lofty mountains in pain.

"In your father Manas' time,
I followed him and served as his courtier.
I accompanied him day and night,
He discussed everything with me.

"I was his advisor,
Forty warriors were under my command.
My bosom friend Manas,
I obeyed every of his words.
I expected you to come back early,
The missing tortures my life day and night.

"Among Kankoler mountains,
I meet you here today as I expected.

"When your father Manas was still alive,
I was free and respected,
I rode on my steed to patrol and play around.
But after majestic Manas died,
I was forced to leave home and humiliated.

"When my friend Manas was alive,
I was free and respected.
After Khan Manas died,
I suffered a lot.

"You wandered to the place of Tirmi,
I, Bakay, was left here like a lonely bird.

"My beloved baby, Khans' only son,
You ran to Kara Khan's palace for shelter.
Your mother took you at the risk of her life,
Let you avoid the disaster and grow up safely.
Under the clutches of those devils,
I lived a miserable life.

"I prayed for seeing you earlier everyday,
My heart is unshakable all the time.
I prayed to God for your health faithfully,
And prayed to God for seeing you.
I am quite content, Semtay,
I can meet you here today,

I will have no regret anymore!"

Smart Semtay suggested Bakay:
"Dear uncle, do not cry,
No other heroes could compare with you.
You have sacrificed a lot,
Do not let your tears run down like a baby.

"Uncle, do not be sad anymore,
I am full of confidence with your encouragement."
The sensible kid did not let Bakay notice,
That he tried hard not to cry with hatred.

Bakay calmed down gradually,
As seeing Semtay's return,
The worry and grief in his heart for many years,
Now disappeared.

He led Semtay,
Returned to the place he lived.

The lion's son Semtay,
Was very happy after he met his uncle.
Semtay and Bakay Khan,
Galloped in the plain shoulder to shoulder.

The only son of the lion,
Was considered as a bosom friend of Bakay.
Bakay took him off the horse,
They sat on the colorful felt,
Talked with each other about their thoughts.

Bakay butchered a fat colt immediately,
To treat the kid who just came exhausted.
He called a famous chef in,
Boiled the colt meat in a big pot.

Manas always came and had party when he was alive,
It was a big wooden basin used to hold the meat.
Bakay kept the basin as a treasure,
It was still like a new one.

Since Khan Manas passed away,
He never used the basin again.
Now the lion's boy came to his home,
Bakay took the basin out.
Cooked the colt meat,
And held all the meat in the basin.

Cut wild onion as sauce,
Stirred thick salt water,
Put them all in bowls,
Placed each of them well.

In order to rest the boy's power,
To test his ability,
Bakay sat aside and watched him silently.

The young tiger Semtay,
Did not decline at all,
Threw the meat in his mouth with both hands,
All meat was gone in an instant.

He did not lose his dignity,
Everyone at presence was surprised at his heroic manner.

Bakay watched him carefully,
He witnessed the extraordinary spirit of Semtay,
"He is not inferior to his father",
He praised Semtay by the side silently.
The boy was exhausted on the long journey,
He felt sleepy after he got full with delicious colt meat,
In order to let him recover earlier,
They accommodated him in a quiet place.

Grandfather Jagurp Poisoned Semtay

At dawn next morning,
At Bakay's home,
Kirgiz herdsmen lived nearby,
All came and gathered there.

At the breakfast time,
By the side of table cloth,
Respected elder Bakay,
Pushed Semtay to the front of all those people.
Told them the detailed story of the past.

After the breakfast,
He ordered to saddle the horse immediately,
They were going to clear their debt,
With Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp Khan.

Semtay mounted his horse,
Let Bakay Khan lead the way in the front.
When he thought about his father,
Semtay could not stop from bursting into tears.

We wish God bless this young man,
Wish him to fulfill what he wants to do.
The king Manas left an only son in the world,
I will continue the story if you want to know more.

When they got close to Jagurp Khan's Ayinla,
Bakay said to Semtay:
"My boy, you stay here and wait patiently,

Let me go first and find out the actual situation,
Get to know your grandfather's thinking,
See whether he is missing you or not.

"He is a bad guy with full of craft and cunning,
Let me find out whether he has a plot."

Bakay explained,
And young Semtay waited him there.
Bakay Khan whipped his horse,
Marched toward Jagurp's palace.

Kanikai and her mother-in-law's running away,
Made Jagurp doubt that it was Bakay who helped them.
Since then till now,
Bakay never came to see Jagurp.
He had not seen Jagurp for years,
They did not even drink tea together.

Now Semtay came back to him,
Bakay came for the first time in years,
He greeted Jagurp on purpose,
Let me start the story from here.

"No meeting, no greeting,
Years just passed in a blink of an eye,
I have not seen you for years,
How are you doing, Jagurp Khan?
I come to tell you a good news today.
Do not you give me money for the good news?

"I have found your grandson,
Semtay is going to visit you,
You can give yourself a relief from the missing.
It is the offspring Manas left,
He is my tiger-like young hero.
He comes from afar and it is a surprise to you,

Do you want to see and welcome him sincerely?

"The dead kid comes back suddenly,
Do you have doubts in your mind?
Do you feel it is hard to say you do not welcome him?
The kid left you for many years and returns home now,
Do you really miss him?
The kid fighting against you now returns home,
Do you have other plans already?"

Bakay was talking,
And walking to the front of Jagurp's palace,
Right at the moment,
Jagurp Khan fully exposed his ferocious features,
He shouted like an evil devil:

"You let my daughter-in-law off,
Now you come and lie again arrogantly.
You said they went to Kara Khan for a shelter,
You are the accomplice, you such an old and useless slave,
How you dare come and ask me money for the good news!

"You said you would find my grandson back for me,
But it was you that made me suffered from missing him.
Semtay is the flesh and blood of my family,
How you can let others raise him.

"You let my vicious daughter-in-law Kanikai off,
Sent her to Kara Khan's tribe.
Bad things you have done are more than alhagi,
You are more malicious than venomous snake!

"My grandson has grown up,
It is natural he come back to his grandfather.
Bring my grandson to me as soon as possible,
Why do you leave him out in the wilderness?

"Bring him back to me soon,
Maybe he hates his stubborn mother.
As long as Manas' son comes back to me,
I will have no regret to God!"

He did not betray his feeling in front of Bakay,
Shouted his complaints as if he suffered from injustice:
"Bakay, go back soon, do not delay,
Bring my grandson to me soon."

Hot-tempered Jagurp became agitated,
Bakay stepped out of the palace right away.
He untied his horse from the post,
He had already had doubt in his heart.

He rode on his short-tail purple horse and went ahead,
The doubt made him stop going forward.
He tied his horse by the side of the hill,
He sneaked back to the palace.

He opened the bottom felt of the palace,
Wise elder Bakay,
Listened what was talking in the palace.
Jagurp said to himself like this:
"I need kill Semtay as early as I can,
Otherwise there will be big trouble."

He shouted exasperatedly:
"Ayi, Bakdolet[①],
Come here soon and listen to me:
I heard damned Semtay has come back,
He is coming to get his father's money back.
If we do not kill him,
We cannot keep our life as good as now.

① Bakdolet: She is Qierdy's servant and Jagurp's second wife and mother of Aweikai and Kobosh.

"You, my wife, and your two sons,
He will not see you with his eyes.
The little bastard left by Manas,
He must destroy all of us.

"He will make an incredible disaster,
He will plunder and wipe out like a devil,
He will take his treasure and property back.
He will take his Ayinla back,
Your two sons are free as birds now,
They will be cut and killed.

"When Bakay and Semtay come later,
I must kill them.
Bakay hides himself in Timur mountain,
He is a great man,
I must destroy him.

"Semtay is Manas' only son,
He must be a ball of burning flames,
If we do not destroy him completely,
Do not mention our happiness,
Even our offspring will be sent to the hell.

"You take out the porcelain bowls that Khitan people gave you,
Wash them with water,
Then pour the poison and strong wine in,
You must put in enough poison,
Then propose a toast to Semtay and let him drink up.

"Now you arrange someone to watch in front of the door,
To see if they are coming."

He took out Tishabolot[①] he collected,

① Tishabolot: It is the name of a poison. It means people will die once they touch it.

Put it in the wine and stirred.

Jagurp Khan was in a great bustle,
He arranged in a hurry which he thought was perfect.

The figure was gentle and graceful like a sheath,
The heart was kind like a fairy,
The skin was white like peeled onion,
Khan's wife Bakdolet,
Found an excuse and refused to do what he said.

She cursed Jagurp as she was unwilling to follow his order:
"You such a damned old fool,
You are so ruthless and shameless.
He is your own grandson,
How do you have the heart to poison him to death?
He will die in an instant once he drinks it,
He has suffered too much these years!"

Bakdolet burst into tears,
Jagurp did not care her words at all.
He beat and kicked her and threatened,
Forced her to put the poison into the wine.

Jagurp shouted crazily,
"I will skin you off if you do not follow my order,
You such a useless fool wife,
I will divorce you if you do not listen to me!"

Bakay hid outside of the palace,
Heard everything and remembered,
After he heard all of their talk,
He sneaked out quietly.

When he got to the side of his horse,
He mounted immediately,
And galloped toward Semtay,

Reported what he had heard just now.

He told Semtay everything,
That he just heard outside of the palace,
Then they marched forward to Jagurp's palace.

"Oh, my boy, we go to your grandfather's,
He will put on an interesting play.
He wants to take our lives,
We need to be very cautious.

"When we get to his palace,
He will take out a bowl of water,
He will pour poisoned wine in the other bowl.
When he hands the water to me,
I will drink it immediately.

"Your grandfather sits in the honor seat,
If he puts the poisonous wine in a porcelain bowl,
You should present the bowl to him in an instant.
If he refuses to drink it,
You just pour it to the dog trough outside of the door."

Bakay told him the countermove,
Then he led Semtay,
Galloped toward Jagurp's palace.

Hearing the pressing sound of hooves,
Jagurp went out of the door to welcome his grandson:
"Ah, my beloved colt,
You went to a place far away,
I keep missing you all the time.

"My colt, do you grow up?
Your vicious and stubborn mother,
Took you to a strange place.
Now you come back to me safely,

How happy I am now!

"My dear boy,
Your foolish mother,
Took you to a desolate and strange place,
Since you have come to me,
You make my anxiety disappear.

"My boy, your living condition,
Always made me worried!
The only son, when you are back,
I feel so grateful to God.

"You are the only son the lion left!
I will leave this world soon,
Your coming makes me very happy!
Come on in, my boy,
Bakay, take him inside now."

Jagurp opened the door by himself to welcome them,
He pretended he was very happy.
In order to hide his intention of poisoning Semtay to death,
Did not let his plot be noticed by anyone in Ayinla.

Bakay and Semtay,
Stepped in Jagurp's palace.

Once Jagurp stepped in.
He shouted loudly with an evil look:
"Oh, Bakdolet,
The boy is hungry and thirsty after the long journey,
Take out the wine and meat to welcome him,
Give to my dear boy to eat and drink!

"You have known it just now,
Are you ready, my wife,
Take the water out to the elder Bakay,

Then take the horse milk wine in porcelain bowl,
To my grandson Semtay!"

Jagurp shouted loudly,
Bakdolet held the porcelain bowl with blue edge,
Came up to Bakay in humble reverence.
Bakay took over the bowl,
And drank the water.

Bakdolet were nervous and flustered,
She was not hardhearted enough to give Semtay that bowl,
She was at a loss and her hands shook unstoppably.
She held out another bowl.

"To my dear kid, the black mane wolf,
Pour the wine in that porcelain bowl.
You damned evil bitch,
How you can treat my grandson coldly.

"Why don't you take out that big porcelain bowl?
That is the bowl his father once used.
Pour the wine in that bowl and present to him."
Evil Jagurp,
Tried to cheat Semtay through his loud shout.

Bakdolet lost her mind,
She held the bowl in her hand in fear.
She looked at the boy in front of her with pity,
Her body and hands both shook,
She bent over and stepped forward with difficulty,
Stretched her arms out and gave the bowl to Semtay.

Semtay took the bowl over,
Acted as if nothing was on his mind,
He stood up and said with smile:
"Grandfather, you should drink first,
You are in front of me,

How I dare drink first!"
He sent the bowl to the front of Jagurp.

Cunning Jagurp said:
"Since your father left the world,
I had already stopped drinking,
Now, I am old and weak,
I should avoid drinking the strong liquor.

He suggested in a pity voice:
"Thank you, good boy,
You drink it, Semtay!"
Jagurp Khan shook his head,
He did not know young Semtay had known the ins and outs.

Looked at the poisoned wine in front of him,
The young man had an idea suddenly:
"For your grandson's respect to you,
Grandfather, please take the first sip!
If I drink before you,
I will not be the offspring of Kirgiz!" ①

Semtay held the wine bowl,
Handed it toward Jagurp's mouth.
The wine splashed out of the bowl,
Fell on Jagurp's beard.
At the moment the wine splashed on his beard,
His beard was burning immediately.

Semtay poured the wine into the dog trough,
As soon as the dog's nose touched the wine,
It fell on the ground,
Died in an instant with its mouth open.

1 In Kirgiz customs, children or younger people cannot drink horse milk or eat before the elders do, otherwise they will be considered as unfilial descendants.

When Semtay saw this,
He jumped up high.
He overturned the pile of bedding,
Pulled the coat armor out from the bottom of the bedding.
Bakay Khan shouted in haste:
"Take the bag too!"

Semtay was in a towering rage,
He threw the door open with a big noise,
Rushed out immediately.
The door was thrown forward,
And flew to the place one arrow could get.
Manas' son Semtay,
Showed his heroic manner and great strength.

He mounted his horse with rage,
He was in a towering rage,
Like the angry waves,
To his malicious grandfather,
He reprimanded:

"Jagurp, you will not die in your boots,
I will send you, a heartless damned man, into the hell!
You want to force me to drink the poisonous wine.
I will not drink it and be killed by you,
I will never let you off!"

Semtay shouted at the moment:
"Where are Aweikai and Kobosh?
Take your two sons,
Come and compete with me if you dare!

"You had already killed one infant for the sake of me,
Today you still want to kill me.
My inhumane grandfather,
All the cunning plots you planed on me,
Will descend over your head!"

The black mane wolf finished his talk,
Turned his horse from the right side,
Galloped toward the place where Aweikai was living.
Then he turned the horse from the left side,
Galloped toward the place where Kobosh was living.

"Let's go, uncle, we need go quickly!"
Semtay and Bakay galloped down the hill.
Two steeds, galloped fast,
Climbed over the mountains with sweat,
They made a shortcut,
Ran as fast as they could,
Toward the Ayinla of Aweikai and Kobosh.

Semtay Contested with Aweikai and Kobosh for the First Time

When they got close to Ayinla,
Old Bakay said:
"How dangerous it is, my dear kid,
How I dare ignore your safety!
My baby, Semtay,
How I can stop worrying for you!

"Do not worry, you just wait here,
Let me go first to find out the real situation.
Your uncles Aweikai and Kobosh,
Do they miss you really?

"Maybe they think the guy that can compete them has come,
Have they made plans for fighting back?
You left when you were little and come back now,
Does any fellow villager still remember you?
Does anyone believe the boy died many years ago comes back?
Do they have doubts and feel scared?

"The woods grow by the river bank,
Are they willow trees or birch trees?
Do they consider the boy that comes from nowhere,
Is going under other's name?
Are there fellow villagers to show their sympathy?
Does anyone feel dissatisfied with your coming back?
Does anyone think the same as your grandfather Jagurp,
That hates you very much in his heart?"

Bakay finished his words,

He whipped his horse and galloped away.

He arrived at the Ayinla of Aweikai and Kobosh,
Held his horse in front of their door.
Bakay shouted loudly:
"Aweikai! Kobosh! Are you at home?"

Those two Khans were in the palace,
One was playing the game "Take Palace",
The other was playing Chatlash chess①,
They were in the world of their games.

"Are there anybody home?"
Bakay asked again,
But again no one answered.

People elected Kobosh as Boz② leader,
To take charge of the drinking game.
For the shouting outside,
People all felt scared.

Bakay saw a little kid at the door,
"Kid, please tell me,
Is Aweikai at home?"
Bakay asked the kid on his horse,
The kid laughed and ran into the house.

The kid laughed after going into the house,
People inside were all surprised:
"Why are you laughing, little kid?"
The little kid told them the reason:

① Chatlash chess: It is the traditional Kirgiz folk chess game. There are sixteen pieces in each side. The black and white pieces are arranged and moved on the board to win the game, which is like Chinese Chess.

② Boz: It is one kind of traditional fermented Kirgiz beverage that they made by themselves.

"There is an old man on a horse,
He asked 'Is Aweikai at home',
Let me come in and call him out.
He called on his horse,
The old man did not know the courtesy."

Aweikai was quite wise to the ways of the world,
He smelt out the flavor of a storm:
"The person shouted on his horse,
It must be Bakay."
He rushed to the door immediately.

Heard the call from Bakay,
Kobosh made a rapid calculation:
"What is Bakay coming for?"
Damned Kobosh was in a great rage,
He rushed out of the palace.

Aweikai got out and asked:
"Senior, respectable Bakay,
My noble uncle,
Did you get some news?
What are you worrying for?
Respectable Bakay,
Do you live healthily and happily?"

Bakay responded:
"Aweikai, Kobosh, two Khans,
Are you two healthy and happy?
Semtay is coming to visit you,
Do you two still love him?

"Do you think the kid had died long ago?
Does anyone still remember him?

"He left here long ago and comes back now,
Do you wait for him?

Or you think your enemy is coming,
And prepare to defeat him?
Or you consider him as Manas' son,
Does anyone want to hold the flag for him?"

Heard the questions from Bakay,
Kobosh felt anxious and alarmed,
He became angry from shame,
And he was ready to raise a big stink.

Kobosh was boiling with rage,
He shouted like roaring flood:
"You, Bakay, are such a fool,
What nonsense are you talking about?
Look, I am going to take care of you now!

"It is nonsense that Semtay is coming back,
How dare you start the rumor?
You are too old, you only need to keep yourself alive,
Do not come here and make the trouble!

"He has been dead for too many years,
You dare say he is coming back,
How you dare make the story out of nothing!"

Damned Kobosh stamped with great rage,
He lifted his pole and rushed up,
Knocked Bakay's head severely,
Bakay's head was broken right away,
And he fell off his horse.

A piece of his head skin was hanging aside,
His eyes sparked with stars.
He only could pray to God,
He squatted with great pain.

Right at this crucial moment,

Aweikai came and panted for breath,
When he saw Bakay was bleeding on the head,
He rebuked Kobosh harshly:
"You act like a crazy dog,
You always hurt people and talk wildly,
You never listen to the suggestions,
You always make a fool of yourself.
You are as stupid as an animal,
You never feel good if you do not do something bad.

"My respectable uncle,
We are as intimate as brothers.
God must punish Kobosh,
As long as we unite,
God will grant us treasure.

"Stupid Kobosh is mean,
Do not lower yourself to the same level as his.
My dear uncle, I am willing to sacrifice my life,
To help anytime and anywhere.

"Broken head is in the hat,
Broken hand is in the sleeve,
We have the same ancestor,
We should be in one family.

Aweikai said comforting words,
Invited uncle Bakay to his house.
Washed the blood on his head,
Cleaned the injury on Bakay's head carefully,
Then bandaged with white cloth.

Poured tea in the bowl with honey in it,
Put all kinds of delicious food on table cloth,
All food smelt good,
He treated Bakay well to apologize.

Satiated with food and tea,
After entertaining Bakay eagerly,
Aweikai talked more politely,
He was trying to cover the plot in his mind:

"Born-smart Kanikai,
She learned more than sixty skills,
She is proficient in languages of six tribes,
Maybe her trick is too magical,
If not how can Semtay come back to life?
He has been dead for too many years.

"You said Semtay has come back,
Maybe he will come to the homeland.
Do not delay, set out now,
Bring Semtay back home now.

"He is the only son of my late big brother,
Let us serve him solemnly,
Let us unite and fight against enemies together.
I will butcher sixty mares,
I will wisely let him clear his hatred in the heart.
I will let him be Khan,
I will work for him and protect him.
I will let sixty tribes' Argen①,
Let all Nuoyi people be his subjects.

"Please go and take him back soon,
Do not let him be scared again.

"My respectable uncle,
I will take good care of him,
Otherwise it will be a shame for me.
You'd better comfort him,
Do not leave any hatred in his heart.

① Argen: It was the name of a Kirgiz tribe.

Do not say any bad luck words,
Do not make him hesitate and doubt."

After hearing Aweikai's words,
Bakay responded like this:
"My kid, Aweikai,
I observed from the appearance of Semtay,
He is as strong and tall as his father!

"But, Aweikai,
He is a spoiled kid,
He has full of hatred in his heart.
He is brought up far away from his homeland,
He is inferior to you in every aspect,
This is your nephew's situation now.
I asked him to come but he refused,
He is a strange and coward person."

Bakay mounted his horse as he finished his words,
Let Kokcholok① galloped forward,
Toward where Semtay was waiting,
He came up to Semtay in an instant.

Semtay said at the moment:
"My dear uncle,
You went out at dawn and come back at dusk,
Are they busy enjoying themselves?
Are they surprised how a dead kid can come back?
Does anyone among them still miss me?
Do they talk nonsense?
Do they still feel angry toward me?

"Do they think their enemy is coming?
Have they prepared for a fight?
I know what kind of person they are,

1 Kokcholok: It is a short-tailed black horse. It is also a famous horse in the epic.

They are all cunning and malicious."

Bakay said angrily:
"When lion Manas was still alive,
Why did not I die?
In order to protect your father's achievements,
I did not fear of death!
I always expect when the orphan comes back,
I am waiting for you day and night.

"Today I went to report the news,
Told them Semtay has come back,
Aweikai pretended he welcomes you,
Kobosh burned with a great rage.

"He stamped with rage and talked wildly,
He beat me off my horse,
With his pole,
I am suffered from his humiliation today.

"Aweikai pretended to be friendly and ease the situation,
Cheated me with sweet words.
But he does not regret for his past crime at all,
I see clearly the real nature of him.
This is the reason I come back late,
This is my cold experience today.

"My dear colt,
You should remember my words carefully,
Although Aweikai showed his respect to me,
It is impossible to hide his ambition.

"You should calm down on everything, Semtay,
Do not act like a hot-tempered lion.
When facing Aweikai and Kobosh,
Do not be careless and misled.

"I am always waiting for you to grow up,
You cannot act like a naïve and unsteady child,
Some people harbors an evil heart,
I must remind you before you meet them."
Heard old Bakay's warning,
Semtay mounted his horse right away,
Followed Bakay and marched forward.

One old and one young heroes came for revenge,
Whipped their horses and went shoulder to shoulder.
They arrived to the front of Khan's palace in an instant,
Now it was Aweikai and Kobosh's home.

People gathered outside of the palace,
Aweikai came up and said:
"My dear boy, how are you?"
He apologized and begged for mercy to Semtay.
Helped Semtay dismount warmly,
Put thick carpet under Semtay's feet.

All the people rushed up,
Embraced Semtay warmly.
Held the face of Semtay,
Came up to kiss and greet him one by one.

The lion's son Semtay,
Facing Aweikai and Kobosh,
Was neither humble nor arrogant,
That was the situation when the uncle and nephew met.

At the moment he saw Semtay,
The maniac Kobosh's heart,
Was almost jumped out of his body.
He recalled his despicable acts in those years,
He felt scared in his heart and blurred in his eyes.

All the evildoings he did to Kanikai,

Appeared in front of his eyes,
He was suddenly scared out of his wits,
His panic was incredible.

Aweikai started with his sweet words:
"My dear nephew Semtay,
Do not worry and annoy anymore.
You come back safe and sound,
Do you miss us all the time?

"Now you come back healthily,
Do you always think about us?
You come back to look for us finally,
we appreciate your affection.

"You come to my home for finding me,
We are satisfied with what you are doing.
I saw you in my dream last night,
You come to my home today,
The good dream comes true, Semtay,
We feel so excited and surprised."

Kobosh and Aweikai,
Felt scared and shocked,
Semtay, whom they killed many years ago,
Now came and stood in front of them healthily.

Semtay was neither humble nor arrogant,
He watched with his sharp eyes,
The play of Aweikai and Kobosh.

When they saw the young man's prestige,
Aweikai and Kobosh were scared out of their wits.
They could not cover their shocking eyes up,
Then put their hands on their chests and flattered.

Semtay talked harshly:

"Aweikai, Kobosh!
You committed towering crimes.
You robbed my property,
You took all my livestock.

"You humiliated my mother,
Made her suffer too much.
You were totally insane,
You even killed my substitute!

"You guys did unlimited evil things,
I know clearly each of them!
Whether you consider me as your brother[1],
It is your own business.

"Just go and call troops if you think I am your enemy,
Mount the horses and fight right away!"

After hearing what Semtay said,
Aweikai felt shivery and bowed to Semtay,
Crossed his hands and begged for his life:
"My dear Semtay,
It is my fault, please forgive me!

"I will not die in my boots if I tell lies,
If I am not faithful to you,
I will be sent into the hell!
I will die now if I have evil thinking to you,
And I will never see God!

"Smart and agile young falcon,
Never eats his meat up at one time.
Majestic Khan's son,
No matter what kind of things you meet,

1 Brother: It is Kirgiz custom. Uncle and nephew can call each other brother when the grandfather is alive.

Will never hold the grudge.

"White eagle hunts the game,
Never eats his meat up at one time,
The lion's wise son,
No matter what he meets,
Will never lose his nerve.

"Lion Semtay, I am willing to offer you fine horses,
I, Aweikai, am ready to die for you.
All the palaces your father left,
I will fix them and give them back to you.

"My dear boy,
Please listen to my words carefully,
I will call for craftsmen as soon as possible,
And repair your palace.

"Let the orchards blossom,
Let nightingales sing in the trees,
Let's carve pretty patterns in and out of the palace,
Let the world be surprised.

"My dear Semtay,
Please forgive me,
If do not forgive me,
Kill or cut, just do what you want!

"If you are not as tolerant as the falcon,
Then you just cut your uncle's head off!
Dear colt, you decide what you want to do to me."

Semtay said to them seriously:
"Do not say those sweet words to me, Aweikai.
Fix my palace as soon as possible,
Invite the craftsmen right away.

"Use the green paint,
Repair it as a new and splendid one,
Let the echo pleasant to the ears,
Let the flowers all blossom,
Let the cuckoos sing on the branches.

"You must finish it in one month,
I will move in in two months.
If you are true and pure in heart,
I will reward your affection.
But if you plot some evil secrets,
I will clear it out with you."

Semtay explained all he wanted to say,
Aweikai agreed all of them with fear:
"My lion Semtay!
I will follow your orders and do it one by one.

"I will repair your palace to be a new one,
I will order them to cut all poplar trees,
I will gather all skilled craftsmen,
Use colorful paint,
Decorate with all kinds of methods,
Paint the wall with lime,
I will let the repaired palace glitter,
Make it splendid and be the number one in the world,
Let everyone who sees it praise it.
My dear hero Semtay,
I will let you move back here as soon as possible,
It is the land Manas grew up."

Aweikai complied in appearance but opposed in heart,
He expressed the brotherhood volubly.
Bakay and Semtay,
Were invited into the white palace again.

Put the carpet and cushions out,

Spread the table cloth and put the delicious food on,
Took out the cheese and honey,
Made the tea with Samor[1].

Made milk tea with white porcelain pot,
Made the beverage for Semtay only.
Took out the horse milk wine,
Poured in the big bowls.
In order to fete Bakay and Semtay,
Butchered fat mare of empty embryo.

Dug the dirt stove and put the pot up,
Boiled horse intestines and meat,
Thick salt water used as the sauce,
Big wooden basin made the meat delicious.

Semtay and Bakay have lined and wined to Satiety,
They gave blesses to show their satisfaction,
Asked them to pack the tablecloth and silvers up,
Then loosed the horses to eat and drink,
They put their heads on pillows and went to good dreams.

The sky turned white in the east,
Stars faded gradually.
Colts on the plain started to neigh,
Black-eyebrow larks sang in the woods,
Sparrows by the road flew away,
And chirped on branches in orchards.

Stars in the night sky,
Were gone quietly.
When the morning came,
Bakay and Semtay,
Now turned and lifted their heads,
Stretched themselves and put their clothes on.

① Samor: It is the specified stove for making tea.

When they got washed,
Servants came up in a hurry,
Brought them tea and food.
Took out butter and cooked meat,
Took the jade bowls for drinking tea.

They enjoyed the food leisurely,
Aweikai came at this moment,
Feted them warmly.
Cut the horse intestines and the fat for them,
Handed black tea to them.

The wine held with precious Kokuri,
Filtered through fine cloth,
Let them drink to their hearts' content.
Just finished drinking this wine,
Horse milk wine was poured in the bowl.

Ate the honey in gourd,
Ate nang made with crème,
All the food presented,
They ate them all.

Semtay and Bakay,
Wiped their mouths and ordered:
"Do not bring more food to us,
We are full.

"Aweikai, listen carefully,
My father left all kinds of weapons,
Where are they? Take them all out."

When the tablecloth was packed up,
Aweikai stood up right away,
Served by the side of the young man,
Neither dare blink his eyes nor open his mouth.

He asked to put in front of them,
Ackelty iron gun,
Akorlbok coat armor,
Achalbaris sword,
Bulerturshun magic lash,
Crescent battleaxe and Sire spear,
Counted them one by one,
Then handed them to the young black mane wolf Semtay.

Checked and accepted the armament.
The young man was satisfactory,
He untied his horse,
Ordered to saddle his horse,
"I want to check my horses!"
Then mounted and set out with Bakay.

Set out from Aweikai's Ayinla,
It was beyond the schedule of the fleet horse,①
Clouds drifted in the blue sky,
Flocks of horses spread all over the unbounded prairie.

The young tiger Semtay,
Came up and watched carefully,
Twelve belaying ropes were set side by side,
Each colt had one course②,
Countless wealth connected the sky with the earth together.

For the property his father left,
Flocks of horses were the best.
In four seasons in Kankoler,

① One schedule of a fleet horse: Kirgiz people are used to calculate the distance between two places through the schedule of a racing horse. One schedule usually is about twelve to fitteen kilometers.

② Each colt had one course: One schedule of horse colt is about one and a half to two kilometers.

Horses were herded here.
All horses were strong and fat,
Herdsmen could ride them casually.

When Manas was alive,
He specially picked Buruler steed,
That was prepared for Semtay,
Only Bakay knew the story.
Bakay said:
"My boy, Semtay!
You go among the horses and look carefully,
Buruler horse your father left for you,
Now is fifteen years old,
You can go and pull it here!"

The flock of horses all had white hair mixed,
No single horse had an obvious difference or mark.
Among so many same color horses,
It was hard to distinguish Buruler.
Old Bakay was astonished,
He also had no idea.

All the horses crouched together,
Every of them was strong and fat,
They went and checked around,
They both could not find Buruler out.

As there was no help,
Old uncle Bakay,
Gave an idea:
"Let us drive all horses,
Drive them to the ropes that tie the colts,
Buruler must show some extraordinary characters,
We can catch it then."

Each of twelve belaying was long as one colt journey.
Crowded wranglers shouted and surrounds the horses with belaying ropes.

"Are there any horses in the valley?"
Semtay asked.
Aweikai, who followed Semtay,
Responded right away:
"All the horses are here,
No single horse is out."

After answering the question,
Aweikai waved the pole and shouted,
Drove all the horses to one place.

The rope was colt's twelve-journey long,
Became the ropes that circled the horses.
All Kirgiz herdsmen around,
All came and drove horses for them.

A colt of red sand color,
Lifted its tail up high,
Neighed loudly to the sky,
Hopped out of the rope.

Wise Bakay,
Smiled and said to himself.
"It must be Tayibruler!"
Bakay was sure about it.

"My kid, stop chasing!
Open your bag right now,
Find out quickly,
The prolonge of Ackura steed."

Semtay dismounted immediately,
Opened his white bag,
The rolled rope,
Appeared in front of him.

The silk twisted rope,
Was preserved very well.
On the pole that made of birch,
The rope was tied tight.
Young Semtay mounted the horse right away,
Before Tayibruler turned round,
He lassoed the neck of the horse tight.
The pole with the silk lasso,
Was held in Semtay's hand tight.
Tayibruler rose and hopped high into the air,
Then stopped tamely.

The lasso pole left by his father,
Was held high in Semtay's hand,
From numerous horses,
He lassoed the selected fine horse.

Old Bakay ran over and helped him,
Aweikai was in a hurry,
Also whipped his horse and followed tight.

Through their careful watch,
They finally found the fine horse Tayibruler,
They put the halter of Ackura,
On the head of Tayibruler,
It was just right in size.

Their action went smoothly,
It was a bless from God.
Buruler was meek at the moment,
It turned round and smelt Semtay.
With the familiar smell of many years ago,
It got close with him friendly.

The pommel was made of gold,
The cantle was made of silver,
Two fenders were made of iron.

Exquisite produced Ackangke saddle,
Did not shake at all,
It fitted Tayibruler perfectly.
Then Semtay mounted his horse,
Buruler neither hopped,
Nor galloped suddenly,
It just stepped forward steadily.

The strong and straight figure sat on Buruler,
Long Sire spear held tight in the hand,
Young lion Semtay,
Was of same towering heroic spirit with Manas.

Achalbaris sword hung by his side,
Crescent battleaxe tied on his waist,
Bulerturshun magic lash held in his hand,
Ackelty powder gun,
The magic treasure that could protect his life,
Was hung on his broad shoulders.
The crescent shape decorations on his shoulders,
Made the young man more graceful in appearance.

Semtay, with a heroic bearing,
Mounted the throne of hero Manas.
The empire the late king left,
Would be inherited and developed,
It would benefit all Kirgiz people.

He turned round slowly,
And said to Aweikai:
"My uncles, Aweikai, Kobosh,
My mother suffered from your humiliation,
I will go back to her.
Bakay is a fair witness between us,
He is my respected uncle.

"You need to build a white palace,

You must build it elaborately.
I will return in two months,
I will let my mother move into the gorgeous palace.
If you build the palace splendid and beautiful,
I can see your heart as a fellow."

Semtay talked loudly and clearly.
Took Ackelty gun,
His heart still beat fast.
He wore Akorlbok coat armor,
Prayed to God solemnly.
To Aweikai and Kobosh,
He talked again:

"All the property my father left,
I have already taken it over,
Do you want to serve and work for me?
It depends on you.

"The evil things you did to Bakay,
My mother's miserable sufferings caused by you,
If I do not speak them out,
It will never go away from my heart.

"When my father Manas passed away,
Fellow villagers held grand funeral for him,
Less than ten days after the funeral,
You began to rob. You were worse than evil bandits.

"My majestic mother Kanikai,
Don't you think she will forgive you?
I will go and ask her,
Listen to her instructions.
My grandmother Qierdy and my mother Kanikai,
Maybe they are worried about me now.

"Time has moved in my favor and I return home,

I am all gratitude to what the heaven have arranged.
I will come back to Talas again,
Administrate my Nuoyi people,
I will become their Khan and bring benefits to them.

"Let us forget those old hatreds,
Let us unite for the better new life.

"Aweikai, if you only do good things from now on,
I will appoint you the general of the troops.
For my dear mother who brought me up,
I will beg her for sparing your life.
If you harbor sinister motives and do evil things again,
I will let you deserve what you have sown.

"I will go back to my mother from here,
I will go to Kara Khan's city,
Shatimur's granddaughter is Chachykai,
I, Semtay, will marry her.

"I will present the betrothal gifts,
It is the custom from our ancestors.
Marry the enemy's woman forcibly,
It is also the tradition our ancestors left.

"Chachykai is a beauty,
I heard she has already had a fiancé.
He is Shihay's son Chinkogeo,
He is a warrior known by the world.

"Chachykai, such a beautiful girl,
Cannot be taken away by strong Chinkogeo,
I will marry her even he cries to heaven,
If he really makes me angry,
I will defeat him and scatter his people mercilessly!"

The young black mane wolf Semtay,

Finished all his words in one breath.
Then Aweikai responded,
Promised this way:

"I am willing to serve and work for you,
I promise I will follow your order.
If I have evil thoughts toward you,
Let me go to hell immediately.

"If any Nuoyi dare rebel,
I will twist his neck off right away.
If you are going to even up your father's blood debt,
If you are going to go on expedition,
I will call six tribes' Kara Nuoyi people in,
Drive them and serve you.

"As long as I, Aweikai, live in this world,
I will be faithful forever,
I will follow you firmly,
Till the last minute of my life.

"This is my promise and vow,
Respected Semtay,
You can decide everything for me."

Semtay and Bakay were content with his words,
They turned round with smiles and galloped away.
Old Bakay led the way in the front,
Semtay whipped his horse and followed tight.

They marched toward the lakeside full of cyperus rotundus,
Passed dense Shabur grass,
By the side of Arakoler lake,
Manas' tomb towered there as a mountain peak,
Even if nine centuries went by,
It would still tower there as strongly as iron.

When Semtay got to the front of the tomb,
He held the halter and dismounted,
Butchered the white mare he brought with him,
Shared the meat among those poor people,
People prayed solemnly for the hero's spirit.

Heard the news of Semtay's return,
A lot of subjects of the late king came.

They worshiped the spirit of Manas together,
Visited the tomb of the lion.
Then mounted their horses,
Marched forward on the big road.

Not long on their journey,
They arrived at the prairie that belonged to late Manas.
Tens of thousands of mares were tied there,
Gold hitching posts for tying horses were still there.
The time when they arrived,
Was right the time flowers blossomed all over the prairie.

Bakay said to Semtay:
"Oh, my leopard Semtay,
When your father Manas was alive,
I, your uncle, always accompanied him.
Here is the pasture in which we spent our summer,
People lived scattered on this beautiful prairie,
It was a place all Nuoyi people got together.

"When your father Manas was alive,
Old Bakay accompanied him.
It was a good place where our people lived happily,
People put up yurts along that hill,
There were all friendly Nuoyi people in your sight.

"Livestock was fully spread here and there,
People could not distinguish their own animals,

No matter it was noble or humble, rich or poor,
People all lived together harmoniously.

"Five hundred mares were tied on one rope,
Appointed men would milk the mares and made wine.
If two hundred horsemen set out,
There must be two hundred servants to welcome and lead the horses for them."

"Horse milk wine filled seven leather bags full,
Guests could drink all at one time.
One special leather bag was chosen,
Smoked and dyed it crimson.
Then chose the milk of the yellow mare,
Made horse milk wine carefully and held in the leather bag,
It was especially for your father and some honored guests.

"They did not enjoy themselves to the full,
Then they drank strong alcohol with Kokure.
To fete honored guests came from afar,
Fat mares of empty embryo must be cooked.

"Man raised and tamed their horses carefully,
Slung the long spear in majesty.
Watched enemies who intended to invade all the time,
Took all the armaments when they drilled.
In all the face-to-face contests,
No enemy had ever defeated your father.

"In order to crusade against Beygin city afar,
He enquired the way and prepared to set out.
When Nuoyi people did not want to go,
The copper horn was blown immediately,
Eloquent Ajibayi was sent,
To call those seven Khans in.

"When seven Khans came with their troops,

Flags flew and gun saluted.
It is the place the battle flag was erected,
These were the past glory of this prairie."

Bakay finished his story about the past,
Semtay was extravagant in his admiration of the old days.
In the place with full of wild flowers,
They camped on the hill that night.

When the dawn came next morning,
Two heroes mounted and set out again.
They did not stop at all,
Several days passed, and nights too,
They arrived at a wood,
A running spring was right in front of them.
Manas once bathed here,
Prayed to the sky solemnly here.

Two heroes whipped their horses,
Dismounted by the side of Kaynar spring.
"This is the magic spring my mother Kanikai mentioned,
My respected uncle,
I guess you know its history,
Please tell me the detailed story."

Bakay started to say:
"Semtay, my kid,
It was a magic spring here,
The running water of it was very warm.

"The spring ran day and night,
People that came to worship were unstoppable.
There was a big Chinese parasol tree by the spring,
Luxuriantly green and leafy.

"If there are some people not coming,
They are women.

And those Karamark people,
Never came or worshiped either.

"When your father Manas was alive,
He always came here and worshiped.
He considered the tree and the spring as gods,
And respected the tree god and the spring god.

"The tree dried one time suddenly,
That was the moment,
When you father Manas went on expedition to Beygin city.

"In order to protect you, the orphan,
When your mother was on her way of fleeing,
She lived here one night.

"Once I heard but did not witness,
The tree burgeoned again,
But there is a branch still dry till now.
Let's go and take a look now,
Do not go on the horse,
We need walk there."

They dismounted and walked there,
They prayed to God silently in their hearts,
For blessing them defeat numerous disasters.
They held the halters in their hands,
Put the whip across their necks,
Walked round and worshiped the magic spring.

At dusk,
They saw the tree in front of them,
The tree had three trunks,
Two of them were with luxuriantly foliage,
The third one was dry,
How magical it was.

Bakay shook his head at the moment,
He read God silently with tears,
The tree rustled immediately,
It seemed a gale blew it hard.

But the dry trunk did not move an inch,
It was so different from the burgeoning trunks,
The trunk was so dry and yellow,
Everyone witnessed felt surprised.

They thought God would fulfill their wishes,
They held their collars and prayed.
Bakay who never hid the truth,
Now talked about the secret he predicted:

"My boy, listen to me,
I will tell you all the truth.
The tree turned dry at that time,
Predicted your father would fall a prey to a plot of Kunwuerbayi.

"From then till now,
There is one trunk still dry,
The appearance of the dry trunk is a bad omen,
There will be a day the bad thing falls on you,
Enemies surrounding you will plot against you.

"Two burgeoning trunks,
Predicted you would have two fellows,
One is absolutely faithful to you,
The other will betray you!

"My boy, let's go on our journey quickly,
Why do we still stay here?"

They ignored how tired the horses were,
They did not stop at all and continued day and night,
Galloped toward Kara Khan's city far away.

On the way,
Uncle Bakay gave guidance to young Semtay.
They went on under hot sun and sand,
Climbed over clays of mountains.

It was a sixty-day journey,
But they arrived in thirty-five days.

From every morning to night,
Kanikai counted the days,
Till the night came everyday,
She still overlooked and waited for his son.

Khan's daughter Kanikai,
Climbed up on the hill in front of her yurt,
She saw blurred figures in her sight,
That must be Semtay and Bakay.

She invited friends and relatives,
Waited and welcomed them by the entrance of Ayinla.
Noble Kanikai wore decently,
She stood by the door and waited eagerly.

Bakay and Semtay were awe-inspiring,
Two horses galloped shoulder to shoulder,
Dust covered the road behind them.
Horse heads swayed left and right,
Hooves kicked up and galloped fast like shooting stars.
Hooves knocked on Gobi desert and raised sparks,
Like lightening cut in the sky.

They both rode on fine horses,
Steps of their horses were like running clouds,
They arrived at the door in an instant.
Servant came up and held the halter,
Tied tight on the hitching post.

Kanikai took out a yellow baby goat,
Held Sadaha[1] ceremony to exorcise evil spirits.
Asked servant to bring the purple mare,
Butchered it right away.
Loosed groups of hunting dogs in Ayinla,
Let them eat the mare meat,
Till all the meat was eaten up.

Kanikai opened her long pouch,
Took out shining gold and silver,
Threw at people as charity.
The old, the weak, the disabled and the poor,
Got more than others.

Faced many Kara Khan's subjects,
She took out all Semtay's clothes,
And gave them away to the poor.
Twelve-year-old black mane wolf,
Praised by Kara Khan's subjects.

"What a fine horse it is!"
People surrounded Tayibruler,
Praised the horse heartfeltly:
"The son of the lion Manas,
His horse is as magical as Arckura."

Surrounded by all these people,
Bakay and Semtay were welcomed into the palace.
Splendid carpet was put,
White tablecloth was spread,
Cube sugar and dried fruit were on,
Hot milk tea was served.
Semtay returned to his mother Kanikai,

① Sadaha: It is a traditional custom Kirgiz people use to pray for safety, health and to exorcise evil spirits. They use the lung of a goat or a baby goat to knock on the head of the person three times, then throw it away. Let the dog eat the meat, it means the disaster or bad luck will go away. They also can give clothes and money for charity.

They had too much to tell each other.

Let us start the story,
Kanikai was preparing for his son's wedding,
And then they returned Talas to retake the throne.

Semtay Punished Treasons and Retook the Throne

Kanikai and Semtay Returned Hometown and Punished Treasons Severely and Retook the Throne

Worn-out elder Bakay came to Kanikai after a long journey,
Kanikai was excited and burst into tears.
She arranged grand banquet,
Feted Bakay warmly.

Smart Kanikai,
Bent her body and greeted Bakay in respect:
"Wise senior Bakay,
You are an uncle like the sage.
You come back safely,
We have not seen each other more than ten years,
Are you still healthy?

"Do you come because of missing us?
Did you feel that I always miss you?
How is your life going?
Do you come to me because of missing me?
I miss our people in homeland day and night,
Do you know I always feel lonely?
Are the fellows in homeland doing well?

"Are you still a Khan that command our people?
Or you are not a Khan now,
Being pushed aside,
Enduring hardships,
Living an uncertain life?
Did you inspire and instruct my only son?
Did you lead my son,
To look for Jaugrp?

"Did you send someone from the hometown,
Bring me the exciting news,
When your junior specially went to you,
Did you take him to avenge?

"Did you send someone from your Ayinla,
And report some news secretly?
When Semtay went to you and call you uncle,
Did you take him to make them pay their blood debt?

"Did you believe in others' sweet words?
Softhearted uncle,
Were you cheated by others?"

Before Bakay could respond to her,
Kanikai turned round and held Semtay in her arms:
"My dear son Semtay,
You are my beloved baby my lion left to me.
You are more important than my life,
I am concerned about you at every moment!

"My sweetheart Semtay,
Did you see the homeland you dreamed in?
The precious gift Semtay Kangkoer left to me,
After your father Manas died,
I got a lot of grace and helps from your uncle Bakay.
Your father's brothers of same father,
Humiliated me too much.

"Did you see your grandfather Jagurp?
Do you come back because of his cheating words?
Did you see Aweikai and Kobosh?
Do you come back because they smiled to you?

"All armaments your father left,
Did you take them back with your heroic spirit,
Or did you get nothing and were cheated by them?

Do you come back without accomplishing anything?
The armaments for defeating enemies,
Did you ask them to return straightly?

"How did you deal with your two uncles?
They robbed of your father's armaments.
How do you take the armaments back,
Safe and sound?

"Respected senior Bakay,
As long as I see my king's armaments personally,
My heart will then calm down."

Semtay started to talk,
He explained to his mother:
"Mother, please listen to your son's report,
I have taken care of Jagurp,
I almost take his life although I am too young!

"He poisoned the wine and wanted to kill me,
I poured the wine on his beard and made his plot exposed.
I cursed him severely,
And spared his life for the moment.

"Aweikai and Kobosh,
Were jerked around by me.
All the armaments my father left,
Have all been taken back.

"I caught Tayibruler horse,
This horse makes me satisfied the most.
I wandered around the prairie there,
And observed the flocks of horses there.

"Twelve running horse journey ropes,
Was made into the ropes to tie the colts,
They are still perfectly good in use,

That is the heritage my father left to me.

"I toured in flocks of horses,
Looked for Buruler horse.
I told myself that was it,
Then I lassoed the Tayibruler horse.

"Then I went to my father's tomb,
I knelt and worshiped solemnly.

"I ordered Aweikai to repair our palace,
Asked him to decorate with colorful paint,
I want the sound echoes in the palace.
Asked them to finish at the Beyginning of the spring,
I told them my mother and I will move in in two months.
I told them if they cannot finish on time,
I will cut their heads off and put before the public.

"I have arranged everything,
Aweikai vowed at the moment,
He begged for my forgiveness,
Kobosh could not act violently anymore,
He is also obedient to me now.

"I called all Nuoyi people in,
Even those old man and old women,
No one was left!
They all got together,
And pledged loyalty to me.

"Aweikai held a grand banquet,
Feted your son, the only son the lion left.
They did nothing evil,
My majestic mother,
Please relax and do not worry anymore.
"Mother, you have suffered too much,
If the palace is repaired well,

I will ask for your instruction,
How to deal with Aweikai and Kobosh.

"Aweikai and Kobosh,
Promised many times and apologized.
They begged me for sparing their lives,
So I left them and come back to you.

"My grandfather did not listen to the advice,
He put poison into my wine viciously.
I have punished him severely,
And I warned him seriously.

" 'Semtay will miss us,
It was us who lost head for a moment.'
Aweikai nad Kobosh regretd with tears,
In front of the public,
They spoke the truth,
And knelt by my feet."

His mother Kanikai said at the moment:
"My beloved colt!
You are my beacon your father left to me,
You must light up the world with your brilliancy,
You must see through evil people's sweet words,
That is the plot they make for you,
Do not believe their rubbish talking.

"Aweikai and Kobosh,
Committed all kinds of crimes.
They could not accept the orphan your father left,
It makes me confused till now.

"Their crimes are inexpiable,
Each of their crimes will let me forget:
The cradle made of gold,
Was cut to pieces with their axes.

"In order to kill you,
Kobosh rushed into my palace,
Grabbed the baby in the cradle,
Said let my baby die in miserable cry.
They would kill the poor baby,
And went to report the good news to your grandfather.

"I begged and cried like a baby camel,
I felt as if a knife stabbed to my heart.
I have suffered what would have in the hell,
I have experienced all the misery in the world.
How I can forgive those brutes,
If let me forgive them,
Baby, I would rather go to hell.

"Baby, do not interfere in this affair,
I will kill them with my own hands,
To relieve the hatred in my heart.

"Those arrogant Berk[1],
I do not fear of their cruelties.
There are no ordinary people with eternal life,
I would rather sacrifice myself for revenge.
I will never give up avenging,
I will never let them off.

"They cheated you and you come back here,
My kid, you watered the root of disaster.
If they stir up troubles again,
Semtay, for these cold-blood devils,
I will show no mercy to them,
I will treat them with no kindness."

① Berk: It also can be called Bek. It is the common name of local officials ancient Kirgiz called. Sometimes it also refers to the noble or people with high social status.

Semtay said to his mother:
"Oh, my dear mother!
The horse I ride is magic Buruler,
Aweikai and Kobosh are my family members,
If I kill my own family members,
It is like I am punishing myself.

"If Aweikai does not keep his promise,
Then you can punish him severely.
You can cut Aweikai's head off as you please,
Let you kill Kobosh.
The stubborn and vicious old man Jagurp,
I will never ask even if you kill him.

"If Aweikai keeps the affection between us as a family,
If he chooses falcon to raise,
If he tames the fine horses,
If he does not play tricks and plots,
If he does not make troubles,
If he takes the responsibility as an uncle,
I will give you to him as his wife.

"According to the customs ancestors left,
A widow should remarry,
How can he not marry you?
How can you disobey the rule?

"He will inherit my father's throne,
He will be my majestic uncle,
He will be a Khan that commands our subjects,
And carry on the prosperity of Manas' family.
The kid repeated his words,
The kid did not yield to anything.
Hero Semtay talked his thinking repeatedly:
"Let us all move back to our old homeland,
Let numerous poor Nuoyi fellow villagers,
Come into our land and live."

Heard what young Semtay had said,
His grandfather Kara Khan,
Asked to butcher more than forty mares immediately,
Called in all his people to celebrate.
He stretched his arms and opened his palms first,
Gave his heartfelt blessings to Semtay:

"My kid, wish you have an infinitely bright future,
Let your enemies seek their own doom,
Wish all sages and wise men assisted your father,
Will come and gather around you.

"My kid, wish you all the best.
The great cause your father created,
I wish it will be more prosperous in your hand.
Wish God bless you,
And carry out your mission quickly.

"My kid, your father is Manas,
Your grandfather, I, wants to tell you:
Your mother is Kanikai,
She is my baby, my sweetheart.
She is the wife of your father,
I heard your uncles want to marry her,
Ask them to go to hell.

"Shatimur's granddaughter Chachykai,
Wish she can be your wife.
We have no other request,
You are the son of the king,
We will not ask you for betrothal money and gifts.

"Timir and Shatimur,
They are my bosom friends like brothers,
I can make decisions,
For all their things.

"Kanikai, start everything now,
Prepare for the wedding now,
Bakay seldom comes here,
Now it is a blessing of God."

People present brought loud cheers in,
Everyone came and gave blessings.

Kanikai and Bakay discussed in a hurry,
Returned the coat armor,
And the grey flying horse[1] to Kara Khan,
As the betrothal gifts for the engagement,
It made the engaging ceremony happy and grand.

In front of Kara Khan,
They spread the black coat armor with great respect,
Tied the fine horse in Kara Khan's yard.
Seeing the return of the coat armor and the horse,
Kara Khan's fellows felt happy from the bottom of their hearts.

Happy girls talked like chirping birds,
Married women came and congratulated,
For the unite of two families,
Young men all came and gathered.

Old men with white beard,
Old women with white hair,
No matter the old or the young and men or women,
People gathered from all places and celebrated happily.

Chachykai was a true beauty in the world,
It was God's decree that Semtay must marry her.

Kanikai reported to her father:

[1] Flying horse: It refers to the horse that are good at trotting.

"Semtay has grown up,
I appreciate you let Chachykai marry him,
She is the girl Semtay loves.

"Semtay cherishes high aspiration of his father's great cause,
He will return to Talas recently.
They need hold the wedding within seven days,
Invite Molerdo to be their chief witness."

Achieved their desire,
It was as warm as spring in April.
Kanikai and Bakay were glad.
They ordered to open the big pouch,
Took out forty thousand red ingots,
Presented to Kara Khan as the betrothal money.

Chachykai was Shatimur's beloved granddaughter,
He prepared new wedding yurt for her.
The beautiful yurt was shining,
Graceful and gorgeous.

The skylight was beset with silver metal,
Ropes were golden copper chains,
Center post was painted,
Then twisted velvet carefully on it.
Such a splendid yurt,
No one was mean to the praises.

Rafters painted red were strong and resplendent,
Splendens lattice was also twisted with velvet,
The belt used to tie the rafters was Marnat fabric[①],
The bottom of the felt was covered wit four-finger-wide otter skin.

The edge of the skylight cover,
Was wrapped with Kamuka fabric,

① Marnat fabric: It usually refers to red velvet fabric.

The patterns of the roof cover felt were peach blossoms,
It made people feel they were in the garden all year round.

The lattice of the yurt,
Was not tied with leather ropes,
But fastened with copper nails.
The door frame was made of gold,
In the sunshine,
It was shining like a palace.
The skylight was beset with tin and silver,
It sparked like stars.

There were numerous young men,
Fell in love with Chachykai,
But because of their low status,
They only could love her in their hearts.

For the sake of his granddaughter's bright future,
Shatimur prepared a large dowry early.
For her comfortable life after getting married,
For her best time after getting married,
In order not to let Chachykai do much housework,
In order not to let Chachykai miss hometown afar too much,
Shatimur chose forty boys and forty girls,
Went with her as her servants.

Carried the dowry,
With sixty single-hump camels.
There were four thousand and five hundred fine horses,
They were also his granddaughter's dowry.
What Kara Khan had did,
Made his poor daughter Kanikai happier.
One hundred and ninety people formed wedding ranks,
They separated in two rows,
Held shotguns in their hands,
And were busy driving dowry animals.

They were ordered to drive dowry animals,
And get to the bridegroom's pasture.
Let the orphan be contented,
Let the princess be happy.
Let the wedding grand and warm,
Let the wishes ever lasting and unchanging.

Kara Khan had prepared everything,
That they need on the journey.
Kara Khan also prepared well,
The food they need for sixty days.

Falcon-like figure, sheath-like waist,
Red silk dress with thin and long belt and wide round hip.
Black hair with colorful hair knots,
Two long braids hanging like phoenix feather.
Medium height, apple-like head,
Arched eyebrows, straight nose.
Charming lady Kanikai,
Wore long otter coat,
Walked out elegantly.

She led sixty single-humped camels,
Toward the direction of homeland Talas,
Stepped on the road to Kankoler.
She said: "Godbye, father, take care!"
Merged into the returning group.

Manas' son Semtay,
The young warrior was like a tiger.
Semtay, the only son of the great king,
Was a young hero with little experience in the real world,
Bakay kept him by his side,
Cared him as a lamb.

Whipped, neighed,
Horses galloped on the road,

Busy under the hooves toward the place afar,
Gold and silver decorations on the halters,
Shone brightly in the sunshine.

Bakay's beard,
Shone as silver.
Purple horse under him,
Knocked the earth with its hooves.
The forelock whipped in the wind,
Long mane in the neck waved in the air.
The head raised high as an argali,
Its purple hair was as glossy and sleek as otter's.

Old but vigorous Bakay took the lead,
The young hero followed by his side closely.
Qierdy and Kanikai went on shoulder to shoulder,
Chachykai followed them tight behind,
The group anxious to return galloped into the distance.

They hurried on their journey day and night,
Climbed over several mountains everyday,
Ignored their tiredness,
They continued the journey for thirty-five days.
It counted days and nights together,
When the days and nights accumulated to sixty-five,
They finally arrived in beautiful prairie Talas.

In vast Talas plain,
By the side of Alakoler lake,
It was the tomb of lion Manas.
When the massive group arrived there,
They all dismounted and walked to the tomb.

In order to worship Manas' spirit,
They butchered the purple mare,
People worshiped the spirits on bended knees,
Prayed and worshiped solemnly.

If counted all the time of the journey,
There were just thirty-six days.

After visiting the lion's white tomb,
People mounted again,
It was the orchard Manas once developed not far away,
The king's palace was built there.
Hero Semtay said:
"Let's go to the repaired palace first!"
They had passed Tortkoler Lake as he talked,
The palace the lion built was nearer and appeared in their sight.

Born-vicious Kobosh,
Cherished another evil thought.
He was ungraceful and ready to make trouble,
He was heading for his doom.

He acted secretly behind Aweikai,
He dug a deep pit on the main road,
He hid himself in the pit,
A silent powder gun was held tight in his hands.

He filled the gunpowder full and loaded it,
Then he hid in the pit,
He was waiting for Semtay's coming,
He was going to shoot the young hero in the back.

Kobosh waited in the dark place anxiously,
Semtay led the group and marched ahead fast,
He was perfectly open and frank and naïve,
He never expected an evil enemy would be in an ambush.

When they got close to Kobosh,
Clever Tayibruler steed,
Had detected something,
It stopped going forward.

The young orphan was so lucky,
God blessed him all the time.
He avoided the disaster again.

Kobosh hid in the dark,
Shot his gun mercilessly at the moment.
With the born instinct,
Tayibruler lifted its hooves up fast as the lightening,
Leaped over the deep pit under its hooves.

Semtay on the horseback,
Was almost thrown off the horse.
"The damn horse, are you crazy?"
He whipped it and shouted.

He turned round and saw the dust after the explosion,
A strong smell of gunpowder came to him.
Someone did the explosion for killing him secretly,
Semtay figured out as he saw this,
It must be Kobosh who did this.
He was burned with wrath immediately,
He felt disappointed to Aweikai and Kobosh,
His heart was as cold wind.

The strong young tiger,
Whipped his horse and galloped to the palace.
Aweikai and Kobosh were obsessed,
But they laid the new carpet,
In the repaired palace,
And pretended nothing happened.
They welcomed Bakay and Semtay,
With great respect,
They served them warmly.

Khan's daughter Kanikai,
Insisted on what she once said as firm rock:

"Do not let me see those bastards,
I insist on not seeing them.
They once killed my adopted son,
Tore him like tearing a lamb,
Today they ambushed with silent powder gun,
Tried to kill all of us.
These incorrigible bastards,
How I can let them off!"

Kanikai punished them severely in a towering rage,
Jagurp, Aweikai, and kobosh were killed.
Kanikai took the revenge,
She had no regret anymore.

Semtay Punished Warriors Committed Treason

Semtay returned to his homeland from Buhara,
Made the fellows made waves pay the blood debt,
Inherited his father's great cause and became the master of Talas.

When Semtay visited his father's tomb,
He prayed to his father's spirit.
He thought any of forty warriors who were still alive,
Must come and welcome him,
They would worship the spirit of the late king together.

The forty warriors his father gathered,
Were the main force for his father.
They followed his father and went on expedition everywhere,
Many of them had lost their lives in the battles.
There were still more than twenty of them alive,
How were they doing?
Semtay was still concerned about them.

But no one came and welcomed him,
No one went with him to visit the lion.
Semtay saw what happened,
Suspicions had arisen in his heart.

When Semtay went to Bhara,
To marry Chachykai,
Chachykai, the princess,
Became the daughter-in-law of Kanikai.
Shihay's son Chinkogeo was very dissatisfied and he would never give up,

He sowed discord between Semtay and the warriors.

Chinkogeo was so resentful about it,
He was not prepared to give up that easily.

"I must stir up some troubles,
I will show them what I can do."
The damn slave calculated in his heart,
He did not let anyone know it.

He called in the warriors with the elder Kergelchal as head,
Many of them were young men who replaced the dead.
Two bastards Chybiti and Kochykor,
Two mad dogs Ade Bay and Koler Bay,
Chinkogeo called them in, too.

He spread the tablecloth before them,
Instigated the warriors:
"Warriors,
You meet great disasters,
That brings you about endless injustice,
All the good deed and achievements you have done,
Are just like pouring water in the river. No one cares.

"Chybiti and Kochykor,
Ade Bay and Koler Bay,
And the elder Kergelchal,
I have watched you guys carefully,
You all have no preparation for facing the death.

"When Manas passed away,
Aweikai and Kobosh,
Intended to marry Kanikai,
They sent me to lobby as a matchmaker,
Kanikai refused immediately.

"I reported it as what it was.

Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp Khan,
They felt very resentful,
They vowed to wreak her,
To drive her away.

"Only a few days later,
They robbed Manas' property.
The adopted baby was mistaken for Semtay,
And was torn like a lamb.
The hatred planted then,
Was always burning in Kanikai's heart.

"Kergelchal led the warriors,
You did not avoid and stand by,
But you all were Kobosh's accomplices,
You all got a lot of property.
You also humiliated Bakay Khan,
Pushed him aside and made him wander in mountains.

"But that old bastard does not relax,
He counted the days and months,
He was waiting for the chance to revenge.

"Now you have seen his plot,
When Semtay came from Buhara,
It was him waited on the way,
And led the little wolf here.

"He went round the neighborhoods,
He led the little wolf and made the trouble.
Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp,
Now are cleared by them.

"Jagurp poisoned Semtay,
He sowed discord between them,
He instigated the boy,
Made him go against you."

"How Aweikai and Kobosh,
Forcibly occupied Manas' property.
And the secret of Tayibruler,
Bakay blabbed all these to Semtay.
Crafty Bakay did not fear the lofty mountains and tricky paths,
Followed him to Buhara city.

"These are all Bakay's ideas,
Young Semtay does not have the ability.
Think about this, marry and bring Chachykai here,
Who support Kanikai?

"Bakay pretended he knows nothing,
But killed Aweikai, Kobosh and Jagurp,
In a blink of an eye.

"Warriors present,
You are ignorant to everything happened around,
Once that old bastard fights back,
None of you can live your life anymore.

"He will say:
'Jagurp robbed Manas' village,
Forty warriors were his accomplices!'
He will think the charges are not enough,
He will say:
'Forty warriors did not come and welcome the lion's son,
They will not pledge loyalty to you!'

"Bakay will fan up the flames of trouble,
Bakay will play plots,
Finally achieves his purpose of rooting you out.

"The stubborn woman Kanikai,
She will make up the story and stir up the trouble.
She will say:

'My boy, if you do not kill forty warriors,
I would rather die here!'
She must cry and force his son.

"In order not to offend his own mother,
Semtay must kill you all.
After you are all killed,
Bakay, his beard is like rotten felt,
He then will live at ease.

"If you all die in Semtay's hands,
No one will have compassion for you.
For his own grandfather,
And his uncles Aweikai and Kobosh,
Semtay did not show any mercy,
How can he be softhearted toward you?

"Under the instigation of Kanikai and Bakay,
This heartless boy,
Will kill you all.
Now the tragedy is coming on the way,
Please discuss and get an idea.

"When leopard Manas was still alive,
You were all brave and skillful heroes in battle.
During the period of Aweikai and Kobosh,
You all were also in power.
Now,
The power is in Bakay's hands,
You will descend into deep disaster.

"Kergelchal understands, I understand too,
Bakay Khan's eyes are bloodshot with anxiety,
He has full of lies and plots,
He smiles and says sweet words,
But he kills people in the back.

"Kanikai is a stubborn woman,
Venom is full in her body,
Semtay, brought up by these two,
Opens his bloody mouth like a hungry wolf.
They will put us under house arrest,
They will deprive us of safety and freedom.

"He cheated and lured Aweikai, Kobosh,
And Jagurp with sweet words,
Let them repair the deserted palace,
Painted the inside with red oil paint,
Brushed the outside wall with white lime.

"After the palace got repaired,
Heartless Semtay returned kindness with hatred,
He let the vicious woman kill them at will,
Like butcher some animals.

"Chybiti and Kochykor,
Ade Bay and Koler Bay,
White-beard elder Kergelchal,
And all brave warriors,
I invited you all to gather here,
I want to know what good ideas you have.

"People's desire to life is endless,
No one wants to die miserably.
Kanikai, Bakay, and Qierdy,
Now are planning to descend plague over our heads.

"They have already figured in their hearts.
We need to leave this troublesome place quickly.
Find a safe place as soon as possible,
I will go with you and hide.
Let us go and live in another place,
We will have no good end if we still stay here.

"If we just rush out of the yard,
Fight with that young man,
Semtay must kill us,
Even our bodies will be thrown to the wilderness.
As long as we unite together,
We will come back one day,
We will achieve our goal!

"If we stay and wait for death,
We will be killed innocently.

"Kanikai and Bakay,
Will not allow us to live a peaceful life.
She will crack our talus,
She will lift us with ropes,
She will fasten us with nails like wooden hitching posts,
She will make us suffer endlessly.

"Kanikai is a humble and lowly servant,
She will never let us live peacefully!

"Cruel and evil Qierdy,
Is a cunning woman and she always makes up stories.
She will call one of us in everyday,
Lure us to tell our secrets.
Arrogant Semtay,
Will find all kinds of excuses to eliminate the dissidents.

"Some of you are seniors,
But some of you are still young,
Once you fall in their hands,
It is impossible to keep you still alive.
If you all agree to take my advice,
You should leave this place right away,
Do not put your faith in luck,
And lose your life.

"If Semtay comes and chases you,
He will say cheating but sweet words to you,
He will promise to let you wear coat armor,
And let you ride his Buruler steed.

"And he will talk to each of you,
Tell you he will give all kinds of power.
He will say as long as you return to Talas,
He will forgive your past misdeeds forever.

"Kanikai, Bakay, and Qierdy,
Are cruel people that will crack bones and eat marrow.
You would rather die in strange places,
Than come back to Talas,
Do not go back no matter what they will say."

Warriors heard what Chinkogeo told them,
They went out of the yurt in groups,
They walked and thought about Chinkogeo's words,
And discussed with each other.
They shared the same rotten tastes with each other,
They all appreciated the bastard's idea,
They were like rolling dark clouds.

"We have made up our mind to flee away!"
None of them leaked out the news,
Those crazy guys gathered together,
Stepped on the evil journey.
Even their own wives and children,
Were not aware of any clue.

Warriors were ready to flee away,
They prepared from dawn till dusk.
At the night no one noticed,
They fled away together.

From the time of Manas till now,

They had unified equipment.
Each of them had a strong fine horse,
A feedbag made of Manat fabric,
With all year round plentiful fodder.

The fine horses were always in combat stances,
Trainings all year round kept the horses in the same strong shape.
Now under the cover of the night,
They fled away from Talas.

The next morning,
People said they would pay a formal visit to Semtay,
When all villagers gathered,
Kanikai ordered:
"Gulidur①,
Kangbar②,
You two go and call them in right now.

"The warriors failed to confront Karamark troops,
The throne had to be left in Beygin city,
They were forced to withdraw to Talas.
Khan Almanbet Suritang,
Left an offspring behind,
His name is Kristan.

"Barita Khan's son Chuwak,
Is also a peerless hero.
He has a son,
Kankeldi is his beloved boy.

"I guess they are eight years old now,
The boys get this age,

① Gulidur: He was one of Manas' forty warriors. Almanbet's son Kristan was brought up by his wife, so people think Kristan was his son.

② Kangbar: He was one of Manas' forty warriors. Chuwak's son Kankeldi was brought up by his wife, so people think Kankeldi was his son.

It is the perfect time for them to follow Semtay.

"Look at their fathers,
None of them is ordinary,
I arranged people to raise their sons.
Gulidur and Kangbar,
I asked them to bring those two kids here.

"When my king was going to Beygin city,
Aisan Khan's daughter Birmiskal,
And general Ai's daughter Burulicha,
Were presented as gifts.

"When those two beauties came,
When showed them to the public,
Koshaoyi once said:
'Almanbet came with his troops,
That was a big bless from God.
That matched their expectations perfectly,
So the beauty Birmiskal,
Was sent to Almanbet.'

"Chuwak disappeared mysteriously in the battle,
No news about him for three months.
But he caught sons of forty generals after three months,
He said he caught them when they played in the field.
So the beauty Burulicha,
Was sent to Chuwak.

" 'Almanbet and Chuwak,
Two young men made great contributions,
Their marriage with these two girls is a heaven-made match'.
Koshaoyi once said like this,
Kirgiz people all agreed.

"Twisted facts are ill-founded,
All I said is true.

Marry beautiful girls from Khitan,
People had no regret but happiness in the past.

"The heroes lived in Beygin and ruled that place,
They sent Showtu[1] who wore a big white felt hat,
Came here with two pregnant women,
And five hundred people.

"When it was due time for those two pregnant women,
At the upper streams of vast Talas,
In the soft marshland of Chuhe river,
They camped in the Ayinla.

"The wedding escort group,
Met the disaster at the moment:
The two pregnant women caught diseases.

"I went and welcomed them by myself,
I called all the villagers in.
In less than three days they two delivered smoothly,
They gave birth to those two cute boys.

"With the time of making a pot of tea,
Almanbet's wife delivered,
Then hero Chuwak's wife Burulicha,
Also delivered.

"According to Kirgiz customs,
The one born first should be the big brother.
Two beauties from Khitan,
Their sons will be heroes.

"I held the infants in my arms,
I did not let them eat their mother's sick milk,
But let them eat from my breasts,

1 Showtu: It is the name of one of the forty warriors.

Took care of them like they were my twins.

"I fed these two babies,
With my milk,
The nipple Kristan sucked,
Had white milk run out like spring water.
The nipple Kankeldi sucked,
Had blood dropped.

"I did not tell any of the elders,
I did not ask others to give names to the boys.
I gave them proper names,
According to the breast that had milk or blood come out first.

"For Almanbet's son,
I gave the name Kristan,
For Chuwak's son,
I gave the name Kankeldi.
Their natural mothers,
God let them stay in the vast Talas.

"From Beygin to here,
Two mothers died of sudden illness,
And left this loving world,
Before they could hold and love their own sons.

"God will arrange everything,
Including the unpredictable happiness and misfortune.
Showtu wore white felt hat,
He went to report the good news of newborns to Beygin,
Two Khans were so excited,
They presented the city in Altay,
To them as a gift.

"From then till now,
Kazakh people never leave Altay area,
There are no other tribes,

Go and settle in that city.

"The two boys must be good friends,
I always tell myself.

"I heard the warriors go to a place afar suddenly,
I asked you to call Gulidur and Kangbar in,
They did not respond,
Do they have something worried in their hearts?"

When Kanikai said all these words,
She did not know the warriors had fled away,
No one came and reported to her.

"Why the warriors still do not come?"
Semtay began to doubt it.

Someone came and reported right at the moment:
"All warriors have disappeared,
Their mounts were nowhere to be found.

"It happens now,
There must be someone controlled in the back.
We rode the horses and chased as soon as we got the news,
We found the trace of their horses on Mazhayil hill."

Semtay flew into a rage in an instant,
He took the weapon by his side.
Mounted his Tayibruler steed,
Started to chase without hesitation.
Whipped and whipped,
Sweat ran down the horse legs like a waterfall.
God had already made up the mind,
Made Kochykor① to be the warriors' grave.
Young hero Semtay chased them bravely,

① Kochykor: It is the name of a place, means the place of ram.

Like a tiger ran down the mountain.

He did not fear because they had more people,
He caught up with them in a blink of an eye.
He blocked the way of those warriors,
He did not wave his spear and fight against the warriors.

Semtay did not act on an impulse,
He did not get angry,
But met all warriors sincerely,
Because they were his father's good fellows.

Semtay felt no hostility toward them,
He did not exert violence to them either.
When Semtay faced those warriors,
He was humble and polite.

"My respected uncles,
Your kid catches up with you and greets you.
Where are you going in such a hurry?
Do you come and investigate the enemy's situation?
Are there enemies invading us?
Could there be mountains striking us down?

"I just returned home yesterday,
Did I cause any trouble for you?
Did I shout at you,
Or did I whip you without any reasons?

"Do not go away like this,
Uncles,
Please tell me if I did anything wrong!
What did I do on earth that hurt you?
"Ajibayi's son Kelman Bay,
He is just a little boy,
Only he still stays at home.

"People that should die had died,
Your life is not influenced at all.
The offspring the dead left behind,
Are all controlled by you guys,
Why do you take them here?

" 'Kobosh has gone to the hell,
Aweikai has been removed.
Jagurp also lost his life,
How can he not treat us like that?'
Do you think this way?
Do you flee for this reason?

"If I have other evil thoughts toward you,
I will kill all of you fearlessly,
Any of you,
No one can still be alive.

"Maybe I am too young and naïve,
But I know you are my elders.
Respected uncles,
Please take it easy and think carefully.

"When birds land they need tails,
When birds fly they need wings.
Uncles, if you all leave me,
I just lose my tail for landing,
And I lose my wings for flying!

"Uncles, do not make me worry,
Do not desert me when I am still too young.
I heard that Ade Bay and Koler Bay,
Know the background of Erchywuler and Bozwuler,
You are all headmen,
You will be more reasonable.
Chybiti and Kochykor,
I am absolutely certain you will listen to me,

I suggest you four especially.

"You shared hardships from long time ago,
You four are as close as brothers,
You once supported Aweikai and Kobosh,
You have wisdom that beyond the average.

"Do you guess this way:
'Although Semtay can forgive us,
Kanikai, Bakay, and Qierdy,
How can they let us off?'

"Do not confuse your brain.
I present my horse Buruler,
Any of you can ride it.
Uncles,
I take off my Burum coat armor now,
Any of you can wear it.

"Please do not make things difficult for me,
Please return to Talas,
Let us share joys and hardships together.

"My uncle Kergelchal is your senior,
He is the headman of forty warriors,
I need give him the status he deserved.

"Please go back to the homeland,
Go and manage your fathers' possession of sites well,
Mount the throne confidently,
I will never allow others to rob it.

"Let us return to Talas together,
Let's explain to Kanikai and Bakay Khan,
And remove the misunderstanding."

The majestic lion said like this,

He put the coat armor on Buruler's back,
He walked up to them respectfully,
And blocked in their way sincerely.

"The circle of the world comes again and again,
Nothing is unchangeable!
The people that instigated you,
Are Aweikai and Kobosh.

"If you cut the root of the tree,
How can the braches burgeon?
Aweikai and Kobosh committed the crimes,
How can I blame you about it?

"Do not stay in the wilderness too long,
Uncles,
Let's go back!"

Semtay suggested them again,
They still did not dare go back with him,
No one dared ride the horse Tayibruler,
No one dared wear Burum coat armor either.

Two bastards Ade Bay and Koler Bay,
Two ruffians Chybiti and Kochykor,
And the old bad ass Kergelchal,
They five asked Semtay,
For giving them time to discuss.

"It will be fine for tomorrow,
Do not be in a hurry,
Discuss carefully,
Do not only discuss whether you will go with me,
Do not tangle in this one thing,
You also need to discuss,
What you should do,
When you go back to the palace."

When Semtay finished his words,
At the cross of the rivers,
By the side of the white grave,
They sat in a circle,
Discussed what they could do next.

"Although Semtay can take us back safely,
Bakay and Kanikai,
Who knows what they are thinking?
Can they spare our lives?"
There was death in their eyes.

"Semtay only said sweet words to us,
Not all of his words are trustful.
If Semtay does not want to kill us,
Why does he present his coat armor and horse to us?
Why does he drive us back home directly?
He treats us as strangers,
We should be more cautious.

"Semtay drives us back,
Could it be that he wants to kill us all?
Kill us one by one secretly.
Bakay and Kanikai,
Will put us to death at their pleasure,
Semtay must fold his arms and look on,
We cannot be negligent.
We would rather die together,
Than be killed one by one.

"We cannot go back,
We need endure the sufferings together.
Let's find another way,
How about we go to Kunwuerbayi for shelter,
Let's live with Karamark people.
Let's shake off Semtay thoroughly.

Otherwise, all of us,
Will be killed by him,
We will not avoid the misfortune."

The warriors discussed for a while,
They let the headman Kergelchal replied this way:
"Although we were your father's warriors,
We do not want to render a service to you.
Your advisors Bakay and Kanikai,
We do not want to be their slaves anymore!
This is our decision."

After the discussion,
The warriors crowded and came up.

"Uncles,
It seems your discussion is not bad."
Semtay waited by the side,
He smiled with full of hope.

When they saw Semtay's smile,
They all felt desperate.
In front of Semtay,
Kegelchal did not dare say their decision.

When he rambled in his statement,
Ade Bay,
Who was arbitrary and rude in Kobosh's time,
Stood out with fury.

He wore fur-lined jacket inside-out,
He was in his thirties,
But he did not have beard on his chin,
Started his snappish talk:

"Kergelchal, shut your mouth,
Stop talking aimlessly,

Do not say those irrelevant words!

"Semtay, listen to me,
No matter you present the coat armor or the horse,
Do not dream of making us change our minds!

"You are a cunning scoundrel,
We five are warriors,
How can you call us by names?

"You speak with your tongue in your cheek, cunning scoundrel,
You cheat us and want us to be Bakay's slaves.
It is a shame to Kergelchal.
Let us serve you Semtay,
We will have no good end.

"You come alone to take us as your subjects,
You occupy the land as soon as you are fully fledged,
You allow the widow to take the palace,
And you allow old Bakay to make an enemy of us.

"Khan Aweikai and Kobosh,
Has been sent to the hell,
How we can keep us alive!"

When Ade Bay said all these words,
Warriors led by Kergelchal,
Echoed in one voice, "What Ade Bay said is right",
Everyone present shouted.

When the noises roared in the wilderness,
Semtay neither acted on impulse nor flew into rage,
He persuaded sincerely and earnestly again:
"It is not like what you think, dear uncles,
Please go back to our homeland first.

"I will let you be in power like in the past,

Let you be the tribal elders,
Majestic old Bakay,
Was your Khan in the past.

"In the time of Aweikai and Kobosh,
He suffered from injustice,
I sincerely invite you to go back.
Livestock all over the hills, countless yurts,
How can you desert your property in Talas?"

Not in a hurry,
Sincere and earnest,
Hero Semtay stood calmly in front of the warriors.

As soon as Semtay finished his words,
Koler Bay was ablaze with anger,
Hurtful words came out of his mouth:
"What you said is just a lie,
You are not kind to your uncles,
You even make enemy of your grandfather.

"You said he poisoned you,
So you killed innocent Jagurp,
You said Kobosh shot you in the back,
So you killed your uncles mercilessly!
You believe every word from Bakay,
You argue in favor of him all the time.
The justice and sincerity you talked,
We have fully experienced!

"We did not rob your livestock,
You can still lie in your palace at ease,
We did not shoot and disturb you,
We will go to Kunwuerbayi for shelter,
We have made up our minds."

When Koler Bay made the choice of rebelling,

His accompanies around him,
They all agreed and applauded.
His words displeased Semtay at once,
He shouted with great anger:
"Kunwuerbayi is the mortal enemy of Kirgiz,
None of you is allowed to go to him,
You all return to Talas with me!"

The warriors still adhered to their decision,
They drew their swords and knives out,
Exposed the ugly faces as enemies.

Semtay saw their reactions,
He could not bear these rebels anymore.
With the clashing sound,
He pulled his sharp sword out.
He swiped the sword and thrust,
Let them go to hell.

Horses the rebellious warriors left.
Were driven back to the village by Semtay.
He called in the people on mountain around,
Built the tomb for the warriors.
He said the warriors had died a hero's death,
Put a tomb stone in the front,
Carved the words "Place Forty Warriors Died" on,
Since then it was the name of this place,
People called it the Place Forty Warriors Died,
The name AcKochybor Mazar,
Handed down from generation to generation.

Love Imbroglio among Krichorao, Kanchorao and Ackoyun

Kristan and Kankeldi,
They were two little kids,
They were struck dumb with fear,
Semtay spared them from his sword.

Semtay watched them carefully,
They were sturdy like metal,
Their eyes were as blue as diamond,
Wisdom showed through the fear.

"They will become useful person in the future",
Semtay told himself,
He could not leave them two casually,
He put them on the horse.

The two kids watched Semtay too,
He was valiant and heroic in bearing,
He was young and strong like a mountain.

Semtay checked the field carefully,
There was no living person left,
He put a pouch on his shoulder,
And carried the two kids in the pouch.

He mounted his horse,
The horse clip-clopped fast forward.
The black mane wolf left by the lion Manas,
Went back to his home in Kankoler.

He went alone and returned quickly,
The rebellious bastards,
Were all removed by him.

What Semtay did,
Made all his subjects praised.
The heroic daring of Semtay,
Amazed everyone that witnessed it.

The hero talked to Bakay unceasingly,
About this breath-taking experience.

"I chased after them,
My majestic uncle,
I dismounted and begged them,
I persuaded them sincerely,
I promised them I do not kill them if they come back,
I allowed them to discuss again.

"They said the slander to them cannot be forgiven,
They are unwilling to stay in Talas.
I stopped them and persuaded for a while,
They still refused to come back with me.

"They would rather go to Kunwuerbayi for shelter,
Than come back with me.
Going to Kunwuerbayi means making enemies of Kirgiz,
How I, Semtay, can put up with rebels who go over to enemy.

"They really made me angry,
Those black sheep among warriors,
I killed them into a disorderly pile of dead bodies.
My sword soaked with their blood,
I defended Kirgiz dignity with my action.
Those two little boys Gulidur and Kangbar,
I took them back with me safely.

"My mother Kanikai has told me,
Who are their parents.
If I kill the innocent children,
God will not forgive me either.

"My dear uncle,
Do not conclude that I am a cruel person.
They are going over to Kunwuerbayi,
I have no other choice,
How I can let such bastards off easily.

"My mother Kanikai once said,
The warriors my father left,
Would meet on my way,
But the truth is, except you,
I did not see anyone else.

"I presented my horse Tayibruler and my coat armor as gifts,
But they still did not agree to stay.
Choraos① did not have regrets left behind,
I built graves for them,
I buried them there,
I presented them to the spirits of the earth.

"Aweikai and Kobosh has died,
They lost their lives for killing me.
Let the orphans of these two warriors,
Be my bodyguards,
I will train them,
Observe them carefully.
Let the potential heroes grow up,
Let them become great heroes.

"They are thickly built with strong waist and shoulders,

① Choraos: It means warrior in Kirgiz language. It also has the meaning of company, friend and guard.

They must tear all their rivals up.
We must bring them up,
Let them be good at martial arts like powerful tigers.
I, Semtay, will be content,
With the company of these young heroes.

"Mother Kanikai and uncle Bakay,
According to your request,
I have brought the kids back safely."

Kanikai said with smile:
"My boy, you did good,
I must explain to you clearly,
The prediction after Kankeldi was born.

"When Kankeldi grows up,
He will be the person to pull your collar,
He will betray you to your enemies,
He will tie you up and give you to Karamark people.

"When I fed him with my milk after he was born,
My breast dripped with blood,
There will be one day in the future,
He will make your blood splash.
I was not hardhearted enough to kill the infant,
Now you can make your decision."

Heard what his mother Kanikai said,
Semtay started to say his idea:
"Kanikai, my mother,
We have wiped out Jagurp Khan,
Killed wicked Aweikai,
And banished tyrannical Kobosh to the hell.
We punished rebellious warriors,
We retook the throne of Khan and our land,
We also rescued suffering fellows and villagers.

"Now,
We must unite all Arashi heroes,
And resist Karamark with one heart.
Make Kunwuerbayi pay the blood debt,
Avenge my father Manas' death.

"Kristan and Kankeldi,
Are the offspring of our elders,
Kankeldi is my brother too.
Only God knows,
What will happen in the future.
We cannot hurt him,
We will care for and train him.

"Two boys will be my close Choraos when they grow up,
I will give them new names,
Kristan will be Krichorao,
Kankeldi will be Kanchorao.
The reputation of two Choraos,
Will circulate in the world."

Heard what Semtay said,
Mother Kanikai cleared uncertainties up in her heart.
Her son Semtay possessed the ambition of a king,
Kanikai felt proud and satisfied.

"They are natural sons of Khans,
I will hold a wedding banquet for them."
Followed his mother Kanikai's instruction,
Semtay gave the order to prepare for the banquet.

He ordered to move Kanikai's giant yurt,
To his father's former site.
The former site finally,
Was four arm-span area larger.

Kanikai warned at the moment:

"My boy, do not pitch the yurt here,
Your father once lived here,
And courted the unexpected calamity,
There are plenty roomy places in Kankoler,
There are enough suitable places for you to choose."

"It was an ominous place when my father lived here,
But your son Semtay will make it propitious.
My father's site fell into disuse for many years,
Because those bastards dare not pitch their yurts here,
They were scared when they see this place."

Semtay did not listen to the advice,
Pitched his own palace yurt forcibly,
At the door of Nasirkurgan.

Eighty mares were butchered,
Feted the honorable guests coming for the banquet.
A grand banquet was held for those two kids,
And presented them with brocade robes.

"Warriors always get the awards,
When they contest face to face,
It is the tradition and custom,
Let them two kids fight against each other,
The winner will get the award."

Semtay made the decision then and there:
"Shihay and Jagurp Khan,
They are brothers with same mother,
His son Chinkogeo is my uncle,
Chikogeo's daughter Ackoyun is my cousin.
Among the beauties in the world,
No one could compare with her.

"Krichorao and Kanchorao,
They are offspring of Almanbet and Chuwak,

They are the blood and flesh of the two lions.
They sucked my mother's milk,
They are like my siblings.

"Anyone that defeats the other,
The winner will get her as a reward,
Let the kids live happily like in the heaven."

"Semtay is a true man."
His words were praised.

Chinkogeo, who listened by the side,
Did not dare to resist then and there,
But grumbled in low voice:

"My beautiful daughter,
Becomes the reward of the wrestling boys,
She is a living person,
She is also a noble princess."
She felt her dignity was humiliated,
More hatred grew in her heart.

Two little warriors started to wrestle,
They were around ten years old.

Almanbet's son Krichorao,
Rode on Aweikai's Aktilk① steed.
Chuwak's son Kanchorao,
Mounted Kobosh's Surtilk② steed.

Young heroes whipped the steeds under them,
Held the shining spear tight in the hands,

① Aktilk: Kirgiz language. It is the name of a horse. It means the horse is like a white dwarf musk deer.

② Surtilk: Kirgiz language. It is the name of a horse. It means the horse is like a grey dwarf musk deer.

Competed with each other face to face,
Many Nuoyi shouted and cheered for them.
The young kids went into the fierce fighting,
Showed their courage and strength.
One round was fought face to face,
Then two spears clinked,
They pulled each other's shoulders.

The two kids chased and fought,
From dawn to dusk,
Whipped the horses and fought,
They did not defeat the other one.

The sun set, the night came,
Semtay came up and held the reins:
"That's it, brothers, stop!"
He led them to his white palace yurt.

In order to let them modestly decline,
A middleman was arranged to mediate.

The elders all gathered,
They put the two kids by the door,
Came to sound each of them out.

They called Krichorao into the yurt first,
Bakay talked to him:
"Your big brother wants you to marry,
He said he can help you marry a beauty,
He takes care of you like natural brothers.

"If there are no suitable Nuoyi girls for you,
He will help you marry a Russian girl.
If there are no Russian girls you like,
He will pick Afghanistan girls for you.
If he cannot make you satisfied on this,
The gossips from others will be too much to bear.

"If there are no Kirgiz girls you like,
He will go and pick among Khitan girls.
He said he does not fear the death,
And not fear knives or guns either.
What kind of beauties do you really want to marry?
Tell us now, Krichorao!"

Krichorao blush before he could speak,
He said with a very firm tone:
"I do not want to marry,
A good man should take the tribe into consideration first,
Before I make any achievements,
How can I marry first?"

But the elders did not let him go,
They insisted on letting him speak out a name,
They asked again and again.

"If my big brother said I must marry someone,
Then let me marry Ackoyun,
If God bless me with this love."
Finally they got Krichorao's heartfelt wish,
The elders asked him to wait outside for the final decision.

Krichorao went out of the door,
While Kanchorao was wandering there,
He did not hear what was talking inside,
And he was called into the room.

For the question of his marriage,
They started to ask again.
"If my big brother let me marry,
I want to marry Ackoyun."
He also spoke his heartfelt wish out.

Krichorao was called in too then,

The elders told them the results:
"Semtay let you pick girls to marry,
You two both pick Ackoyun."

Kanchorao stood up immediately and said:
"It is the Kirgiz tradition,
Man should get married and have separate kitchen when he grows up,
This is the custom descended from our ancestors.

"Before a pot of tea was ready,
Krichorao was born,
So he is my big brother.
I decide to drop out,
Krichorao should get Ackoyun!"

"Kanchorao is absolutely right!"
People could not agree more on what he said,
They all applauded warmly.

The elders reported to Semtay immediately,
About what happened just now.
Semtay got their information,
He sent a matchmaker to bring up a marriage:

"Chinkogeo is an elder of mine,
He and my father are cousins,
I am also his kid.

"Almanbet's son Krichorao,
He is Khan's son of noble birth,
Let Chinkogeo's daughter marry Krichorao,
They are equal in social status.
Let the matchmaker set out quickly,
Repeat what I said to Chinkogeo word by word."

Chinkogeo heard what the matchmaker said,
He flew into a rage:

"How he can insult me and my identity of a Khan like this,
I will never marry my daughter to a slave.

"Semtay, Semtay,
Do not consider me as Aweikai,
I am not Kobosh either.
Let your dream go to hell,
How I can endure your arrogance and impudicity!"

Chinkogeo flew into a great rage,
He talked wildly without thinking about the consequences.
The matchmaker returned immediately,
Brought Chinkogeo's word back.

When Semtay heard these words,
He also stamped with rage,
Young and aggressive lion Semtay gave the order:
"Call Krichorao and Kanchorao in,
Ask them to come to me right now!"

"I have sent matchmaker to bring up the proposal,
Chinkogeo does not agree on the marriage,
Who has a brilliant idea,
On how to marry Ackoyun?"

Krichorao opened his mouth with a smile,
His words always carried weight and elegance:
"I am waiting for your permission,
I miss her deep in my heart,
As long as you agree, big brother,
Let me do it by myself.

"As long as I am still alive,
I can conquer her any time.
I will take her home with me quietly,
When she is playing outside."

Semtay thought Krichorao was right,
But he was afraid Ackoyun did not want to marry.
In order not to hurt the girl's pride,
Semtay gave his order:

"Go ahead, young heroes,
You must take the girl back.
Set a big fire,
In the heart of stubborn Chinkogeo!"

After Semtay finished his words,
Two young men went away together.
Ackoyun with fifteen companions,
Were playing the game hide-and-seek.

In the time of Aweikai and Kobosh,
Krichorao and Ackoyun,
They studied together,
They fell in love with each other from then on.
Ackoyun and Krichorao,
They had been of one mind.

Pretending to play together,
Krichorao and Kanchorao,
Got close to the girl gradually.

There was a girl named Kalicha,
She had a dark and beautiful face,
She was eloquent and beautiful.
She and young hero Kanchorao,
Fell in love at first sight.

Krichorao walked up and said quietly:
"Oh, my dear Ackoyun,
My big brother Semtay,
Agreed to marry you to me.
He had sent a matchmaker to propose a marriage,

But your father did not say anything good.

"He raved wildly against the matchmaker,
It made my big brother mad.
He talked to me:
'If you really love her,
Ackoyun is my sister,
You go and take her back!'"

Kalicha stood aside and heard his words,
She started an unceasing flow of words in a clear voice:
"Mother gives birth to daughter,
Daughter will get married sooner or later.

"Take the girl forcibly and get married,
It is a Kirgiz custom.
It is not disgraceful,
It is very common down the ages.

"As long as two persons love each other,
It is right to get married.
Krichorao comes for you,
You cannot disappoint him.

"Kanchorao comes for me,
I will not hurt his heart.
Semtay sent them here,
Why do not we go with them?

"We all make a pledge of love,
How we can be apart from each other,
Let's go with them,
Do not hurt their pride."

Ackoyun followed Kalicha's suggestion,
Both of them went with the young heroes.
Holding the hands of two girls,

Two young heroes were profoundly happy,
They came into Semtay's palace.

Kirgiz young people choose their spouses freely,
It is a custom praised by the world.

The news of the girls' running away,
Spread to Chinkogeo soon.
He could not accept the truth,
He sent someone to Semtay's palace and delivered the message.

"I said I would not marry my daughter to Krichorao,
But the damn girl ran away with him,
It made me ashamed and it was harmful to morals,
Please return the girl to me!

"We can discuss again in good manner,
Hold the wedding according to the custom.
Let us hold the wedding decently,
Please give us one-year time,
Let us prepare for the wedding,
Please do not make us embarrassed.

"As long as God bless us,
Let us be healthy and harmonious,
We can wait till next year when the livestock get fat,
We can hold the wedding ceremony then, is it ok?"

Heard the suggestions from Chinkogeo,
Semtay agreed:
"That's the way it is, my elder,
Please make good preparations!

"We have prepared generous betrothal,
We wait for him to come and take the gold, silver and the silk,
We wait for him to come and visit the luxurious bridal yurt,
We also wait to see the dowry he prepares.

"If he delays the time of the wedding,
If he disobeys his promise,
He will regret then,
Do not complain that I do not give him face."

"Let the girls go back!"
The hero gave his orders,
So the two girls were sent back home.

Kanchorao and Krichorao,
Had to bury their sorrow in the heart.
The lovers did not have chance to get married,
No happy stories came out.

Chinkogeo Intended to Force Ayichulek to Marry Him

Chinkogeo Encircled Akun Khan City with His Troops and Intended to Force Ayichulek to Marry Him

Winter had gone,
Spring was coming happily.
Numerous Nuoyi people,
Were busy with moving,
They were moving to the cool summer pastures.

Neighbors all moved,
But Chinkogeo still lived there without moving,
He had already known where he would go.

He castrated male horses and used as draft horses,
He castrated male sheep and used as wether,
He also prepared plenty of food they would need on the way.

When people were busy with moving to summer pastures,
Toward the direction of sunset,
He set out secretly to Jetsu[①].

Twelve months passed,
He arrived at Jedigair tribe,
And dismounted in the Ayinla of the tribal headman Toltoy.

Chinkogeo said to himself:
"My daughter Ackoyun,
She is a unique beautiful girl in the world,
If I present her to Toltoy,
I can use his troops to deal with Semtay."

① Jetsu: It originally means seven rivers. Later it refers to seven rivers in Central Asia.

Chinkogeo made up his mind,
He came to hero Toltoy's home.
He told Toltoy his purpose in coming,
Toltoy was very happy about it.

He felt so excited that his heart beat fast,
He ordered his servants,
To drive a pen of sheep,
To drive a herd of horses,
Held Yorluik① to fete Chinkogeo,
To thank him for bringing such good news.

"You come from afar, Chinkogeo,
Welcome you to be my neighbor,
You betroth your beautiful daughter to me,
I am very happy you do this.
You look weighed down with care,
Do you have something worrisome or have any enemy?

"You come to my Ayinla from afar,
Are you coming for riding my steeds?
You come and become my close neighbor,
Are you coming for wearing my brocade clothes?

"If you want to ride my horse,
I am willing to present my black-spotted horse to you.
Everyone sees it like a four-wing magic horse,
If you ride on it and fight against your enemy,
You will fly,
Then you must kill numerous enemies.

"Ride on it, my friend,
It can dispel the secret anguish in your heart,
It is a magic horse with four wings,

① Yorluik: It is a Kirgiz custom. It is a ceremony to welcome people move to the village from other place.

No one dares ride it except the deity.

"It is an unmatched Pegasus,
Since I own it,
Till today,
I never put a saddle on it,
I cannot bear to ride it.

"If you want to wear my coat armor,
I will present you with my gold string coat armor.
It is a rare treasure,
You will be invincible if you wear it."

When Toltoy treated him generously,
Shihay's son Chinkogeo said:
"I come neither for riding your horse,
Nor for wearing your coat armor,
Manas' son Semtay is the only reason,
He hid far away and came back suddenly,
All what he had done,
Completely discredited me as a Khan.

"Shatimur's granddaughter Chachykai,
I intended to marry her,
But he blocked in front of me and married her.
I feel painful for this,
It is hard to swallow the resentment.

"He did not think he was wrong,
He sent a matchmaker to propose a marriage,
Tried to marry my daughter Ackoyun,
To his guard.

"I did not agree to the marriage,
He instigated his guard to take Ackoyun away.
I told a lie to him,
I took my daughter back home.

I could not bear it,
I was filled with anger.
I wish to know heroes in the world,
So I come and find the help from friends,
I move to your village,
I want to become your relative through marriage and get your protection!"

When he finished his words,
Headman Toltoy of Jedigair people,
Lowered his head and did not reply for a while.
He was absorbed in meditation,
After weighing and considering for a long time,
He had an idea:

"There is a Khan called Akun Khan,
Ayichulek① is his beloved daughter.
Before Semtay was born,
Manas and the Khan pointed to the belly,
And proposed the marriage for them.
Manas made one thousand camels carry tea,
And presented countless gold and silver,
To be the betrothal for his son.

"As long as we lead our good soldiers and generals,
To attack Akun Khan's capital city,
Ayichulek, as pretty as the moon,
Will be taken away by us.
We will make a tragedy for Semtay,
Make him cry to the sky.

"At dawn tomorrow morning,
I will call all my people in,
I will give them orders solemnly,

① Ayichulek: She is also called Chulek. Ayi means the moon, it refers to the girl as beautiful and innocent as the moon. She is the fairy with two wings that transformed from a white swan.

I will form a powerful troop.

"Recruit strong soldiers,
Assign efficient generals,
Sharpshooters who never miss targets,
Brawny executioners,
Spearmen who are good at martial art,
I have enough good soldiers and generals."

Toltoy called in his subjects next morning,
People were like groups of animals,
Crowded in narrow lanes.

Toltoy of Jedigair tribe,
And Shihay's son Chinkogeo,
They carefully picked out:
Knife men to use knife,
Sharpshooters to shoot a gun,
Executioners to wave the axe,
Spearmen to use spears,
And eloquent speakers,
All elites gathered there.

They made the roll and registered soldiers,
Estimated the time,
Decided the journey,
They plotted a battle of abducting the bride.

Shihay's son Chinkogeo,
Went to Toltoy of Jedigair tribe for shelter,
He exchanged his beautiful daughter,
With the black-spotted Pegasus with four wings.

Chinkogeo thought the relation was not close enough,
He and Toltoy swore to stick together in life and death,
He asked his son-in-law and friends for twelve thousand soldiers,
Prepared to force Ayichulek to marry him.

"Semtay, son of Kangkoer,
Wants to marry Ayichulek.
I will besiege Akun Khan's city with picked troops,
I will marry Semtay's fiancée forcibly,
I will make Semtay a disgraced man,
I will show the world my power."

Chinkogeo thought excitedly,
With hero Toltoy,
Led twelve thousand soldiers,
Marched toward the Akun Khan's city,
Intended to besiege the city and take the beauties forcibly.

Toltoy from Jedigair tribe,
Warned and discussed with him:
"Underestimating the enemy is not excusable,
The hidden troops are the most horrible.

"We send a messenger to Akun Khan first,
Deliver a letter gentle in words to discuss with him,
To figure out the deployment of his troops,
Then we can make efficient attacks.

"If Akun Khan does not agree,
We just take Ayichulek forcibly,
Then stamp his city flat."

Chinkogeo was excited about his suggestion:
"Right, this is a good idea,
It is in complete accord with my intentions.
Who is the best messenger?
He should be brave and careful."

Eloquent Kalabay, stood aside,
Had read Khan's mind,
He volunteered to go as the messenger.

He rode on his white-necked claret stallion,
Galloped off the road like the wind,
Gusts of sand and dust rose behind him,
He arrived at the gate of Akun Khan's city in an instant.

The city wall was built with rocks,
And the foundation of the bottom of the city gate was iron rocks.
Kalabay shouted loudly at the gate:
"Kalasart[1],
Open the city gate for me quickly!

"I will go in the city,
I will step on the streets of navy rocks,
I have a very important news,
To report to your Akun Khan."

Kalabay whipped his stallion,
Shouted and burst into the city gate.
Kalabay shouted and galloped forward:
"Ayi, Akun Khan! Akun Khan!"

Akun Khan's gold throne,
Was soft with cotton bedding cushions.
He lay on his back and rested in his throne,
Suddenly he heard the crazy shouts outside of his palace.
He was startled as the time of his death was coming,
His face was pale and legs were quivered.

"Is the time of my doom coming?
Where does my enemy come from?
Where does this ferocious tiger come from?"
He wore a pair of overshoes on his bare feet,
Put on a coat on his bare body,
Ran out of his palace in panic.

① Kalasart: It refers to the guard of the city gate.

Kalabay shouted as he saw him:
"Oh, Akun Khan!
I am the messenger of Chinkogeo and Toltoy.

"Toltoy from Jedigair tribe,
Leads seventy thousand elite troops.
Shihay's son Chinkogeo,
Leads sixty thousand elite troops.
They follow the road of horse caravan,
They have got close to your city,
Your city is just like the size of a palm,
They will besiege it with three-ring soldiers.

"They said, send moon-like Ayichulek,
To Chinkogeo to be his wife,
If you do not want to present Chulek,
They will fight against you.

"They said, send sun-like Chulek,
To Chinkogeo to be his wife,
If you do not want to present Chulek,
They let you decide the time of starting a battle.

"They said, they will change the direction of the rivers,
They said, they will dam the spring that runs to the city,
They said, they will make you all die in the city,
Do not let the infants sleep in mothers' arms.

"Do not let mares rest in the pen,
Do not let you plough,
Do not let you sow in spring and harvest in autumn,
They will lock you in the city and let you die!
Then they will take sun-like Chulek away,
Take her forcibly."

Akun Khan heard what the messenger said,
He shook his head and gnashed the teeth in anger,

Gave the orders to his soldiers:

"Catch him, catch this slave,
Ask him,
Did I go to Toltoy's land,
Did I kill his brothers?
My Chulek is as beautiful as the moon,
Ask me to present her to them,
Am I their mortal enemy?

"Did I go to Chinkogeo's homeland?
Did I rob his horses?
My daughter is as beautiful as the sun,
Ask me to present her to them,
Do I owe them blood debt?

"Look at the stupid slave,
Look at him,
His abusive words are offensive,
Cut his tongue out!

"Listen to his load of rubbish,
We should cut his belly.
Pull this bastard out of my city!"

Majestic Khans gave the order,
His soldiers rushed up,
Got ready to drag the maniac out of the city gate.

Agile slave Kalabay,
Stirred the white-necked claret stallion with his legs,
He waved the whip and galloped out of the city,
Fled away in panic.

The messenger returned and told Chinkogeo:
"Ah, my respected Chinkogeo,
I have been to the four corners of the world,

I have been to east, west, south, and north.
Beautiful girl like Chulek,
I have never seen.

"If Chulek swallows a grape,
You can see it through her throat.
If Chulek swallows melon,
You can see it through her throat.
If Chulek swallows an apricot,
You can see it through her gullet.

"If you look at her eyebrows,
They are better than the crescent moon,
Look at her eyelids and eyelashes,
It seems they are penciled with ink,
Look at her cheeks,
They are seductive as a ripe apple."

Heard the report of the messenger,
Shihay's son Chinkogeo,
Was unable to control his excitement.
The white eagle was tied with gold chain,
He loosed the chain,
Let it fly toward the moon.
The black-spotted steed was tied with silver chain,
He loosed the chain,
Let it fly toward the sun.

Chinkogeo rode on the black-spotted steed,
Soared in the white clouds in the sky.
He lit the fuse of the six-shot powder gun,
And shot six times.
He drew the bow,
And shot six blue arrows.

Akun Khan told himself at the moment:
"I need call my troops in,

And fight against Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
I must defeat these two bastards.

"I would rather fight against them,
And try to defeat them,
Than present my daughter as beautiful as the sun to them."

Akun Khan made up his mind,
Then he ordered his troops,
Held the spears in the hands and rode on horses,
Rushed out of the city gate to the battlefield.

Akun Khan's troops,
Rushed and fought face to face,
There was blood everywhere in the battlefield in an instant.

Held the long pine spears in the hands,
Fought face to face,
The heads of spears stabbed into the chests of warriors.

Spears waved, knives and axes clanged,
People shouted and horses neighed.
Warriors rushed and fought from the left side,
Generals waved spears and resisted from the right side,
Blood made the soldiers' faces red.
Numerous soldiers of two Khans,
Fought in the battlefield.

Akun Khan's elite troops,
In a short time,
Had more than sixty heroes died.
Too many soldiers of two Khans,
Died and injured severely in the battle.
Both sides suffered heavy casualties,
They both held the fire temporarily and rested.

The war descended a great disaster,

To the people who lived in peace.
When spring came,
Farmers were not allowed to go out of the city to plough.
When winter came,
Woodcutters were not allowed to go out to cut firewood.
When autumn came,
Fat lamb meat was impossible to eat.
Akun Khan's subjects,
Fell in the depths of the disaster.

Akun Khan could not bear it,
They fought another two fierce battles,
For the sake of Ayichulek,
Both sides were angry with great hatred.

Chinkogeo led his troops from far away,
Could not capture Akun Khan's city,
And could not take Ayichulek away.

Troops of both sides were at a stalemate,
Were exhausted from the battles.
None of them could win easily,
No one came and mediated between them.

Ayichulek Asked Semtay for Help

Akun Khan's son Ajebay,
Bay's son Tirmechik,
Advisor Tumanbay,
And eloquent Kalbek,
They surrounded Ayichulek,
Gave ideas to Akun Khan:

"Ayichulek is as pretty as the moon,
We'd better present her to them.
We have already had a lot of warriors lost their lives,
Grand palace and city are also destroyed,
Chinkogeo and Toltoy are two natural devils,
It seems they will not let it go."

After hearing Tumanbay's advice,
Akun Khan, who felt helpless,
Sighed in despair:
"White silk thread ties on the legs of white eagle.
Your moon-like sister,
Connects with a secret story!
There will be a person holding axe and knife,
Come and fight for her anytime,
He will discuss with me and remove the enemy for me.

"Trade caravans were intercepted at Tumshowk mountain,
Everyone knew it in the past.
Intercepted tea carried with one thousand camels,
Which belonged to Georoy and Kunwuerbayi.
He occupied Sarikoler,

He drove and butchered numerous yak,
Which belonged to powerful Kalercha.

"In the battle of Kashgar,
He cut Kaledayi's head off,
Took the clean brocade robe off.
He killed all the warriors that resisted him,
Then no one dared come and revolt.

"He is the world-famous heroic Khan,
He is king Manas of Kirgiz.

"One day, he went around Oboltao mountain,
Marched toward Yurganchy river,
Hunted the bharal along their journey,
They trudged and crossed mountains.
They were generous with their treasure,
They presented countless livestock.
I made an agreement with him in front of all Khans,
That I would marry Ayichulek to his unborn son,
Made the promise of a marriage by pointing to the belly.

"I got to know recently,
Hero Manas has died unfortunately,
Under the lead of his father Jagurp,
His half brothers,
With same father and different mothers,
Robbed all of his property and treasure.

"Qierdy and Kanikai,
Had taken preventive action to the evil deeds of Jagurp,
They gave Semtay to Saritaz and hid him in other place,
Then they raised the boy Saritaz picked,
They loved the boy as their own.

"These two stupid pigs,
Mistook the boy for Semtay.

They held human lives cheap,
They grabbed the boy away from Kanikai's hands,
Tore and threw him on the ground.
Then they boasted they killed their enemy,
They were worse than animals.

"Taking the boy from Saritaz away secretly,
Poor Kanikai had nowhere to go,
Helped her mother-in-law by the arm and held the baby in her arms,
Fled to her parents and asked Kara Khan for a shelter,
And raised the boy there.

"The orphan grew up through hardships,
Finally he grows into a strong young man,
I heard that he is very brave and smart.
Manas' son Semtay,
Has become a real hero.

"He is strong with thick and powerful back and shoulders,
He becomes a peerless hero.
I heard he defeated iron-armed hero,
Has become a powerful warrior.

"I heard all his information,
I heard his legend:
He removed his grandfather Jagurp,
Wiped his uncle Aweikai out decisively,
Sent Kobosh to the hell,
He showed his power and vigor as a black mane wolf.

"Insurgent warriors tried to flee away,
I heard he killed them all.
Anyone that makes trouble and makes him angry,
Will have no good end.
He dares to take responsibility for what he has done,
Enemy's blood,
He dares to drink it like liquor.

"At the ceremony of Koktoy,
When wise Kanikai,
Presented Kanidahay leather pants,
Venerable old Koshaoyi Khan,
Could not ease his excitement,
Prayed for the madam for a son in public.
God bestowed her with a great son,
That is the peerless hero Semtay Khan.

"No one could challenge Semtay,
There is nothing one can do except die if he is challenged.
Although he is generous and magnanimous,
He never forgives evil person easily.
If we present Chulek to Chinkogeo,
How can we reply if Semtay comes back?
You suggest to present Ayichulek,
How can you give such a suggestion?"

Akun Khan burst into a fury,
Reprimanded severely the long-tongued.
What had happened in the past,
Ajebay knew nothing about it.

Tumanbay did not know it either,
Bay's son Tirmechik,
Kabek, rode the spotted horse,
All blushed and lowered their head silently.

Exposing her white teeth as the fairy,
Ayichulek spoke with a smile:
"Chinkogeo and Toltoy's request,
I will give them the answer,
I would rather die if I do not have a good countermove.

"I would rather die immediately,
Or fly in the sky with clouds,

Than become their war trophy."

People never knew she could fly,
So no one understood the meaning of "fly".
People present were surprised,
All asked her to give an idea to deal with the enemies,
All begged Ayichulek for protecting them.

In order to deal with those evil enemies,
Ayichulek thought hard about the scheme.

Among the subjects of Akun Khan,
There was an able man called Elichybek,
Every time people gathered,
He presided over the meeting.

Elegant Ayichulek,
Called uncle Elichybek to her mind:
"Please call uncle Elichybek,
I am lonely here,
Ask him to come and talk with me."

Two ladies were sent to call him,
One was Elichybek's daughter-in-law,
The other one was his daughter Suyorhan.

Suyorhan went to her father and said:
"My respected father,
Sister Ayichulek asked you to go to her,
She said she is in a hurry,
She has urgent thing to discuss with you!

"I come and invite you,
Sister Ayichulek,
It seems she has something to do so she will fly to the sky."
Heard his daughter and daughter-in-law's words,
Elichybek set out right away:

"Fairy's girl Ayichulek,
Doesn't she leave us?"

Akun Khan's grand city,
Had two parallel gates,
One was painted red,
One other was whitewashed with lime.

The red gate,
Was always guarded tight,
That was the palace where Akun Khan lived.
If there were orders to give out to the people,
That was the place the Khan gave the order.

In the white gate,
It was Ayichulek's palace.
She was accompanied by eighty servants,
Forty of them were married ladies and the other forty were girls,
They always played together happily.

Her handmaids were all girls,
There were ten married ladies in the kitchen,
They were all Ayichulek's servants,
They followed her orders and took care of her daily life.

Elichybek walked in with great respect,
Ayichulek was very happy about it.
She came out of the door,
Welcomed the elder Elichybek.
Led him into the empty palace,
And into another room.

Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Put new clothes on Elichybek,
And served him with delicious food,
Made Elichybek content.

Chulek said:
"Oh, my respected uncle,
I need to discuss with you:
Please go to Toltoy's camp,
Do me a favor.

"Please tell what I said to Chinkogeo,
And figure out their information by the way.
Do not stay there too long,
You must return here by tomorrow evening.

"Pray to God, bless you a smooth journey,
Do not need to take responsibility for telling lies to enemies.
For that bloodsucker Toltoy,
I will cheat him with lies.

"Wish the sages accompany you,
Bring you good luck,
All the words you tell them,
Are my plot to them.

"You tell them, 'Chulek sends me here,
She knows you are fearlessly brave.'
You tell them, 'respected lion Chinkogeo,
Ayichulek is willing to lower her head to you!'

"You tell them, 'Ayichulek said personally,
She would like Chinkogeo to be her husband,
She would like Toltoy to be her nephew,
This is her best luck in her life!'

"You tell them, 'Ayichulek does not like to stay in Yurkainichy river,
She wishes Jetsu can be a good place for her to live!
Her father Akun Khan does not allow you to marry her,
But she has made up her mind to marry you.'
You try your best to tell lies to them,
You should tell the lies like they are real.

You tell them, 'in order to prepare for the wedding,
Please give her ninety days,'
You must bring their response back to me."

Old Elichybek heard what she said,
Felt nervous:
"I never tell lies to anyone,
In case I make something wrong,
How I can bear others' abuse!
How I can, in my later years,
Lose my dignity and reputation!"

In order not to disobey Ayichulek,
He did not say, "I do not want to go".

Elichybek walked out of the door,
Went to Toltoy's camp with reluctance.
The wise friend had already waited by the door,
Tumanbay walked to him and asked:

"Uncle Elichy, where are you going?
Your face is pale,
Your steps are halting,
Your eyes look flustered,
What happened?"

Elichybek said at the moment:
"Tumanbay, listen carefully,
I will tell you a hidden secret:
Khan's princess Ayichulek,
She makes a big trouble for me!
She said, 'you go to Toltoy,
You must try to hold him up!'
She said, 'you go to Chinkogeo,
You must try your best to cheat him,
And bring his sincere words back!'

"I am in a hurry to do it,
This is where I need to go.
I feel shy to refuse,
What does the servant do when the master gives an order?"

Tumanbay said:
"My uncle, please wait a second,
What you said is not complete!
The secrets in Ayichulek's heart,
She did not tell you all!

"It is very far between two places,
How can you get there if you do not ride a fine horse?
If you go as a messenger on foot,
Two ferocious tigers Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
How can you deal with them?
Once you meet troubles or you are hungry and thirsty,
Where do you find a company to help you?

"If we want to defeat those two slaves,
We need unite and make up our minds,
Do not let them notice a clue,
In order to delay their time of attacking,
We need leave nothing untried!
Even if we do not send message to Semtay,
Ayichulek will go by herself and ask him for help.

"As long as we hold them up,
Powerful king Semtay,
Will take his troops to come!
The black mane wolf's son Semtay,
Will defeat the enemies!

"If he defeats Toltoy,
These two evil ruffians will die out.
We ask them to give some extra time,
Try to win more time for the girl.

Kirgiz hero Semtay,
Will not blame us!

"Uncle Elichy,
Let me go with you as your company!
Uncle, please calm down,
Allow me to prepare an old clothes."

He took off his official robe,
And put it at home,
From the horses outside his house,
He picked two fine horses.
Elichybek and Tumanbay,
Toward the camp of Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
Whipped and galloped their horses as messengers.

Passed the old water mill,
Crossed Tarmalsaz swamp,
Old Elichybek and Tumanbay,
Passed by many strange places.

They could not stop on their way,
They could not turn their heads,
For the sake of their master Ayichulek,
They disregarded the hardship of the wind and sand.

They rushed to the enemy camp,
Thought what they should say on their way,
If there was any crack in their words,
The sequence would be unbearable.

When they saw Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
Tumanbay started to talk first:
"Respected Berks Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
We come from Akun Khan's city,
As private messengers.
Akun Khan does not know we are coming here,

It is Ayichulek's idea."

Then Elichybek began to explain:
"Ayichulek is a fairy,
She is beautiful and smart,
She asked us to see you without letting Akun Khan know.

"She said, 'my father Akun Khan is old and not as wise as before,
He does not allow me to marry the hero.
He is old and unaware of his own limited ability,
It is he who causes the trouble.'

"She said, 'If Chinkogeo is really in a hurry,
Please let her prepare for ninety days,
If Chinkogeo can wait,
Please give her six months to prepare.'

"She said, 'I will prepare a grand wedding,
I will leave home decently.'
She said, 'Toltoy is my nephew,
Chinkogeo is the hero I will marry.'
So she sent us to see you.

"This is all Ayichulek wants to tell you.
She pleads again and again,
Ask you to give her six months.'

"She said she will make preparation for the wedding,
She will prepare everything well.
Toltoy as strong as a mountain,
She is very happy to be her aunt.

"She said, 'There is nothing like an absolute secret,
There are no good words that can hide all the time,
Heroes like Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
No beautiful girls can control themselves not to love him.'
This is the purpose I came here,

These are what I need to tell you."

Chinkogeo thought for a while,
Spoke out his worry:
"Why does Ayichulek need six months?
Does she plan to fly to a remote place?
Does she want to find a man she loves to marry?"

Stupid Toltoy heard what they said,
He felt disappointed with Chinkogeo's worry:
"Chinkogeo, let your thinking go to hell!
What nonsense are you talking about?
To find a man aimlessly,
Ayichulek is not such a degrading person!

"She is not a low girl,
She will not break her promise,
She is not a butterfly,
She sends private messenger to you,
In order to prepare the wedding.
You doubt her like this,
What you said is hurting her!

"Married the beauty Chachykai not long ago,
Semtay is still excited about it,
He will not marry Chulek,
He will not exhaust himself to come a thousand miles here.

"Chinkogeo, if you are sincere,
Accept what the messenger told you,
I have told you just now,
This is what kind of person Chulek is.

"She sent Elichybek as the messenger,
Explained to you and apologized to you!
If you think six months are too long,
Then you just give her ninety days.

"Till then,
Ayichulek must give you a perfect wedding.
This is my suggestion,
You can decide by yourself."

Chinkogeo heard this,
He did not argue with Toltoy.
Chinkogeo had no other choice but to say:
"I will give her ninety days!"

Tumanbay said at the moment:
"Brother-in-law Chinkogeo, hero Toltoy,
I am Ayichulek's brother,
Messenger Elichybek is my uncle.
If Ayichulek did not order us,
How can we come to you?

"We are afraid the wedding will not be ready,
If you do not consider six months are too long,
You'd better give her six months,
Let pretty Chulek make good preparations,
Do not make her feel embarrassed!"

Shihay's son Chinkogeo said:
"Elichybek, Tumanbay,
Since you come to me now,
Why do you look down upon me?
Why do you start the trouble?
As the saying goes, 'As long as lower the head to you,
Even father's murder can be forgiven!'

"I am very happy and satisfied,
You come to me personally.
Five months,
That is my final deadline!

"I do not need any dowry and property,
Do not want to make troubles for you either.
Please let Ayichulek be at ease,
Do not think six months are too long for me,
Do not doubt my patience.

"I do not have any evil thoughts toward her,
As long as she can understand my heart,
All I have said is right,
As long as she can understand my lion-like character.

"When the last day of five months comes,
Open all the gates of your city,
Let my troops go in.
Prepare thirty married ladies and thirty girls,
Let them line up and welcome me,
And they need say, 'My heroic brother-in-law comes!'
Let them serve me and welcome me!

"When that time comes, Elichybek,
I will make everyone satisfied,
I will let you be a minister.

"I will make her city run rivers of oil,
I will fill her lakes full with horse milk.
I will let the moon hang on her skylight,
I will make her people happy forever.

"Everything the wedding needs I will prepare,
Please tell Chulek to be at ease,
I will drive camels with nine betrothal gifts,
Let the livestock be full in her pasture.

"I will present countless gold, silver and brocade,
As long as I can marry Ayichulek,
I will do my best and have nothing to regret even if I die.
In order to make the wedding preparation faster,

Please return to your city as soon as possible.

"Tumanbay, my brother-in-law comes to me,
You have seen everything here,
You have known the situation,
You should feel lucky for this journey.

"When Ayichulek comes to my home,
My black-spotted magic horse with four wings,
I will let you ride on,
The magic horse for the hero,
I will present to you as a gift.

"No matter how powerful the enemy will be,
I have peerless soldiers!
No matter how fierce the battle will be,
My giant Toltoy is undefeatable!
This is my, Chinkogeo's, promise,
Please tell Ayichulek carefully."

Chinkogeo had told them all his decision,
The time he prolonged,
Had had ninety days passed,
Elichybek and Tumanbay,
Set out for the returning journey with satisfaction.

Elichybek came back quickly,
He came to Chulek in a hurry,
Reported everything to her:

"My dear kid Ayichulek!
We tried our best and convinced him finally,
We tried all our ways,
And get a few months more.
"Chinkogeo said once he marries Chulek,
He will let me be his minister,
He wants to be the king of Jetsu.

He said, his black-spotted horse with four wings,
He will present it to Tumanbay.

"He said, in order to let you play happily,
He will put up a swing,
Tie it with silk ropes,
Build a playing paradise for you.

"He said, if the five-month time is due,
He will occupy our city mercilessly.

"This is what I have done,
This is what he has promised."

Clever Ayichulek was happy about what she had heard,
Showed her white teeth and warned them:

"If Chinkogeo becomes my husband,
You will become Chinkogeo's minister,
Do you feel content?
Uncle, do you forget my trust to you?
My will does not change,
I will not give in even if there is no way.

"As long as God blesses,
I will go to the remote place,
No matter how hard it is on the journey.
As long as we defeat Chinkogeo,
Catch the ferocious devil Toltoy,
Till then, my uncle,
You can be a real minister.
It will earn you with honor and reputation of justice.

"Chinkogeo has no place to shelter himself in his homeland,
He wanders and goes to others for a shelter.
How can Toltoy compete with us?
How can Chinkogeo be my husband?

"Once Semtay comes here,
No one can defeat him but bows to him.
Uncle, do not leak it out,
Manage your mouth well, remember it."

Ayichulek said all she wanted to say,
Sent them enough clothes and gold,
Made them shut their mouths up,
Let Elichybek leave her palace.

Knowledgeable Chulek,
How smart she was:
She called in forty girls,
And forty married ladies,
Warned them one by one.

Ayichulek warned them:
"If my father calls me,
You all should say,
'We do not see her!'
If he asks where I am going,
You say, 'We do not know,'
Except these words,
Do not say anything else."
She said to Kaliman:
"I will go to afar,
Do not let anyone notice it."

Kaliman was her favorite sister,
And was also the smartest one among the girls.
Chulek put her own brocade robe on Kaliman,
Let Kaliman live in her gold palace.
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Showed her wisdom as a fairy,
And showed her extraordinary ability.

She put on a white swan feather clothes,
She begged to God;
She pulled her own collar,
She made all preparations for the fly;
She fluttered her wings toward the sun,
Her tail flapped on the ground,
A white swan flew into the sky.

She roared up into the sky,
Showered herself in the warm sunshine.
She flew from Akun Khan's city,
The white swan was attracted to the blue sky.

She flew above the white clouds,
She showered in the graceful moonlight,
She fluttered among the clouds,
She flew over mountains,
She prayed to God all the time,
She flew toward the direction of sunrise.

Toward Khitan,
She flew faster and faster.
Too many thoughts went through her mind,
She said to herself:
"Bagersh's son Toltoy,
He once went to Khitan,
It is he who causes the disaster,
For Karamark and Khitan people,
I will see Toltoy has long-time hatred toward you.
So, firstly,
I need to visit the hero Kunwuer Khan."

Lofty Arat mountain,
Was dappled with snow,
And continued for hundred miles.

She fanned her wings in the blue sky,

She looked at the pretty hill in the front,
There was a red tower shining.

She was sure that was Beygin city,
She circled around over the city slowly,
She saw the copper tower point,
And the rust on the body of the tower,
It was a grand palace.

She saw a group of people wearing Kasaya,
And hovered in front of the palace.
There were Karamark Molerdo.

Here was not the place where Khitan people lived,
Here was not the capital of Karamark either.
Chulek was a Molerdo herself,
She traveled around the four oceans and had great magic power,
She knew the change of the world.
She thought, "I get lost,
This is Lahasa, the ancient city."

Ayichulek decided to change the direction,
Tears sparkled in her eyes,
Flew over countless rolling hills and peaks,
She continued flying to the east.

It was an ocean that stretched beyond the horizon in the front,
It was impossible to fly over.
It was the place where the fishermen lived,
Fishermen were casting nets and catching fish in groups.

She turned to another direction,
Ayichulek continued flying forward.
She saw grey herds of horses,
Wandering in a prairie.

She once heard from those girls and married ladies,

Hero Semtay's horses,
Were all dark brown and fat,
She thought she finally found his horses,
She was so excited that she wanted to sing in the sky.

She fluttered her wings,
In the blazing sun,
A thick mist came to her eyes suddenly,
It blurred her eyes and made her hard to see clearly.

In a blink of an eye,
She got close to a splendid palace.
"It is said that Khan Manas' palace,
Is fully painted with oil paint.
Do I take the reflected light of the paint,
As the shining mirror?
Let me get down to the clouds and watch carefully."
She descended through clouds.

The grand palace was in a shape of rectangle,
Streets were wide and tidy.
As seeing the grand palaces,
Ayichulek felt very surprised.

Looked at those stone lions, stone tigers and others stone animals,
There were all absolutely true to life,
Exquisite and vivid great pieces:
Some were with four hooves on the ground,
Some lifted their hooves to gallop forward.

On the burned dirt stove,
Gold pot was shining.
The ample city looked resplendent and magnificent,
Everyone that came for the first time would get lost.

Spears were piled at one side,
Swords hung at the other side.

If enemies dare to invade,
None could escape.

The small luxuriant garden,
Was beautifully trimmed.
The walls built with rocks,
Roared into the sky.
Outside of the walls,
The moat was as wide as lakes.

Ayichulek looked down from the sky,
It seemed she was above Beygin city.
All the daily life needs,
Were easy to be found here.

The heroic lion she was looking for,
Now had left the human world unfortunately,
She felt depressed when she thought about it.

Ayichulek flew in the sky,
Watched the horses with marks,
They were all grey horses,
Ran and chased and neighed,
Galloped toward the river in groups.

Ayichulek flew in the sky,
She felt worried that she could not find Semtay.
She calculated in her mind:
"After my father-in-law Manas passed away,
Did Aweikai and Kobosh put the horsewhip in the center,
And divide the property[①]?
Did they mix taupe stallions with others deliberately,
And made those taupe horses,
Turned into the color of light grey?

① Put the horsewhip in the center, and divide the property: It is a Kirgiz custom. When the father dies, brothers put a horsewhip in the center to divide the property in order to show the justice. Horsewhip is the symbol of the power.

Maybe what I heard from those girls and married ladies,
Was the false gossip!"

Ayichulek watched and guessed,
She lowered herself and got close to the horses,
Opened her eyes wide to see clearly.
Right at the moment,
Kunwuerbayi walked to the horses.

This brutal and merciless strong man,
He was the famous general in Beygin city,
He was a peerless giant,
His reputation was spread everywhere.

The plait on the back of his head,
Was like the mane of a maroon stallion.
He held the shield on his back,
Took all his weapons with him.
If enemies came to invade,
He could wipe the rivals out with his vigor.
His eyes blinked like the waves of lake,
It seemed he would swallow everything in front of his eyes.
His tyranny was like the surging waves,
As if he could push a mountain down.

His nose was like the spur of the rock,
His mustache was like the reed in Gobi desert,
His brow was like humped cliff,
His beard was like the bag that held the arrows,
His eyes was like the forest fires;
His stalwart built was like a tower,
Long arms were like the branches of phane tree.

This cruel and merciless guy,
Who dares to act violently in front of him?
He was as tall as a single-hump camel,
He was as powerful as surging waves,

He was as cold as the winter of the prairie.
He did not fear at all when charging against enemies,
It seems he could swallow and stamp flat all the invaders.
His sword was as strong as a beam,
That could pierce through the rampart.

Strong and tall Kunwuerbayi,
Had hair like horse mane, and strength that could move the hill,
Choktabulger was his pasture,
He was ready to fight the enemies all the time.
In four seasons,
He tied the black-spotted on the hitching post.
If enemies came and invaded Kakan,
He would let enemies' blood run immediately.
Among Karamark people who wore black felt hats,
He was an illustrious Khan.

He rode the high black-spotted horse,
Ochohur gun was hanging by his side.
He wore the coat armor no bullet could pierce through,
He got close to the horses at the moment.

The spear was held in the hand tight,
The sword shined in his waist.
Alngor bow and sharp grey arrows,
Swayed on his right side.
The hat beset with diamonds on his head,
Shined in the sunshine.
That was his precious crown,
The dripping diamonds made your eyes confused.
Even the king came and stood with him,
It was hard to distinguish the real one.

Chulek saw with her own eyes,
He was in such high spirits.
Although he was already over seventy years old,
He was still with a heroic thrive.

White beard was like the white frost.

His right arm was wide and muscular,
As if it could defeat all the heroes in the world.
His left arm was round and sturdy,
As if it could pull the hill down which was in the way.

Facing the great hero,
Ayichulek had more hatred than the reverence in her heart.
He was the mortal enemy of Kirgiz people,
He was the ringleader who killed his father-in-law.
Ayichulek told herself that she had more important things to do,
Otherwise she must fight him to the death.

She thought, "A formidable enemy is coming,
I should find Semtay first and avenge my father-in-law's death.
Pray to God and wish he bless me,
I should fly to Semtay as soon as possible!"

Ayichulek told herself like this,
But she still had a mess in her mind,
Facing west against the wind,
She flew high in the sky.

She was excited,
Fluttered her wings and flew over Mongolian prairie,
She saw this fertile land,
All Karamark landlords lived here.
Flocks of livestock spread on the pasture,
Which made people envious and yearn for.

She turned to northwest and continued flying,
Toward the direction of Altay.
She flew over Altay mountain,
She flew over rapid rivers,
Came to Alma-Ata plain,
By the side of the rolling river.

Muzburchak's Ackubak,
Was playing there.
He was hunting and loosing his dog and eagle,
He shouted and played happily.

Chulek flew over that place in the sky,
She saw the young man.
She guessed: "Who is he? What ability does he have?"
Ayichulek watched him carefully.

He was under fifteen years old,
He still possessed the innocence of childhood on his face.
He was still a naughty boy,
He did not possess the vigor of a hero!

His right shoulder was wide and sturdy,
As long as he grew up,
He could conquer the world.
His bones were still not strong enough,
He was not mature enough to fight in the battle.

He was still a boy that acted rashly,
His wisdom was not mature either.

His left shoulder was strong,
Once he grew taller,
He could be invincible.
"If he is not an innocent boy,
He will be a handsome man worthy to marry."

Ayichulek thought again and again:
"People will say 'A dark face girl does not give in,
Marry an innocent young man!'
Will people gossip about me in the back?"

She disliked him as an immature young man,

Ayichulek turned the direction again,
She left the area of Alma-Ata,
Flew high in the sky.

"When I was still in the swaddle,
Before Semtay was born,
My father Akun Khan and the lion Manas,
They appreciated each other,
They loved the unborn child more,
They had decided the marriage by pointing to the belly.
Unlucky Ayichulek,
I worry about him day and night.

"The only son of the hero,
He is a pearl in the ocean,
I should find him as early as possible.
How I can be lost in such fancies,
It is really ridiculous."

When Ayichulek thought again,
She fluttered her wings and left this place,
Going forward along Arat mountain,
She passed Andijan and Tashkent,
Passed strange places one after one,
She flew over again,
The Kalaubla valley.
She circled around high in the sky,
Had too many thoughts in her mind,
She was annoyed for not finding Semtay,
She flew and worried.
Clouds rolled in the sky,
The darkness in the front made her tired.

Grey clouds began to fade away,
Blue came out from the horizon,
She prayed to God,
Ayichulek flew out of the thick clouds.

She hovered over the mountain,
She could not find her lover.
Her tears fell ceaselessly like the raindrops,
She was confused in thinking.

It became bright in front of her eyes suddenly,
Golden sun shined bright lights.
If you do not believe it,
Please go and visit personally,
She was in the sky above Talas.

When she saw swamps near rivers,
Chulek felt excited suddenly,
Wild ducks and wild geese swam in the river,
Look at the spring by the side of the river,
Willow and aspen that grew together,
Were luxuriant in foliage.

Shochanju and Shiliju,
Honeysuckle trees and Hozho grass,
Rowan trees and tumbleweed,
Sparsifolia and cypress trees,
Mixed and exuberantly grew together.

Apples, wild apricots and narrow-leaved oleasters,
Dark plums, walnuts and mistan[①],
Yellow, red,
In clumps, in patches,
Sour and delicious, sweeter than fruits preserves,
Herba Ephedrae also grew by the valley.
Young and beautiful Ayichulek,
Loved this fertile place immediately.

Look at the shady side of the hill,

① Mistan: Pistachio.

There was a green pasture,
Cool breeze blew at the foot of the mountain,
Pine trees waved in the wind.

Nightingales sang there,
The singing spread as far as a three-day distance.
Snow cocks rushed off the snow mountain,
Gazelles and antelopes were full in the grassland.
Fowls and beasts tweeted and echoed,
Without knowing where they were from.
Ayichulek liked this place very much,
She believed it was the best place in the world.

At the downstream of Tortkoler lake,
By the side of the orchard the Khan fostered,
Right in the front of Barikoler,
By the side of Bakay's house,
At the source of Kaynar spring,
By the big phane tree,
Bordered Kankoler,
There was a white palace right in the center of that land,
It shone under the sun.

Ayichulek observed the white palace,
Ayichulek, who flew in the sky,
Through thousand miles flying,
She found Semtay here.
Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
Went to invade Akun Khan's city,
They besieged and ringed the city,
Their purpose was to marry Ayichulek by force.
Ayichulek sent messengers to meet the enemies,
She told lies and cheated the enemies,
For the purpose of stalling for time.

She got five months more,
She turned into a swan and flew into the sky.

In order to save her people,
In order to save herself from becoming a trophy,
She did not regard the hardships in the journey,
Tried to find her lover Semtay.

Now she saw Semtay's homeland,
Fertile Talas where he lived,
His father Manas once lived here too,
She had heard about their stories.

There was a grand tomb appeared in her sight,
"It must be my father-in-law Manas' tomb,
It must be Talas."
Ayichulek flew in the sky and looked down,
Facing the grand tomb,
Ayichulek lowered her head and thought.

"This is the grand tomb of father-in-law Manas,
How I can fly over its head!
If I am punished by the spirit of Manas,
How I can live as a person in the world!"

She avoided the tomb,
Made a detour through Arat mountain,
Flew and passed Alcmalubrak spring,
Flew over Shunkartash peak and grassland,
At the downstream of Tortkoler lake,
By the side of the orchard Manas fostered.
At the source of Kaynar spring,
At the place the phane tree grew.
At the swamp of river bank,
By the river where wild ducks quacked and grey geese honked,
At the edge of vast Talas,
By Alakoler lake,
Semtay was hunting at this place,
He was chasing deer and gazelle.

He loosed his hunting dog and eagle,
Caught wild ducks and geese without a rest,
He did not give those wild lives,
Any peaceful and quiet time.

He picked up the game here,
And then looked for the game there,
Buruler's waist was bent,
He collected too many games.
Wild ducks and geese that tied together,
Their wings touched the ground.
Hero Semtay was carefree,
The young heart was as bright as the sunshine.

Two warriors by his side,
Ran like colts,
They protected Semtay's both sides,
It seemed the Khan had millions of troops.

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Watched Semtay carefully in the sky:
Manas' son Semtay,
He was confident and acted decisively,
He was manly and strong.
Would he like to fight against Chinkogeo and Toltoy?
Would he like to avenge me?
How about his power and ability?
It needed to be judged more.

Ayichulek observed from the sky:
"His right shoulder is wide and thick,
He is a strong man who can defeat the right flank.
His left shoulder is strong and sturdy,
He is a giant who can destroy the left flank.

"He surely is a lion hard to find in the world,
He is the peerless man!

But is he the hero I will marry?
Does he have the heroic courage to defeat the formidable enemy?

"Look at him, with wide chest, sturdy shoulders,
Walk like wind, advance courageously,
No enemy can stop him,
He is peerless and vigorous."

The young and handsome man in front of Ayichulek,
Must tear the formidable enemies into pieces.
His figure was like a powerful dragon,
His manner was like a violent lion.
His firm and confident black eyes,
Were like the burning flames.

He was about eighteen years old,
He was in his prime time.
He had the wisdom of a king,
He had the air of a king.

He had the figure of a giant,
He had the faith of commanding the subjects.
He had the quality as a king,
He had the power to shake the world.
Buruler he rode on leaped and galloped,
Saw the scenery of the world.

Ayihculek observed from a distance,
When she saw Semtay,
She felt excited,
Her face turned red and sweat dropped.
Ayichulek flew close to the top of the mountain,
Hovered and watched carefully.

He dressed shiningly,
He marched forward fearlessly,
Sharp knife and sword on him,

Made invaders scared to death,
Shining battle axe on his waist,
Would cut any enemy into halves.

He held the battle flag in the hand,
The shield was held on his back,
The breastplate was in the front.
His helmet hung on his shoulder,
Copper-made button was shinning on his neck.

He was as strong as a mountain,
If the formidable enemies came and invaded,
He would make them suffer a crushing defeat,
Like a ferocious tiger sprang on the prey.

His beard was trimmed well,
He twisted it and hung it on the ears.
He led two young men,
And hunted in the mountain.
Flew the eagle, galloped the horse and loosed the dog,
He appreciated the beautiful scenery.

He wore the white cloak,
Shining and graceful,
The edge was of gold border,
The edges of the collar and sleeves were of silver border.

Six-shot powder gun was loaded up,
People provoked him would never escape.
Whoever dare offend or displease him,
Must be on a dead road of their life.

He wore Akorlbok coat armor his father left to him,
He did not look up to anyone except God.
He was such a hero,
That was hard to be found in the world.
Maybe in several centuries,

There would be one hero like this descended.

His crimson face was like the fried wheat,
Silver-beset belt was sparkling,
Gold-beset armor was shining,
The handsome youth was like a ferocious tiger down the mountain,
How could the enemies not be scared?

Ayichulek watched and judged carefully,
Semtay could be the commander wisely.

Semtay's Buruler steed,
Its loud neigh could spread to the cliff ten miles away.
It galloped fast and steady,
It would not get tired even you rode on it for six months.
Its life span could be sixty years,
It would not lose even one tooth.
It got the chest like an argali,
It got the belly like a hunting dog,
It would not get tired even you rode on it for seven months.

It was the fairy among the livestock,
It was the cream of the fine horses.
Lion Manas' spirit,
Blessed and supported the magic steed.

Krichorao by the side of Semtay,
Was a servant warrior, young and handsome.
He was just an attendant at the moment,
He must be tougher than Semtay in the future.
His temper was like a ball of fire,
He did not spare any invading enemies.
His character had nothing to do with tolerance and modesty,
He would wipe out all enemies that challenged him.
He was young but did not fear of adversity,
He must be a hero in the future!

Crude and rash Kanchorao,
Was like the fire too.
He dare give crushing blow to invaders,
The young man was also a hot-tempered hero.

Ayichulek observed carefully,
She liked everything of Semtay,
One Buruler steed and three young men,
All made her content.

Young tiger Semtay,
Returned home impressively.
His hitching posts all tied with horses,
His place was crowded with visitors,
The two grand palaces stood face to face,
Roared high in the front of the hill.

Ayichulek Was Humiliated by Chachykai

Ayichulek landed on the opposite hill,
She was worried but did not know what to do.
She did not know how to meet her fiancé,
And did not know how to tell him her heart either:

"Hero Manas' son Semtay,
It is ridiculous if I return home without meeting him!
My fiancé Semtay,
How can I talk to him face to face?"

Ayichulek turned the problem over in her mind,
Thought over and over again:
"If I go back like this,
I must lose my life under Chinkogeo's knife.
If I do not tell the situation to my lover,
Toltoy must kill me.

"The majestic madam Chachykai,
She is my cousin,
Why not meet her first?
Tell my problem to her first."

She thought over and over again,
She watched on the hill carefully,
Till the evening was coming,
She saw the pampered Chachykai,
Who walked out of the door and enjoyed the scenery.

Chachykai was like the white argali on the hill,

Raised her head high with a leisurely manner.
She minced forward,
Looked at both sides,
Like a falcon combed its feather,
Like a peacock spread its tail,
She swayed her magnificent dress.

She swung her hips,
Walked with a light step,
Her blue boots made a clip clop sound,
Her eyes blinked like the stars in the sky.

She walked slowly with elegance,
Eliecheck was on her head,
Gold necklace was shining in front of her chest.
Red coral-beset hair decoration tied on her plait,
Hung on her hips and rustled and shined.

Chachykai walked slowly,
To the path she usually went.
She wore an overcoat,
The long sleeves hung to the ground.

She decorated herself with gold,
Reflected brightly by the moonlight.
She decorated herself with silver,
Showered dazzlingly by the sunshine.
Her gracefully slender figure,
Was like the willow twig that swung with the wind.

Ayichulek saw Chachykai,
She felt excited:
"Is she hero Semtay's exalted wife?
We are both women,
Let me tell her my plight!
I need to listen to her advice,
It is worthy of my long and tortuous journey!"

Ayichulek made up her mind,
She transferred back to herself as a fifteen-year-old girl,
She walked gently toward Chachykai,
Showed her wisdom and manner as a fairy.

Chachykai looked at Ayichulek,
She was stunned with Ayichulek's beauty.
She could not help her hands lowering down,
Her heart almost jumped out of her chest.
She was alarmed and overwhelmed,
Quivered and almost lost her breath.

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Lowered her head and stroked her long plait,
Exposed her white neck,
Said to Chachykai with respect:

"Shatimur's pearl Chachykai,
Dear cousin, are you healthy and happy recently?
Do you have your beloved children?
Do you have a cute son?

"Shihay's son Chinkogeo,
Bagersh's brutal son Toltoy,
They hold spears with pine poles and raise an army,
The revenge on hero Semtay is coming on its way.

"They send messengers to each other,
They work hand in glove with each other,
They are like dark clouds in the sky,
Cover out tribes with endless miseries.

"Chinkogeo presented a woman eagerly,
To please Toltoy of Jedigair tribe,
He asked Toltoy,
For twelve thousand troops,

They attacked us but failed,
They have besieged us for one year.

"They do not allow us to sow in spring,
Do not allow us to harvest in autumn,
People cannot herd in summer,
We have no lambs with fat tails to eat in winter.

"Our people are suffering devastation,
They howl to marry king Semtay's fiancée forcibly.
They threaten my father continuously,
They commit all sorts of crimes and are worse than beasts.

"When they surrounded the city,
I escaped secretly.
They intend to destroy our city,
It is hard to tell our fortune.
In order to keep me alive,
I come thousand miles here for help.

"Your hero Semtay,
Is he a young man thinks highly of his dignity?
I, Ayichulek, am in distress,
Is he willing to save my life?

"Dare he go to punish Toltoy severely,
And damned Chinkogeo?
Ayichulek is in danger,
Does he want to save her?
Or does he regret,
After they take Ayichulek away?

"Dear cousin, do not take me as your rival in love,
Do not think I will bring you loneliness.
Do not think I will rob you of your husband,
I would like to serve you in the white palace.

"I will saddle the camels when you move,
I will clean the palace everyday,
I am willing to serve you for forty years,
I am willing to nourish you till you die after that.
I will not die in my boots if I harbor any evil thoughts,
Let me die without a burial place if I develop bad intentions!"

Chachykai looked at Ayichulek,
Her face turned from red to pale,
The long plait hung on her back,
Two pieces of clothes edges waved in the evening breeze:

"Does the girl in warm cloth feel cold?
Is there any girl like you?
Girls whose parents are still alive,
How can you be a good girl when you look for a man by yourself?

"Does the girl in colorful clothes worry?
Is there any young girl like you?
You do not stay with your parents,
How can you be a good girl when you look for a man?

"You are a bitch, you cannot find your man,
You are stupid and blind,
You are a slave, no man wants you,
You are a shameless servant.

"Till your hair gets white,
Till your teeth all fall,
You should stay at Akun Khan's home,
You should wait till you are rusted,
You should be snubbed life long!

"I have heard you long ago, you such a servant,
You just fit for putting up stoves and boiling water on the hill,
To serve the passing caravans.
You only fit for making tea by the side of the road,

You are only a low-grade servant.

"My king will never marry you,
Stop daydreaming.
What does he get if he marries you?
What goal can he achieve if he marries you?

"From six-month distant Yurkainichy river,
Regardless of the hardships and walk day and night.
You did not ride a horse and come on foot,
You exert yourself for finding the man.
My king is like your father,
Does he receive any of your respect?

"From seven-month distant Yurkainichy river,
You come like a thief.
You should treat me like your mother,
But you talk to me like this,
It seems you know nothing about courtesy.

"You said you are looking for your man,
Does not your mother blame you when she hears this?
Do not your people complain when they hear this?
Does not your father stop you when he hears this?
Do not your neighbors laugh at you when they hear this?

"My lion Semtay,
His wife is Chachykai!
Charm, beauty, and social status,
Which one of them can you, Ayichulek, compete?

"My lion Semtay,
How can he love a person like you?
Let me be the matchmaker,
Am I a fool?

"My hero Semtay,

He is definitely not the person who will marry you.
He has married me, Chachykai,
Do I look pale in front of you, Ayichulek?

"Ah, you should talk to dogs about your thoughts,
Or you can talk to the fleas on your body!"

Chachykai finished her words angrily,
Then she patted her clothes,
Put on Burum coat,
Turned and walked back to the palace,
And pulled the door curtain down.

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
She felt ashamed and almost passed out.
Chachykai's verbal humiliation,
Made her want to hide underground.

She felt too miserable to take a step forward,
She was absent-minded.
She could not control her tears,
Her mouth quivered with rage.

The pampered woman Chachykai,
Bent her body and went into the yurt,
She heaved a long sigh,
Her face turned from red to sallow.

"Ah, I do not feel well all over,
Some evil things get on me."
The pampered madam Chachykai,
Sighed and shouted in pain.

When hero Semtay heard it,
He asked her to lie down and rest immediately.
Ordered others to butcher a yellow goat kid,
Took out the lung of the goat,

Patted Chachykai's forehead with it.

Made Sadaha to drive out evil spirits,
People crowded in,
Visited and took care of Chachykai.
Except Chachykai,
No one saw Ayichulek.

When people were busy,
Krichorao and Kanchorao,
In Kolmer pasture of Kankoler,
Herded the horses and discussed:

"We should go and visit the king Semtay,
To see if he is healthy,
To give best wishes to him,
To visit the returned king."

They laughed on their way,
Talked happily with each other.
The two young men came to give wishes,
Came into Semtay's yurt.

Kangkoer pillowed with his elbow,
Stretched with a smile.
Hero Semtay,
Praised these two young men:

"My hero Krichorao,
My warrior kanchorao,
The white eagle my father left,
Has grown into a hunting eagle,
It has strong bones and has fully fledged.

"Now it is the time of hunting,
It is the season of hunting,
Wild ducks and geese rest in the lake area.

I will hunt along the land of Talas tomorrow,
You go back quickly today,
Convey my order immediately.

"You tell the knight who is herding the horses,
From the horses my father left,
Pick two fine horses.
You must train and ride them, my warriors!
You must saddle them, my warriors!
You go back tomorrow,
Ride those two fine horses and come to me.

"Krichorao, when you come tomorrow,
You go on the main road regardless of the rising dust,
You must get early,
Let us meet at Karasu river at sunrise."

Hero Semtay gave the order,
Two Choraos listened carefully,
Whipped their horses and went to the herd immediately.

The sun set, the night was coming,
Hard working people went to sleep.
On the bed beset with gold and silver,
Spread with soft cotton quilt,
Semtay and Chachykai,
Embraced and slept together.

Like a pair of male argali and female argali,
Like a pair of male camel and female camel,
Went into sweet sleep.
The three stars faded away,
The dawn was coming,
The pampered lady Chachykai,
Put on the clothes and got up arrogantly.

She was on the alert about Ayichulek:

"Ayichulek came last night,
Does she go back?
Or is she still waiting there?"

Chachykai was on pins and needles,
She walked out of the door,
The gold necklace on her neck,
Was shining under the sunshine.

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Was still waiting there,
Her beautiful hair swung in the morning breeze,
Her white face was as pretty as a fairy.

She came up to Chachykai,
She felt tortured like the fire was burning in her chest,
Stubbornly,
She complained about her miseries:

"My dear cousin Chachykai,
Let me tell my heart to you.
Once I get king Semtay's promise,
I will go back immediately.
Let me tell him the truth,
Your hero Semtay,
Does he like to ride on the fine horse?

"If he is the lion who has no fear toward enemies,
Does he know Ayichulek is in danger?
From the hands of Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
Dare he rob them of Ayichulek?

"Does he surrender Ayichulek submissively and willingly,
Is he timid when he faces the rival of love?
And hide himself in Talas.
Is he a coward who is regardless of honor?
Dear cousin, to be honest,

Please give me a good idea to help me out of the misery!"

After hearing what Ayichulek said,
The pampered woman Chachykai,
Lost her mind and pushed the panic button,
She clenched Ayichulek's arm,
And threw out flimsy bestial words:

"You are such a capricious bitch,
You wander into my land with full of lies.
You are such a capricious girl of black face,
All what you said are lies!

"Are you a messenger sent by the devil?
Which woman is willing to send her man to another woman,
When she is still alive?
I will drag you to my home,
Let you be my servant and slave!"

Flustered and exasperated Chachykai,
Grabbed Ayichulek's arm.
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Turned into a white swan immediately,
Glided off Chachykai's hand like the lead water,
Fluttered her wings and flew into the sky.
With all the true feeling,
She responded Chachykai directly:

"You, spoiled Chachykai,
Hero Semtay,

Tonight is the last time you see him.
If my hope comes true,
It will not be me who is unlucky.

"My friend told me,
'Semtay is going to Talas prairie today,

By Karakuler lake,
He will enjoy a life of loosing the white eagle and hunting.
He belongs to you when he stays at home,
Once God bless me,
He belongs to me as long as he walks out of his home.

"By the side of the wide road,
On the road he will pass,
I will turn into a white silk handkerchief,
I will change color for six times,
Let him look at me for three times.

"I will attract him with the magic,
Let him pick the handkerchief up:
'What a piece of good silk!'
He will tie it on his saddle pleasantly.

"When he is overjoyed,
I will find the chance,
And take his white eagle.
I will let him come to me for his white eagle,
Let him suffer in my hands.

"If this way does not work,
I have another one.
When he crosses Karasu river,
I will turn into a goldfish and swim in the river,
I will shine like the gold,
Shine three times in front of his eyes,
I will attract him with my beautiful magic.

"I will perform with my charming dance,
Let him fall into my net.
'What a precious fish!'
He grabs the fish in his hand,
And takes it back home and put into the fishbowl.

"When he feels as happy as a lark,
I will take his white eagle!
I will hold the rope tight,
Fly away from his sight.
Hero Semtay,
I will lure him to my hometown!

"If this one does not work either,
When he passes the lake with full wild ducks,
By the side of the lake with full of cyperus rotundus,
At the place where reeds grow,
On the grassland by the beautiful lake,
I will turn into a white swan.

"I will put my head under the water and play,
I will find the green alga and let him watch,
I will continue to sing,
I will attract his eyes tight!

"When he sees the beautiful white swan,
He will let the eagle off happily,
I will grab the rope on the white eagle's talon,
Flutter my wings and take it back to my home!

"If Semtay does not come to me,
His favorite eagle,
Will fly by Toltoy.
Ayichulek, whom he should marry,
Will become Chinkogeo's wife.

"Till then,
He will no longer be a great hero in the world,
But a notorious coward,
He will become a disgraced man.

"If I cannot meet my goal,
I, Ayichulek, will not die willingly.

If God grants me such fortune,
I will accept and suffer by myself.
I will disappear from the human world,
Let me die quietly,
Wish those gracious spirits,
Bless and help me!"

Ayichulek finished her words,
Fluttered her wings and flew into the sky.
Like a drift of white smoke,
She flew in the sky freely.
Like a drift of blue smoke,
She fluttered her wings and flew in the sky,
Disappeared from Chachykai's sight in an instant.

The pampered woman Chachykai,
Looked stupid after heard what Ayichulek said,
She asked herself: "What has happened just now?"
Her faced turned sallow.

"Is she going to rob me of Semtay?"
She clapped her hands hard.
"Ah, how unfortunate I am!"
She fell back on the ground.

"The bitch comes to me initiatively,
I regret I did not grab her tight,
Otherwise she will be my slave,
She should follow my orders day and night."

The moon set, dark night continued,
Days of miserable life came.
Chachykai felt sad and regretted.

"I caused the misfortune for myself,
My lucky days have passed!"
Her heart was like burning with fire,

She turned withered like the picked flower.

Chachykai lowered her head and walked back,
She said to herself: "Does not Semtay leave me?
I indeed fall ill,
But I cannot lie at home quietly.
I must try my best to hold on to him,
Do not let him leave me."
Chachykai felt nervous and worried.

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Turned into a white swan and flew in the sky.
She fluttered her wings toward the sun,
Flew high in the sky.
She fanned the breeze with her wings,
Patted the sunshine with her tail.

Capricious Ayichulek,
Flew and sang.
She fluttered a gust suddenly,
Made the dark clouds spread over the sky rapidly.

She made the hail fell on the top of the mountain,
Made the heavy rain fell at the foot of the mountain.
Made the thunder grumbled in the sky,
Made the snow fell in the plain.
Made the rapids fell in nine mountains,
Made the water rose high in eight rivers.

The heavy rain lasted the time of cooking a meal,
The sky turned clear and the wind stopped suddenly,
The sun came out and shone again.
Lonely Ayichulek disappeared,
No one knew where capricious Ayichulek went.

When the sky just turned a little white,
Hero's son Semtay,

The young tiger and hero,
Opened his eyes from his dreams.

"I will go to hunt with my eagle!
I will gallop on my magic steed!"
He got up immediately,
Dressed himself well.
"If I set out late,
I would sleep in the wilderness at night,
I must meet my companies on the way,
I must set out as soon as possible."

Semtay walked out of his yurt,
He saw the fresh snow outside.

He burst with joy over the snow,
The snow-covered world lit his passion of hunting.
Brought his steed,
Got ready to ride on his horse.

"Since I have the name Semtay,
Since I got the white eagle,
I have never seen the snow like this.
How excited to see such snow and a sunny day,
At this great moment,
I must go to hunt."

Semtay got so excited,
Put the horse cloak on Tayibruler,
The cloak was made of tiger skin,
The velvet tassel hung by the side,
It looked golden and gorgeous.

Semtay tied the leather drum with gold edge,
Tight on the rope of the saddle.
The drum covered with the elephant skin,
It would make a loud sound even if a fly landed on it.

It was like gunshot when struck by the leather whip,
It would make echoes in valleys.

Tied tight and carefully,
The gold-edged leather drum,
On the side of the saddle.

It was an exquisite saddle,
The pommel was edged with pure gold,
It was a unique and inventive saddle,
The cantle was beset with pure silver.
Two fenders were decorated with iron,
It was the most suitable saddle for Tayibruler.

Tightened the cinch and saddled the horse,
Wore his Akorlbok coat armor,
Prayed to God,
Twelve buttons in a line on the coat armor,
He buttoned them one by one.
There were twelve knots,
He buttoned them too.

He held the white eagle on his hand,
The horsewhip twisted with purple copper wires,
Ringed on his left wrist.
Semtay was very excited,
Untied the rein from the hitching post,
He leaped and sat on the saddle,
His feet did not touch the iron stirrups.

Semtay was ready to set out,
Chachykai could not bear anymore,
She ran out of the yurt:

"My dear king,
Can you go tomorrow instead of today?
I had a dream last night,

I dreamed something horrible.

"The white eagle does not call usually,
But it called suddenly last night.
It ripped the rope away on its talon,
Flapped its wings as it would fly away.

"My king, do not go out today,
My king, you can go tomorrow, but not go alone,
You must take two warriors with you,
Go together with your companions."

Semtay felt disappointed about her words,
He said something unpleasant to hear:
"Let go my arm, you stubborn woman,
Your dream is just fox shit,
Do not say the unlucky words.
Let go the rein! Stupid!
If the white eagle calls,
It must hear the call from its companions."

Semtay talked to her like this,
Chachykai still clutched the rein tight,
Did not let Semtay set out.

Manas' son Semtay,
His face turned black with rage.

The leather whip was in his hand,
With a pretty handle.
The leather used to make the whip,
Was made from the skin of a calf which Kanikai once fed,
The calf sucked two cows' milk.

Craftsmen put the calfskin on the wet ground,
Then spread the fermented dough on it,
Let the rawhide turn soft,

Invited skilled craftsmen to cut it into thin strips,
Twisted twelve strips into the whip carefully.
The whip once beat the ferocious enemies,
Made them bleed.

It was this bloody leather whip,
Now lashed on Chachykai's hips,
Her colorful silk gown,
Was broken into pieces.
On Chachykai's thighs,
Blood flowed out ceaselessly.
She was like a lamb that fell off the cliff,
Shouted and cried miserably.

Chachykai's tears ran like spring water,
She cursed hero Semtay:
"Never come back again if you go today,
I do not allow you to return to this luxurious home!
Go ahead,
I do not let you have this warm family again!

"Let Jedigair people rob you of your eagle,
Let you achieve nothing from this time on!
Let Toltoy rob you of your steed,
Let Chinkogeo rob you of your woman and make her be a servant!"

Chachykai's evil curses,
Did not stop Semtay at all,
She only could watch him leave.
But Chachykai's curse,
Made Semtay remember one of the proverbs:
"The lamb's curse does not hurt the wolf at all,
The wife's curse does not hurt the husband either."
The lion Semtay,
Rode on his Buruler steed and galloped away.

The breeze blew on his face,

The steed passed several hills.
The helmet, the shield and the armor,
Shined under the sunshine.
In a blink of an eye,
Semtay came to the place they would Beygin to hunt.

Ayichulek Caught and Took Semtay's White Eagle

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Flew in the sky and observed carefully.
Semtay was handsome and elegant,
Black eyes were shining,
Any girl or married woman saw him,
Would have two red clouds hung on the face.

Semtay was a brave young man,
He worked for his people and got their praises.
His tall and strong figure was like a single-hump camel,
His mighty bearing was like surging waves.
The youth in the world,
Who could be better than him!

He was as cold as the wind in winter,
He was as warm as the sunshine in spring.
He was like a tiger coming down the hill in an attack,
He was like a black mane wolf in a contest.
Look at his heroic courage,
He was as brave as Achalbaris magic sword.

He was broad-minded,
Like the vast Talas prairie.
His heroic bearing,
Was the same as his father Manas.
Look at his forehead,
It was like eagle king with black frons.

He caught the fancy of Ayichulek,

Ayichulek was lost in wild thoughts:
"He rides on the flying horse,
The white coat armor shines silver light.
Can I have my wish accomplished?
Can I be the wife of this young hero Semtay?

"Will Semtay be excited?
Will he ride his Buruler steed,
And marry Chulek who is in the wedding dress,
And take her into the new wedding house?

"Erase my annoyance,
Wipe out the sorrow in my heart,
Let me be happy,
And live a carefree life."

Ayihculek was lost in fanciful thoughts,
She felt her heart was burning with fire,
She hovered in the sky,
The more she thought the more she felt nervous.
Heroic man Semtay,
Was as powerful as a dragon in her heart.

Two Choraos did not come yet,
Manas' son Semtay,
Had no companions around him,
He played by himself.

After getting up in the morning,
Krichorao rode on his Aktilck steed,
Kanchorao rode on his Surtilck steed,
They galloped forward like an arrow.

They had the same wish:
"We do not put up the tents in the marsh land,
Do not go and play with women happily.
We do not put up the tents on top of the mountain,

Do not go and play with women happily.
We go to see our big brother,
Let's hunt with eagles and play with him.
Let's relieve his distress.

"Let us be good helpers,
For our alone brother to drive beasts,
Let us play happily today,
Then return our homes."

Krichorao and Kanchorao,
Knocked each other's stirrups,
Went forward shoulder on shoulder,
Came to Semtay's palace.

Heard the clips of hooves outside of the door,
Chachykai lay in the palace,
She turned and got up immediately,
Waggled out of the door.

Chachykai said to them:
"Hey, lads, please stop for a while!
You wear the embroidered felt hats,
And wear leather pants,
I have something to discuss with you!

"Young men, you wear embroidered felt hats,
And wear leather pants,
I want to talk my heart to you!

"Please turn your horses round,
I tell you now!
Hang the bit rope on the saddle,
I tell you immediately!"

Krichorao turned his head and looked at her,
Then turned his horse, and reined the horse,

But he thought Chachykai did not show interest in them usually,
Why does she show such a passion today?
Does the brother get angry with her?
Does he lash her with the leather whip?
Or pampered the sister-in-law Chachykai,
Heard something from some place?

Kanchorao said with a smile:
"Ok, tell us! Our good sister-in-law!"

"Our dignified sister-in-law Chachykai,
Tell us your grievance."

Chachykai arched her eyebrows,
Said in a sad voice:
"Our hero Semtay,
When he is going to fly his eagle,
When he is going to return home,
On the lake full of cyperus rotundus,
On the lake full of reeds,
On the lake wild ducks rest,
There is a long-necked white swan.

"It honks and flaps its wings,
It plunges its head into the water,
It picks waterweeds up,
Then it continues honking.

"You will see it right at this moment,
Then your brother will say,
'I will fly my white eagle,
To catch that beautiful white swan!'
You must stop him,
In order to avoid regretting about losing his eagle!

"There will be a silk handkerchief on the road you pass,
Do not allow him to pick up the handkerchief.

For one white silk handkerchief,
Do not let him regret about losing his eagle!

"There will be a goldfish in Karasu river,
Do not let him catch the fish,
For a small goldfish,
Do not let him regret about losing his eagle!

"Your sister-in-law is Chachykai,
Do not treat me unjustly.

"Lads, do not fly the white eagle,
Lads, do not catch that white swan,
Lads, do not pick that white silk handkerchief up,
Lads, do not catch that goldfish!

"If you get these things done,
I will put up new yurts for you.
Beautiful Ackoyun you like,
I will help you marry her.

"If I cannot do what I said,
If I break my promise,
If I go back on my words,
If I do not help you,
Let the sky over our heads punish me,
Let the earth full of grass and trees punish me,
Let the bullets from Ackelty gun punish me!

"Two warriors, you are the witnesses,
Of what I said.
If I do not keep my promise,
I will owe you in the human world and in the hell!
Wish you a safe trip,
Wish God bless you!"
They heard what Chachykai promised,
They nodded and agreed.

Whipped their horses and galloped away,
To chase Semtay.

At Karasu riverbank,
By the lake full of cyperus rotundus,
From the back of Semtay,
They whipped and chased.

A door-size white silk handkerchief,
By the side of the road Semtay passed,
In the dust rose from the road,
Shone colorfully in the sunshine,
Drifted in the breeze.

Before Semtay could dismount and pick up the handkerchief,
Before he could hunt wild ducks with his eagle,
He heard two warriors had come,
He shouted loudly to them:

"Krichorao, Kanchorao,
Your lucky brother,
I saw a white silk handkerchief in the front,
You two dismount now and pick it up for me!

"Below Anjiyan,
Above Namangan,
Does any peddler,
Pass this place at night?

"Kokcher's son Wumaitoy,
Does he go toward his homeland?
You follow the horse hooves to see,
If there are Sart[①] that dodge us,
Go and catch them and take their property.

① Sart: Businessmen.

"Is Wumaitoy richer than me?
Is he so generous?
Do I have less wether now?
Do the peddlers look down upon me deliberately?
Do not I have yellow horses?
Does Wumaitoy have more livestock than me?

"When my father Manas passed away,
He left me Akorlbok coat armor.
When it was taken by Aweikai,
Those brutal bastards,
Did not cherish it at all and wore it out.
The color of the outside of the gown has faded,
The edge of the gown spotted with sweat,
The white inside of the gown was dirty and bad.

"Go and pick that white handkerchief,
Let my mother Kanikai cut it into proper shape,
Let Chachykai sew the inside of the gown with it,
Let me wear it and show off.
It is also a chance to test Chachykai's skill,
To see whether her skill is extraordinary."

With a loud voice,
With lightening eyes,
Krichorao who was blessed by god Shayi,
Turned his head round and saw the handkerchief,
But he felt impatient of what Semtay said.

He replied with a cloud face:
"We have not hunted a wild duck with the eagle yet,
Have not hunted a gazelle either,
What are you thinking about, my brother?
Facing flocks of ducks,
Why do not you fly your eagle?
If you still do not do it,
Do we get a punishment from God?

"If you want a white silk handkerchief,
Let me try to get one for you.
Let me drive sixty spotted horses,
And go to Andijan,
Let me pick carefully for you,
Buy you a sixty feet long white silk handkerchief.

"Let me drive seventy maroon horses,
And go to Yarkant city,
Let me pick carefully for you,
Buy you a seventy feet long white silk handkerchief."

When Semtay heard these words,
He untied the gold wire,
Off the eagle's leg.
Untied the deep red thin silk rope.
Off the eagle's talon.
Took the colorful blindfold,
Off the eagle's eyes.
Lifted the lark-like eagle,
On his hand suddenly,
The white eagle flew into the sky.

The lion's son Semtay,
Beat the gold-beset drum,
Made a loud noise with it,
Wild ducks and wild geese full of the lake,
Flew in a hurry in an instant.
Semtay and Kanchorao,
Whipped and galloped,
Followed the white eagle and chased.

Almanbet's son Krichorao,
Stayed at the back smartly,
He picked up that door-size white silk handkerchief,
Threw it into a deep pit.

He moved a watermill-size black flagstone,
Covered the mouth of the deep pit with it tight.
Then Krichorao followed Semtay,
Whipped his horse and chased after them.

Hero Semtay,
Drove wild ducks and geese into the sky,
The white eagle flew and went to catch.
Quacking ducklings and goslings,
Fled everywhere in panic under the eagle's chase.

They went around Karasu river,
They picked up six wild ducks and six wild geese,
They tied the prey by the side of their saddles,
Made Buruler steed sweaty all over,
And splashed the robe wet.

"Krichorao and Kanchorao,
Let's get my white eagle back,
Let's cross the river,
And go to the other side of Karasu river,
There are a lot of wild ducks and geese,
Let's pluck out the feather of ducks and geese,
Pillows made from their feather are soft and comfortable."

Semtay told them in a loud voice,
And dismounted and came to Karasu river.
He put his hands in the river to clean,
He saw one goldfish passing his eyes.

On the back of the goldfish,
There was a black-spotted pattern,
On the head of the goldfish,
There was a thumb-size mark,
Swung past him.

Semtay was attracted by it immediately:

"My two fearless warriors,
My lion Krichorao!
Do you see what I have seen?
Do you notice what I have witnessed?

"A goldfish swam past me,
There are black stripes on its back.
On its head,
There is a thumb-size golden mark.
I, Semtay, till now,
I have not seen such a beautiful goldfish.

"My dear Krichorao,
Go into the water bravely,
Press the body of the goldfish gently,
Hold its head and catch it.

"I will take it home with me,
Give it to your pampered sister-in-law Chachykai,
Let her keep this beautiful goldfish.
I lashed her hips with the whip in the morning,
Present a goldfish to her,
Let her be happy."

Semtay talked to them like this,
Krichorao could not hesitate.
He took off the white boots in a hurry,
Which he bought from Andijan,
The boots were made of ten soft skins.

He jumped into the water with his bare feet,
Kicked hard the mud in the river.
Krichorao muddied the river,
And pretended that he saw nothing:
"Big brother, where is the goldfish?"

Semtay was very angry as he saw it,

He blamed Krichorao in a loud voice:
"You such a stupid slave!
Look, how dull you are,
Always make troubles for me!"

The lion's son Semtay,
Felt for the goldfish in the river.
Semtay grabbed the neck of the goldfish,
Threw it toward the riverbank:
"Catch it, Kanchorao!

Chuwak's son Kanchorao,
Bent over and picked the goldfish on the ground:
"Ah,
My dear big brother!
It is a goldfish in heat,
You will die if you eat this kind of fish."
Kanchorao finished his words,
At the same time he threw the goldfish back into the river.

At the lake full of cyperus rotundus,
By the side of the lake full of reeds,
A long-necked white swan,
Patted the back with its tail,
Patted the lake surface with its wings,
Looked for the food and honked.

Krichorao saw the swan and he said:
"My dear big brother!
You always fly the eagle,
Give your eagle to me today,
Let me enjoy flying the eagle for one time."

Semtay did not want to go against his warrior's wish,
Semtay did not want his warrior to be sad.
He gave his white eagle to Krichorao,
And let him hold it tight in the hand.

Krichorao got the white eagle,
He loosed the horse bit,
Galloped forward,
He did not turn his head and did not look back either,
He whipped Aktilk horse,
Galloped in a crazy way,
He was nowhere in sight in a blink of an eye.
Hero Semtay burst into a fury immediately,
He had noticed his intention of fleeing away,
He felt angrier toward the little bastard.

He shouted as he looked ahead:
"You such a damned slave,
Look at your dull face,
You do not let the eagle catch the swan,
Why?
I will twist off your lark-size thin neck,
I will pull off your francolin-size thin neck,
I will make you disabled,
You such a damned kid!"

Semtay chased as he finished his words,
Buruler steed only made six hops,
He caught up with warrior Krichorao.

Smart and brave Krichorao,
Knew exactly the lion's intention,
He reined the horse and turned round,
Laughed,
Pretended he was helpless:

"My dear big brother,
You never let me gallop the horse like this,
You never let me hold the eagle,
I do not have the ability to fly the eagle!

"My Aktilk steed,
Is a colt with hard bit,
It has no sense of propriety,
It is easy to be startled.
It galloped suddenly,
It was taken by surprise,
I could not control it.

"If I have evil thought, big brother,
Let me go to hell and have no good end.
It is not a well-tamed animal,
It has a strange temper,
I have no way when it got crazy suddenly!

"If I cheat you, my brother,
Let me fall into fire and burn completely.
What is my purpose if I take the eagle away?
What can I do with it if I take it?"

Heard the guard's promising words,
The lion's fury had been cleared up.
He felt as comfortable as the wind-blew cloud,
They turned their horses and galloped toward the lake.

"The swan appears in front of me,
If I do not fly the eagle to catch it,
Does God forgive me?"
Semtay said excitedly again.

Warrior Kanchorao said to him at the moment:
"My dear big brother!
It seems it is a female swan coming from the sacred place,
It is hatching in its nest,
Let's not get its curse."
Semtay heard what he said,
His excitement turned into great rage again.
He blamed Kanchorao severely,

His words were as strong as volcano erupted:
"I once burst into a fury,
I punished Jagurp Khan,
I made his blood dye the earth,
I cracked the rebels' bones.
I killed Aweikai and Kobosh,
I removed them like the tiger pursued its food.

"When I burst into a fury,
I killed all rebellious warriors,
I made their blood run in the wilderness,
No one cared for their extremely grieved wives and children.
They can do nothing to me.
I, your king, am still alive,
No one can stop me from what I want to do!"

From Krichorao's hand,
He took his white eagle back.
Untied the long rope on its left talon,
Pulled the short rope on its right talon off.
He pulled the blindfold on the eagle's eyes off,
Lifted the eagle talons,
The eagle shot in the sky.

He took out his colorful tobacco case,
Poured Nasbye① tobacco under the front teeth,
Then watched his beloved eagle there.
The eagle swooped swiftly,
Caught the swan on the surface of the lake violently,
Semtay became excited immediately.

He shouted loudly:
"Go, separate them!
Do not let the eagle twist its neck off,

① Nasbye: Tobacco containing under the tongue made from a mixture of tobacco, cypress ash, lime, etc.

Do not let the beautiful swan die!

"Do it safely,
Save the white swan,
Carry it on the horse like carry the white baby camel,
Take it back and present it to Chachykai,
Let her make a soft quilt with its living feather!"

Born-brave Krichorao,
Dare not say no,
He could not make Semtay sad again,
He whipped his horse to the swan.
The gold chain on the eagle's talon,
Was pulled off by the swan.
When Krichorao reached out his hands,
Got ready to grab the wings of the swan,
The white swan flew up suddenly,
Honked and fluttered its wings away.

The white swan raised a whirlwind,
It honked and flew away,
It raised a storm with its wings,
Hail fell on the top of the mountain,
Heavy rain fell on the plain.

Black clouds covered the sky,
Rolled in the sky,
Thunders rumbled,
Shook the earth.
Hail pounded on heads, heavy rain filled the river,
Lightning flashed and thunder rumbled,
Flood roared with rocks down the mountain.

The storm lasted the time of making a meal,
It became sunny,
The sunlight pierced the clouds.
They three looked and tired their eyes,

They did not see the white swan in the sky.
They looked around and felt more disappointed,
Nowhere could find his white eagle.

At the moment,
Semtay got angry with Krichorao:
"You two idiots,
Look,
What the white swan holds in its talons,
Is my white eagle!"

They three watched the white swan flying away,
They shouted and watched the sky.

Almanbet's son Krichorao,
Galloped his horse toward the hill far away,
Kanchorao rode his horse down the hill,
Semtay also galloped his horse forward.

He called the name of Krichorao,
Galloped the horse,
And broke into a furious rage:

"Today you two did three things,
Each of them made me shocked!
I saw the white silk handkerchief and you stopped me from picking it,
You threw it into a deep pit and covered with stone.
I asked you to catch the goldfish and you did not listen,
You did not catch it.
You did not fly the eagle when you saw the white swan,
But sent my eagle to the white swan!

"From this morning till now,
You two always stop me from doing anything,
You do not listen to me,
Did Chachykai twist your ears?

"Where does the eagle go now?
Do not waste the horses to chase,
I have heard a lot of earnest advice from the elders,
I have heard a lot of classic proverbs,
I have heard a lot of instructions,
I have heard a lot of famous aphorisms,
But I have never heard of this,
A white eagle is caught by a swan!

"Lost my beloved eagle,
It means my life is going to an end.
Even if I tire my Tayibruler out to death,
Even if I, Semtay, only have one last breath,
I must find my white eagle,
I will not give up even if I will bleed and die.
How unfortunate I am to meet you in my life,
I will not forgive you even if I die!"

Hero Semtay burst into a fury,
Krichorao felt he was waking from a dream,
He did not fully understand what Chachykai told them,
He did not know what the white swan was about.
He did not get to the bottom of it then,
He did not ask the reason of it.
What the lion said shook both the heaven and the earth,
Two Choraos were scared and their faces turned pale,
They dare to say nothing for a long time.

Two Choraos mumbled in fear:
"My dear brother, please calm down,
If we know the reason and do not tell you,
Let us be tortured even if we are in the grave!

"We do not know what secret the white swan has,
We do not stay with each other everyday,
Big brother, we know nothing about it,
What background can we know?

"If we know the truth of it,
How we dare to resist your will!
If we know where the white eagle goes,
Let us be torn from limb to limb!"

Broad-minded Semtay,
Said to his two warriors:
"Krichorao and Kanchorao,
My dear warriors!
You must promise to listen to me.
You are my countless soldiers when you are in front of me,
You equal millions of troops when you are behind me.

"I came out from my home happily,
Then I lost my white eagle,
Who wants to listen to my grievance?
If I cannot find my white eagle,
How can I go back to see my people?

"Warriors,
Do not stay here long,
Ride your horses now,
Go to see madam Chachykai,
Take her my words:
She knew the white eagle would be caught,
Ask her what the reason is!
She has known the white swan would come,
Let her tell us the answer!

"If she does not want to tell the reason,
If she does not tell us the way to get my white eagle back,
You go to Jergainy plain,
To find my uncle Sari,
Let him come here today.
"If Chachykai refuse to tell the truth,
You just cut her hair off,

Cut her face,
Let her become a horse without tail and mane,
Dress her with ragged felt clothes Kymantay①,
Let her ride the short-tailed dark broun mare②.
Before tomorrow,
Send her back to her parents Shatimur's home!

"Let my uncle Sari stay in Talas,
Let him pray to God for me.
It cannot be later than tomorrow,
You must bring me the news of my white eagle!"

Two warriors heard what Semtay ordered,
Two warriors dare not stay anymore,
Whipped and galloped,
Returned to Kankoler in an instant.

The pampered woman Chachykai,
Waddled out of the door,
With sleepy eyes and lazy manner.
She saw the two warriors come back,
But not hero Semtay.
"The white swan probably caught the white eagle,
Why does he stay there alone?"

Chachykai said to herself but showed nothing on her face,
She stroked her hair,
Came up and welcome the warriors:

"When you saw the countless wild ducks,
Did you fly your white eagle?
Drink some horse milk!

① Kymantay: It is the overcoat made of felt.

② Wear raged felt clothes and ride short-tailed dark broun mare: It is a humiliated punishment for the woman who is not competent as a wife and is divorced by the husband in ancient Kirgiz.

Let your horses have a rest,
You've had a long day!"

Krichorao said at the moment:
"We do not drink your horse milk,
We have no time to waste to listen to you.
Our brother sent us here,
Asked us to find his white eagle.
You said not to let the eagle catch the swan,
You warned us not to go to hunt,
You hinted to us not to fly the eagle to catch the swan,
You hinted to us not to pick the white silk handkerchief.
You do not want the leopard to suffer,
You do not let his horse be tired,
Please tell us where the white eagle has gone,
Do not say some rubbish!"

Got the news from the warriors,
Chachykai spoke delightedly:
"You are a man who manages outside of the home,
I am only a woman who manages the inside,
The white eagle flew away outside,
How a woman at home knows it?
You just come and laugh at me!

"It is a man's job to take care of the eagle!
It is a woman's job to take care of the home!
Young man, go and tell him,
This is Chachykai's answer!"

Arrogant Chachykai,
Turned round and did not take notice of them anymore.
Krichorao, who was blessed by god Shayli,
Held the horsewhip in his hand tight,
Toward the stubborn woman,
He lashed her hips severely.
Chachykai's colorful silk skirt,

Was split from the edge.
Chachykai's blouse with strawberry patterns,
Was lashed into pieces.

She fell down on the ground,
Pearl-size tears fell like the rain.
Krichorao grasped tight in his hand,
Chachykai's arm-long hair.
Furious Krichorao,
Beat the beautiful woman severely.
An agile and smart servant Kanimujang,
Came up in a hurry,
To persuade him.
She rushed up,
Took the horsewhip in warrior Krichorao's hand away.
Then she suggested Chachykai sincerely:
"Tell the truth to the warrior quickly."

But she did not agree,
Saritaz, the headman of Ayinla,
Also came in a hurry and persuaded her:

"If you know it,
Tell him right now!
If you see it,
Tell him now!"
Then came up and helped her stand up.
She still did not respond,
But broke out into curses:

"I do not want to see you, Saritaz,
Do not touch my pearl-like finger.
I never want to see you, the bald man,
Do not touch my silk handkerchief-like finger.
The white eagle is lost in the wilderness,
How does a woman at home know it?"
After hearing these rude words,

Ayinla's headman Saritaz,
Burst into a fury,
Which could fill the sky:
"Erect four wooden poles for me,
Stretch her arms and legs to four directions!

"Drive a flock of goats on her body,
Cut her face,
Cut her hair.
Let her ride a calf with no tail,
Drive the calf to Timirhan's city,
Let her wander everywhere!"

Four wooden poles were erected,
They were ready to pull her to four directions,
Kanikai came to them,
And tried her best to convince her:

"You tell them if you know,
You point to them if you see,
From Buhara city,
How amazing it was when you came here,
You looked fabulous on the horse,
You were happy in the luxurious leather cloak.
But now,
You will ride on the calf with no tail,
Wear felt coat Kymantay with tears,
Go back to your parents' in waggling steps.

"From Buhara city to here,
You were extremely proud on the horse,
You looked gorgeous in the mink coat,
You made everyone surprised and jealous.
Now you are divorced and ride the Calf with no tail,
How do you have the face to go back to your parents?
You will lose that splendid mink coat from now on.

"It seems you have beaten others down,
Semtay will never fear of you.
Krichorao is beating you now,
They will not let you go easily,
Telling them the truth is the only way to save yourself."

Chachykai had no idea at all,
She had to tell them the truth unwillingly.
She told in detail,
How Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek came to her:

"At dusk yesterday,
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Came suddenly by herself.
Ayichulek came to me for three times,
I do not want to tell you all,
But I cannot bear the torture now."

Angry Chachykai,
Cursed and hurled abuse Semtay crazily:
"Let him go and never come back,
Let his happy family be destroyed.
Let him be out forever,
Let his luxurious palace become flat.

"Let Toltoy catch him,
Let Kunwuerbayi catch him,
Let Maradler catch him,
Let Chinkogeo catch him,
Let Jedigair people catch him,
Let him have no good end,
I even do not want to meet him in hell!"
Chachykai cursed hysterically,
Finally they knew where the white eagle was.
As the saying goes,
"Woman's curse does not work on man,
Sheep's curse does not work on wolf."

Krichorao whipped his horse right away,
Galloped to Semtay.

When Krichorao on his way to come,
Semtay in the distance had had a presentiment.
In a blink of an eye,
Krichorao had come to him.
"Warrior Krichorao, did you see Chachykai?
Did you find my white eagle's whereabouts?
Do not laugh at my impatience,
Tell me the truth, quickly!"

Krichorao answered him in a hurry,
He told him all he knew:
"Big brother, I report the good news to you,
Let your enemies go to hell!
Please let me tell you in detail.

"Plump beautiful girl is yours,
Flying horse is mine.
Well-known beauty is yours,
Famous fine horse is mine.

"I have figured it out clearly,
The white eagle was taken away by Ayichulek.
Let me tell you about Chulek,
She is smart and brave,
She is virtuous and pretty.

"She has skin as white as spring snow,
She has face as pretty as an apple.
She has black eyebrows as willow leaves,
She has black hair as smooth as mink hair.
She has teeth as bright as pearls,
She has a figure as pretty as a fairy.

"She is outstanding among young girls,

She is a beauty hard to find in the world.
Her morality and ability are praised by everyone,
Everyone that witnessed fell prey to her charm.

"She is like the fairy of light,
She is like the fairy of rainbow,
Among two-legged human,
She is outstanding,
She is the best.

"She can transform into a swan,
Fly in the sky,
In clouds.
She can transform into a goldfish and swim,
As long as God bless,
She can fly and walk easily.

"It is said your and her fathers had made the arrangement,
Big brother, you will marry her.
You can get her if we go today,
But if you want to go tomorrow,
Chinkogeo will take her forcibly,
We will be back with empty hands."

Semtay heard what Krichorao said,
He stood facing the west and touched his chest to miss his father,
He worshiped ancestors' spirits quietly,
And prayed to God solemnly,
Without a stop,
Continued to murmur.

He grasped his collar to worship,
Appreciated the sacred Creator,
Who let Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek born in the world.
He had been excited though he had not seen her yet,
With his two warriors,
Horse hooves clipped, in high spirits,

He came to see Bakay Khan and Kanikai,
Reported them the details of how Ayichulek took the eagle.

Let's put it aside as it goes here,
Let's Beygin a new story,
From Semtay and Ayichulek getting married.

Semtay Married Ayichulek

Semtay Searched His White Eagle and Met Ayichulek

Kirgiz Nuoyi people,
Lived in fertile Kankoler.
By the side of Kaynar spring,
By the riverbank beside the phane tree,
At the bank of Tortkoler lake,
Opposite the orchard the king built,
By the side of the house Bakay built,
By the lake full of cyperus rotundus,
In the fertile and boundless prairie,
By Karakoler lake where the sage was born,
In Kankoler prairie where the female sage was born,
Near Alakoler lake,
At the river rapids of Ayidenkoler.

In order to search the white eagle,
Semtay climbed over Akbels① hill.
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Got the news from afar,
She took the white eagle back home with her.

In order to find his beloved eagle back,
The black mane wolf swore to track it down.
He did not know how many days he would need,
So he asked uncle Bakay,
For the best route he could go.
He said, "Please tell me the route I must go,
I will take my white eagle back,

① Akbels: It refers to white hill in Kirgiz language.

From Ayichulek's hand."

He said, "My beloved white eagle is caught by others,
How I can drink up this humiliation?
As long as I still have one last breath,
I must track it down.
If Ayichulek did catch my eagle,
Dear uncle Bakay,
Please tell me the best route."

Semtay asked for advice sincerely,
If you did not see his face,
You would regret for all your life.
Semtay came for help in a hurry,
How Bakay could go against his will.
Bakay, in good spirits,
Said to him the wise words:

"My beacon, Semtay,
Please listen to me tell you in detail.
When the lion Manas was alive,
I experienced too many things,
I endured too many hardships,
But I passed all these difficulties.

"When God descended the disaster,
In the time Araokai was doing evils,
I suffered too much and almost died.
When I lost my close companion Manas,
I suffered more in this world.

"Since you grow up and become a hero,
I suffer nothing bad.
Except the hell,
I have been to every corner of the world!
In the time of my bosom friend Manas,
Even God did not let me die.

"You can ask me about the route,
Please listen to me carefully.
No one has a solution if death comes,
When people are going to die,
Wealth is just like the shit.

"When my beard was still black,
When I was still in my prime time,
When I was still using forty Gaiz[1] long arrow bag,
What a wonderful time it was,
How good it will be if I can lead you there.

"Now, I am not young anymore,
I do not have a strong body to help you.
When I am old and exhausted in my strength,
Your request is burning my heart like fire!

"If you are not in a hurry to set out, my beacon,
You need sixty days.
If you are safe and healthy, my beacon,
You must revenge us on the enemies!

"If you go without a rest, my beacon,
You need fifty days.
If you are brave enough, the only son,
You must revenge on enemies and wipe them out!

"You will have a hard journey, the only son,
You should measure the hardships on your journey.
You are still a strong young man,
Wish you can endure all kinds of sufferings."

Semtay got the advice from Bakay,

1 Gaiz: It was the ancient Kirgiz unit of length. It varied from place to place. One Gaiz was about 71 centimeter in some places and was about 105 centimeter in other places.

He felt satisfied and secured.

Kanikai then told him:
"My child, you should remember the past!
When your father Manas went to battles,
Almanbet and Chuwak were always by his side,
Your uncle Bakay always led the way in the front.

"When they went to distant Kashgar,
In Tumshouk valley,
They intercepted Kunwuerbayi's camels,
There were totally one thousand camels' loads of tea.
It made a big noise in the world at that time.

"They rounded Kebeztao mountain,
Marched toward Yurkainichy river,
Akun Khan was going out to hunt,
He saw a cute infant girl was abandoned by the road,
He picked the baby and brought her up,
He named the girl Ayichulek,
He called her everyday with love.

"I was almost get to my due day at that time,
Your father made the decision of your marriage,
Almanbet acted like a matchmaker,
Then your proposing ceremony was held.
This is about your proposed marriage,
Akun Khan actually is your future father-in-law.

"God bless you,
You have a fiancée like Ayichulek.
Your mother, I only expect you grow up healthy and strong,
So I tell you about your marriage.

"I heard Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
They were trying their best to take Ayichulek as wife,
Chinkogeo led millions of troops to force her.

Akun Khan is old and weak and has no ability to resist.
He must be scared and have no ideas,
Chulek also has no other ways,
Maybe this is why she came to you.

"She flew over mountains and oceans,
Maybe she was coming to give the message.
She has no way to complain to you about her grief,
So she takes your eagle away.

"You will go a sixty-day journey,
You can get to Akun Khan's city,
Maybe you will meet your enemy,
They are waiting for you to punish ferocious enemies severely.
Wish God bless you a smooth and safe journey,
Let me arm you then you can set out on the journey."

Madam Kanikai led three heroes,
To the storehouse of the arms,
Took out all the treasures there.
Kanikai opened the pouch,
Took out the coat armor and the precious ceremonial robe,
Put them on Semtay's hands.

The gown's collar had gold edge and sleeves had silver edge,
The inside of the gown was sewed with two layers of cotton fabric,
Outside of the gown was shining fine brocade.
There were twelve buttons on the gown,
And all were buttoned up well.

Even Akbaran gun could not shoot it through,
Akorlbok coat armor Manas left,
Was put on Semtay,
Kanikai buttoned it for Semtay personally.
She took out Kanidahay leather pants,
Let Semtay put it on too.
The origin of Kanidahay leather pants,

Was a long story.
In the famous place Oboler,
There were two-year-old male rock goats on high mountains,
Kanikai sent hunters to hunt them.

Soaked the fresh goat hides with white lime,
And scrubbed it made them soft,
Then sent sixty giants,
To the remote Andijan city,
Bought bark of apple trees,
Then put the soaked male goat hides,
Into the bark pulp in any season.

Each process,
Was supervised,
By Khan's princess Kanikai,
She asked Arukai to command sixty girls and married ladies,
Spent three months time.
They bit the leather with their mouths to make them soft,
Girls shouted with pain when their front teeth were worn off.
Tired girls and ladies became dazzled,
The leather was only enough for making one pair of pants.

The sacred Kanidahay leather pants,
God bestowed it with the magic.
Ordinary people could not imagine:
If you pull Kanidahay leather pants,
It can be stretched longer easily like a belt,
If you loose your hands,
It can shrink to the size of a fist.

Fire could not burn it,
Arrow could not pierce through it,
The sword could not cut it,
No matter how sharp the sword was.
Kanikai handed it to her son,
Asked Semtay to wear the leather pants,

The wide belt made of the gold,
Was also tied on the lion's waist.

Kanikai continued to talk:
"Krichorao and Kanchorao,
My two children, come to me,
These are your fathers' remains,
Now I give them to you, please accept them.

"This one is Chuwak's coat armor,
My child, come and wear it!
These are iron armor and helmet,
And shield and chainmail,
All his remains are here,
I keep them well for you.

"These are Almanbet Khan's remains:
Here are all treasures he collected when he was alive,
Here are all his remains,
I give all of them to you, Krichorao.

"Look at this precious and valuable coat armor,
It has gold collar and silver cuffs,
Front and back of the coat armor both are beset with copper,
Left and right sides are shining silver.
Anyone who wears it,
Will not be hurt by any weapon.

"When Manas was still alive,
Right in this sacred palace,
Almanbet Khan,
Committed this coat armor,
To king Manas' care,
As his remain to his son."
The elder Bakay said by the side:
"Take the coat armor now,
In front of your uncle,

Your father once prayed to God,
It is a rare treasure in the world.

"All what your mother told you just now,
You should remember clearly.
Take the pouch your father left to you,
Open it and look,
There is a gold-beset belt made of baby camel skin,
It can circle around your waist six times,
All treasures your father left,
Are in good condition in the pouch."

Bakay took out a fabric bag from the pouch,
Gave it to Krichorao seriously:
"Here is a spell,
Your father put forty-two languages,
Into the tongue of a magpie,
Krichorao, you eat it,
You will speak forty-two languages from now on."

All remains the past warriors left,
They two handed them to their offspring.

"Semtay, my son,
I brought you up with my milk,
Let God deliver the sincere wishes,
Wish you come back safely and do everything smoothly.

"You came to this world,
To fight against malicious enemies.
Your ancestor is Mamay Khan,
Your father is hero Manas,
Your homeland is vast Talas,
You should protect and keep its honor firmly.
"Yurkainichy is a fertile place,
The big river there runs rapidly with big waves.
Stop thinking that Chinkogeo is your relative,

Do not be kindhearted toward him.
Chinkogeo is extremely cruel and merciless,
He colludes with Toltoy and cherishs evil plot.

"Two warriors are with you,
You should always remember they are majestic,
Discuss with them when you make a decision,
Do not act on an impulse and lose the best chance.
Dear kids, start out now,
God will bless you.

"Do not lose your equipment and your horses,
Do not discredit yourselves in a strange place.
You will have many funny experiences on the way,
You will pass places where birds and animals inhabit,
Do not hurt them.

"Do not forget your mission because of the beautiful scenery,
Do not be reluctant to leave those places.
Do not intrude into cities and villages,
And interrupt people at night.

"Wish your father's spirit in the heaven,
Bless you a smooth journey.

"Your father has gone to the heaven,
The spirit of Manas will help you."

Kind and virtuous Kanikai,
Spread her hands in public,
Blessed them sincerely.

The lion's son hero Semtay,
Received his mother Kanikai's blessings,
Took Bakay Khan's letter with him,
Remembered the roads he would pass in his mind.
The young and promising tiger Semtay,

Was ready to fight against the distant devil.

On the saddle quilt made of Manat fabric,
He tied double cinches,
Then put their baggage on the horse.
Passed mountains and prairies,
From Arashi tribe,
He picked fourteen fine horses.
He led two warriors,
Came to uncle Bakay,
Asked for his blessings and expressed their hearts.

Parted from the palace painted inside red,
Parted from the sacred palace painted white,
Well-prepared black mane wolf Semtay,
Would set out from madam Kanikai's palace.

For the sake of his lost white eagle,
He rode on the magic steed for fighting enemies.
For the sake of the white eagle which was caught by others,
He rode on the magic steed for expedition.
He would drive fourteen horses,
Buruler would be the head of those horses.

He had two warriors by his side,
He was going to search his white eagle,
He held Ackelty magic gun on his shoulder,
He was longing for Ayichulek.

He was going to find his lover,
He was willing to go through hardships for this.
In order to find the girl who took his treasure away,
Semtay would step on the hard journey,
He would not spare his coat armor on the journey.

Let's put this aside,
Listen to me to tell you about the horses he drove in detail.

Grey horse with long mane and red mole,
Grey horse with amulet,
Toktom Bay's maroon horse,
Tokobi's white-spotted horse,
Tikechy's iron-grey horse,
Grey-spotted horse with no sweat.

Surkara horse① girl Toruo presented,
Chachykai's Koytoru horse②,
Old madam's white horse,
Bakay Khan's Surchaolok horse③,
Sari Khan's Tuchunak horse④,
Ajibayi's Kartkulan horse,
Almanbet's Sariala horse,
Kanikai's white-forehead black horse,
Aweikai's Aktilk horse,
And Korkobosh's Surtilk horse.

Akburchuk horse⑤ carried food,
Four horses carried the yurts,
Six mares carried their food.
Six bedding quilts and five pillows,
Were carried by white Ayimanboz horse⑥.

These were horses did not eat points of cyperus rotundus,
These were horses leaped over deep pits,
These were horses never ate cyperus rotundus,
These were horses faster than antelopes.

① Surkara horse: It refers to black and grey horse.

② Koytoru horse: It refers to maroon horse like the sheep.

③ Surchaolok horse: It refers to short-tailed grey horse.

④ Tuchunak horse: It refers short-eared black and grey horse.

⑤ Akburchuk horse: It refers to white horse.

⑥ Ayimanboz horse: Light beige horse.

People sowed highland barley in spring,
If you watch their war horses,
They were all fed with highland barley.

People sowed barley in spring,
If you watch their war horses,
They were fattened through eating barley.

They were armed with equipment everyday,
They dared to meet invaders.
They were armed with equipment every month,
They dared to meet invaders.

Even you rode on them for six months,
They would not feel tired.
Even they were sixty five years old,
Their white teeth would not fall off.

Even you rode on for seven months,
They were still in high spirits.
Even they were seventy five years old,
The corners of their mouths would still be good.
Even you whipped their heads they would not dodge.
Even in the pitch-dark night they would not scare.

Those fourteen famous fine horses in Arashi,
The black mane wolf will drive them to go with him.
He took the two warriors with him,
They would serve him in the journey.

King Manas' son Semtay,
Said to them at the moment:
"My majestic uncle Bakay,
My mother Kanikai,
Let my uncle Saritaz,
Be the king of Talas temporarily."

Manas' son Semtay,
His guard Krichorao,
And the warrior Kanchorao,
Krichorao and Kanchorao,
They two were both heroes like the lion.

Born-brave Semtay,
Drove those fourteen fine horses,
Was ready to set out from Kankoler,
To chase the fairy and defeat the ferocious enemies.

Kangkoer's son Semtay,
Was a hero never feared hardships!
The lion's son Semtay,
Was a hero fearing nothing!
He grew up in loneliness,
He was a natural hero!
He wandered to the homeland of Timir Khan,
He was an extraordinary hero.

He was a true man that grew up in hardships,
He was a hero fine horses thought they were not qualified to hold him!
He would fight against the malicious enemies,
He was a hero that could wipe out all enemies!
The leopard hero with great strength,
Would set out from his home on an expedition.

He prepared everything well,
All fourteen fine horses,
He would drive them like a gust.
From six tribes, Argen and Arashi,
He would leave home for far away.

The blare of horns roared to the sky,
People shouted, horses neighed and drums beat,
People crowded and flags waved,
Shouted and cheered.

Spear Sire was shining in the hand,
The sword clanged on his waist,
Ackelty gun hung across his shoulders,
Crescent battleaxe whirred.

Kanchorao shouted and drove the horses,
The horses galloped as wind,
Krichorao followed tight by his side,
Showed his great majestic-looking in public.
Black mane wolves set out,
Dust rose up by hooves covered the sky.

Went along the narrow winding trail of Bokoy,
Passed the winding paths wolves did not want to go.
Crossed the wilderness where alkaline dust roared,
Climbed over steep cliffs where even leopards did not go,
They marched ahead with no stop and rest.

Met luxuriant grass,
They did not stop or let the horses eat and rest.
Met clear spring,
They did not let horses drink or rest.

They went into the white alkaline land,
It took them fourteen days there.
They galloped along the foot of the black mountain,
Passed small paths no one knew.
They ignored the tiredness of their horses,
They neglected their hunger.

Forty days and nights without a stop,
Horses did not stop and they did not sleep.
They did not spare their horses at all,
Climbed over mountains and crossed rivers.

Passed vast plain,

They saw a road that directed to three different directions in the front,
He calculated the days with his fingers,
They had almost spent sixty days.
Those fourteen fat horses,
Had been as emaciated as skeletons.
When the black mane wolf reined his horse,
The sky had turned black.

He remembered what Kanikai warned him,
And he read the letter Bakay Khan gave him.

From the day they left their home,
He calculated all the days they spent,
It was like what Bakay said,
They passed all the places as the letter guided.
Climbed over mountains and then went into Gobi desert,
Semtay had no water to drink,
He only had a little Yarkant black tea left.
The food they still had was white fat,
Horses were emaciated and exhausted.

Hero's offspring Semtay,
Traversed numerous mountains and streams,
Now he tossed and turned restlessly the whole night,
Planned for the journey of next day.

Right at the moment they and their horses were hungry and thirsty,
They were anxious of no water and their throats were burning,
An amazing mirage appeared in front of their eyes.

Clear spring water ran on the river rapids,
Frogs sang in the water,
Nightingales sang in the prairie,
The sound of running spring was like music.

All kinds of birds chirped melodiously,
It was like fairies living there.

Nightingales sang on the branches,
Which pleased their ears.
Cuckoos sang desolately,
It was like sentimental people complaining about their sorrow.

Look at the pasture full of mountain slopes,
Look at the luxuriant alfalfa,
They were high enough to reach horse belly.
Lots of wild flowers, beautiful and fragrant,
Different pastures waved with wind,
It was like a green wave running in the valley.
Wild apricots dropped and fermented on the ground,
Also sent out heady scent.

Water spilled over the riverbank and formed wetland,
Wild ducks and geese swam there freely.
Colorful flowers blossomed all over the hills,
Wild fruits were everywhere and sent out fragrance.

Look at the places where hogs foraged,
The holes arched like stoves.
Beasts haunted on the plain,
Looked like herds of livestock.

Weeds in the plain,
Was as high as a person,
Silver birches grew all over the mountain,
They were high into the sky.
The small trees were like phane trees,
Phane trees were as big as towers.

Look at the jumping sparrows,
They were as big as snow cocks,
Their twitter boiled the whole mountains.
Look at willows that were higher than poplars,
Birds were as fat as wild ducks.
I do not exaggerate at all,

Anyone who sees it would want to go there.

Eagles were as big as the yurt,
Wild rats were as big as the dog.
Wild pears and peaches were as big as the basin,
Balterhan① weed was of arm-size.

Look at the running female deer,
They were stronger than white-forehead cows,
Hares were of small goat's size,
Wild donkey was of three-year-old horse size.
A group of three-year-old wild horses came,
They were like a thick city wall in front of you.
If lizards crawled to you,
It was as long as a one-arm-span snake.
If snakes crawled to you,
They were longer than ten-arm-span rope with the size of a thigh.

It was a beautiful and fertile place,
It was the best place to live on the platform,
A yurt could be put up on the platform,
Ropes could be tied in the woods to circle the horses inside.

The lion's son Semtay,
He made a comprehensive observation of this place.
He walked and considered,
Suddenly Kangkoer turned his horse round,
Looked back and shouted:

"Warriors with colorful felt hats and leather pants,
I have something to discuss with you.
Young men with white felt hats and blue leather pants,
I have something big to discuss with you.

"Let us rest here for six days,

① Balterhan: It is a perennial herb with tubular stem and leaf.

Let our horses have a good rest,
Then we go to find Ayichulek.
Let us rest here for seven days,
Let us rest ourselves well,
Then we go to find Ayichulek.

"Find out the whereabouts of my beloved white eagle,
From majestic Chulek.
If we run into Toltoy and Chinkogeo,
Let us have a good fight with them.

"My father is Manas,
How we can fear those evil people.
If we sneak into the sleeping city,
Even if we occupy it,
Does not it damage our reputations?
Does not it ruin our ancestors' fame?"

Semtay finished his shouting,
Ordered two warriors to unload their packages,
Put up the four-corner tent,
Then tied tight with ropes.
On the other side,
Fastened the spiral copper peg tight on the ground.

They tied the ropes for circling horses quickly,
Then took all their horses,
Tied tight on the ropes.
They dug stoves on the ground,
Butchered a brown mare.

Prepared all dirt stoves well,
They took out their iron pots,
Boiled all mare meat.
Took out their cedar spoons,
Stirred the delicious meat soup in the pots.

Two warriors and one king,
Let them rest there for a while,
Let us put this aside,
Listen to the details of Ayichulek.

When the sky turned white in the east,
Three stars faded gradually.
A breeze blew in the sky,
The sky was full of stars,
They were twinkling to each other.

The colts neighed,
The tips of reeds quivered gently,
With a rustling sound.
Black-browed larks sang on the branches,
White poplars waved with wind,
The river rippled gently,
All creatures were awake.

When it was getting brighter,
Ayichulek got up excitedly,
Her charming eyes were brighter,
Cheeks were as pretty as a red apple.

This beautiful and elegant princess,
Went to the room of Forty girls,
Woke the sleeping girls.

She told the girls older than her:
"Oh, get up, my good older sisters, be quick!"
She told the girls younger than her:
"Ah, my good younger sister, come here quickly!

"I had a dream last night,
Dreamed about a strange thing.
A fine horse is tied on my hitching post,
It nibbled the dirt ceaselessly,

It is still fat even it is tied.
Please tell me the truth behind the dream,
What is it about?

"Budayck[1] stopped on my eagle landing stand,
Lark landed on my branch,
I became enchanted before it began to sing.
Please tell me the truth behind the dream,
What is it about?

"A short-tailed black hunting dog,
Hovered in the street back and forth.
Other hunting dogs all barked as seeing it,
But this one did not pay attention and just walked forward.
Please tell me the truth behind the dream,
What is it about?

"A black-spotted panther,
Hovered back and forth in the city,
All dogs dare not bark at it,
It walked alone and arrogantly.
Please tell me the truth behind the dream,
What is it about?

"A white snake which is like a dragon,
When it hissed toward you powerfully,
Its huge body reached the heaven,
A gust rose up by it.

"A black-spotted grey snake,
Its huge body is like a mountain,
When it came with hissing,
A gust blew suddenly,
The whole world is turned upside down.

① Budayck: It is the name of one kind of hunting eagle.

"All the people in our city,
Are astonished when they see them.
The sunshine is kept out,
The clear sky turned cloudy,
Running rivers stop running.
All people in the city feel flustered,
They are all scared out of their wits.
Please explain this dream to me,
What is it about?

"Toltoy from Jedigair,
From millions of troops and horses,
He picked seventy fine horses.
He knelt down and begged for mercy,
He put the battle flag flat on the ground,
Pleaded to spare his life.
He bent his body and lowered his head for his life,
He is like a poor worm.
He resisted stubbornly for six days before that,
The battle last for whole six days,
Ferocious enemies are wiped out,
His arrogance and prestige is put out.
Please tell me the truth behind this dream!
What is it about?"

When she stopped talking,
Smart and charming girl Kamanli walked out.
Among thirty married ladies and thirty girls,
She was Kamanli, a rare girl in the world.
Among forty married ladies and forty girls,
She was outstanding Kamanli,
She bent over and put her hands on the chest,
Came up and stood by the side of Ayichulek.

Her shoulders hung, neck was long,
Agile in thinking and bright in eyes,
Back of her hands were plump and points of her fingers were white,

White teeth were like white jade.

Her figure was like a crane and her hair was black and silky,
Medium figure, cheeks like apple in fall,
High nose, deep eyes,
Red cheeks and arched eyebrows.

She responded fluently:
"Chulek, my good sister!"
She opened her mouth cautiously:
"Chulek, my good sister!"
She began to talk with a wise manner:
"Let me read your dream,
Wish God bless you!
"God bless us with great luck,
Let your lover come to you.
The fine horse tied on your pitching post,
It nibbled the dirt ceaselessly,
It is still fat even it is tied on the post,
That is the fine horse with male antelope size legs,
Buruler horse will come to your door.
Is it not clear?
It is the scene appeared in your dream.

"Budayck landed on your eagle landing stand,
Lark stopped on your branch,
If the clear sky is shadowed,
It is the striped white eagle,
That you caught and brought back with you.
Is it not clear?
Lark-like heroic brother-in-law Semtay,
Will come to you!

"A short-tailed black hunting dog,
Hovered in the city,
Other dogs was howling at it,
That is fearless warrior Krichorao,

Whose laugh is like a girl?
Is it not clear?
It is the scene appearing in your dream!

"A black-spotted panther,
Hovered back and forth in the street,
No dogs dare to bark at it,
That is hot-tempered hero,
He is Kanchorao who comes to you.
Is it not clear?

"Dragon-size white snake,
Hovered in the sky,
Its huge body reached the heaven,
Gust rose and blew,
If you dreamed about this,
It is my heroic brother-in-law who is coming,
Does not his prestige compare with a dragon?
Ferocious Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
Do not they bow and surrender to him?

"A black-spotted grey snake,
If it is as huge as a mountain,
The cold wind chills you to the bone,
People in the city all feel terrified.
If you see all these,
It must be my brother-in-law Semtay,
How he can be inferior to others!
How he cannot be admired!

"Facing ferocious enemies,
When is his domineering influence inferior to a snake?
King Manas' son, my Khan brother-in-law,
I have heard from the elders,
He is powerful, brave, broad-minded, and generous,
He is superior to all Nuoyi people.

"He sought refuge in Buhara in his childhood,
Then he returned to his homeland,
I heard that he is so brave and staunch.
Those ferocious enemies wear iron armors,
Have been wiped out.
Let us go and welcome immediately,
Our heroic Khan brother-in-law!

"Let us wait on the road he must pass,
Let us bring delicious food with us,
Welcome him by the side of the road.
Go to Yurkainichy river,
Make the preparations for welcoming him!"
When virtuous Kamanli finished her words,
Lucky Chulek led in the front,
Girls and married ladies all smiled,
And went together to prepare.

They packed up the white tent,
Put it on the back of a four-year-old white horse.
They packed up the green tent,
Put it on the back of a four-year-old cyan horse.

They held up an umbrella,
Drove the flying horses to treat Semtay,
Drove mares as his lunch,
The dinner for him was super,
They even drove baby camel that was still drinking milk.

They took wine from the city,
Brought Kokuri leather bag with them,
The leather bags with velvet belts,
Were all put in the small pouch.

Brought bags of tea,
Brought preserved candy that was held in gourd,
Brought nang made of crème.

Brought yellow raisin,
And grapes with no base.

Brought sweet food made with preserved candy,
Brought horse milk wine.
To avoid the wine becoming less potent,
They put aconite in the wine.

On Ackerya plain,
By the side of wide Yurkainichy riverbank,
By the side of the road,
The lion's son Semtay was going to pass,
A white tent was put up,
They began to sing Yolong[①] in duet.

Set up a swing of six sticks,
Put Chatlash chessboard,
Boiled water to make tea and put honey in,
Put horse neck fat and horse belly fat on tablecloth.

Thirty married ladies and thirty girls,
Walked out of the city gate,
Like flowers flowed forward.
Ayichulek walked in the middle,
Her beauty could echo with the sunshine.

Heard the son of Kangkoer would come,
Smart Ayichulek,
Came to Yurkainichy river,
Let her stay there for a while.
Let's put this story aside,
Go back to the side of hero,
Let me sing his news to you.

The sky turned white,

① Yolong: It is one of Kirgiz folk song.

Three stars faded away gradually.
Morning breeze blew gently,
Stars in the sky were blown away.

Reeds rippled gently in the breeze,
Black-browed larks chirped in a gentle voice.
Aspen braches swung in the breeze,
All creatures began to wake up.
The valley made echoes,
Pine trees on mountain put on a dark green cloak.

When the morning came quietly,
Manas' son Semtay,
A knowledgeable hero,
Had woken up from his dream.

He turned to the right side,
Stretched his body and gave a grunt,
Two warriors slept by his side,
Also woke up from their dreams.

To his late father Manas,
To the thousands of the dead that sacrificed for Kirgiz,
To once prestigious ancestors,
To the late ancestors,
To all the spirits of ancestors,
He prayed solemnly.

He untied the fine horse off the rope,
Let it forage on the hill,
He untied the hobble on horse's legs,
Let it forage on the hill.
He let the horse forage at places with luxuriant grass,
Let the horse drink water at the spring.

He carried the sharp sword on her waist,
Held Sire spear in the hand,

Walked lightly as the panther,
Stepped on a green hill.

Two warriors stayed in the yurt,
Busy with preparing the breakfast.

Brave and tenacious black mane wolf,
Watched around on the hill.
Irresistible black mane wolf,
Climbed on the green hill in the front.
He sat on a black rock.
In an calm manner,
He wanted to observe carefully,
He watched toward the direction of Yurkainichy river.

On the wide surface of Yurkainichy,
Thick mist blanketed,
The red fog descended from the sky,
Made it impossible to see the Yurkainichy river clearly.

Thick mist permeated, fog wafted,
Shadowed the sunshine.
Colorful crows and magpies flew in the sky,
Without knowing where they were going.

Looked at Yurkainichy river again,
It was impossible to see where it went.
Rolling clouds permeated,
Dust flew everywhere,
The earth was covered with thick mist,
It blurred in his sight.

In order to show how outstanding the king was,
He had two guards around him.
In order to show how powerful he was,
His two warriors were like a pair of lambs.

The black mane wolf lifted his telescope,
Watched the situation in the front through the mist.
Let me explain about the telescope,
Wish you all remember it.

His father Manas died unfortunately years ago,
His fellowmen worshiped and buried his father.
Kanikai was humiliated and driven out of her palace,
The property the lion Manas left,
Was all robbed by Aweikai and Kobosh.
Smart madam Kanikai,
Hid the telescope under her apron secretly.

After Semtay grew up into a hero,
She gave the telescope to her son.
It was beset with gold patterns,
It was most useful in the battle.
To watch enemies far away,
They were like just in front of you.

The inside of the lens was as red as the fire,
It could stretch out and draw back.
To avoid the lens from getting dirty,
It was wrapped with white fabric.
In order to carry it easily,
Put it in a bag hung in front of the chest.
Its outside was made of iron sheet,
Its eyepiece was made of gold.
Lens body was beset with pearls and agates,
It was decorated gorgeously,
It was made exquisitely.

It was an exquisite large aperture telescope,
Rotated it six times then it was fixed,
The view at six-day-journey distance away,
Was in front of eyes like six-span-rope far.

The large aperture telescope made of copper,
Was fixed when rotated for seven times.
The view at seven-day-journey away,
Was in front of eyes like seven-span-rope far.

The lens body was one twenty inches long,
The eyepiece was as round as Kantuman,
This gold-made telescope,
Its story cannot be finished in three days.

The black mane wolf Semtay,
Took out the priceless telescope,
From the bag,
And held it tight in his hand.

He adjusted the lens,
Sat on the hill steadily,
Concentrated and unmoved,
Aimed his telescope at Oboler and observed.
He continually adjusted the focal length,
Watched all the directions.

Kangkoer's son Semtay,
Lifted the telescope to his eyes' level,
Watched forward proudly.
From the lens,
He saw a shiny black city gate,
And a luxuriant orchard,
Dense trees grew exuberantly.
Quiet gardens,
Had hundreds of flowers in full blossom.

He saw a prosperous city,
Not far from there,
A group of people came toward him.
Young hero Semtay,
Could not see those people clearly.

He continued to watch,
By the side of Ackerya,
On Almaler plain,
By the side of surging river,
He saw a white yurt,
A cloud of smoke rose to the sky.

He saw a horse with silver-beset breeching,
With gold-beset saddle,
It was like a woman's horse.
It was a saddle with a colorful pommel and cantle,
He saw the girl's horse,
Then he had a big smile on his face.

Krichorao and Kanchorao,
Saw his smiling face.
Krichorao said to Kanchorao with a smile:
"Look at that frowned guy,
He has a smile on his face suddenly today,
He frowns all the time,
But it is like a sunny day after long time cloudy days,
No one has ever seen him smiling like this.
Why does he laugh like this?
What kind of magical things does he see?
Let's go, let us go to his side,
Let us figure out the reason."

They two were as happy as larks,
Two warriors ran together,
Like two little kids running and jumping,
Climbed on the hill and panted,
Came to the side of the hero like the wind.

Krichorao felt no pressure,
He draped his hand over Semtay's left shoulder:

"My dear big brother,
It seems you have full of grievances,
You did not smile at all since we start on our journey,
It is harder to see your smile than see stars in the daytime.

"Why do you smile today?
What magical things do you see today?
Why are you so happy today?
Please tell me,
What on earth did you see, big brother?
Dear big brother, please tell me quickly."

Krichorao asked urgently,
The big brother answered him:
"In this human world,
It will be a regret if you do not see this scenery.

"Wear embroidered felt hat and wide leather coat and pants,
Young warriors, I have something to discuss with you.
Wear embroidered felt hat and wide leather coat and pants,
Young heroes, I have something to tell you in detail.

"I will tell you my secret,
In the remote place,
There is a luxuriant orchard and a shining black city wall,
Trees in the orchard grow with luxuriant foliage,
The beautiful city is like the capital of a Khan.

"The view in the front is blurred,
I could not distinguish its detailed appearance,
It is like an old city,
Streets connect and people are crowded.

"That blurred city,
That quiet but luxuriant orchard,
It is like an old city of a long history,
I really cannot distinguish it.

Crows and magpies fly together,
Do not know where they are going.

"From the black city,
Toward its city gate,
A big group of people come out,
Colorful clothes shine in the sunshine.
Your young brother Semtay,
Feels dizzy for not seeing them clearly.

"Are they armed enemies?
Are they coming to battles with us?
They are girls in splendid clothes,
Chulek and me had proposed long ago,
Is she ready to be my wife?

"When I look at this side,
By the side of the surging river,
I see a white yurt,
A cloud of smoke rises into the sky.

"Then I watch carefully,
I see a horse with silver-beset breeching,
With gold-beset pommel and cantle,
It is like a girl's horse.
"The sun scatters golden sunshine,
Girls are like silver,
Each of you is a hero better than two men,
Who is willing to find out the truth?

"One stays here with me,
Take care of the horses and forage,
The other one goes to scout,
Hurry right back, take the spear with you.

"Who is by the side of the river?
Is that Toltoy's troop?

Do they aim to stop us?
Is it Chinkogeo's troop?
Are they waiting to battle with us?

"If they are enemies,
Fight against them and do not flinch,
Do not let your face turn pale with fear.
You are warriors like ferocious wolves,
Fight enemies with shouting 'Manas'!"

Kanchorao said immediately:
"My dear king brother,
Let me stay with you,
Manage the forage and feed horses.
If ferocious enemies come,
I will prick out my spear bravely.

"I cannot say unpleasant words to girls,
I cannot say anything to make married ladies pleasant.
I cannot say quiet loving words,
I have no way to make them happy.
An eloquent man among girls and married ladies should be sent,
Respected Krichorao is the best to do it."

Krichorao said at the moment:
"My dear king brother,
Let me scout!
How cannot I go to scout?
How do we know it is a gift or a knife?

"Yurkainichy river in front of us,
Let me defeat its waves.
I would rather die if it is my end,
I would rather undertake it if there is hardship!

"Brother, since you send me to go,
I am going to ride and leave now.

Aweikai's Aktilk,
Is an inferior horse not good to handle.

"It has short legs and low back,
It is fleshless as a hungry dog.
If it meets a surging river,
How it can cross the river!
If it meets high mountains,
How it can climb over!

"Big brother, have mercy on me,
Let me ride your Buruler,
Let me try my courage.
Let me wear your Burum coat armor,
If I meet enemies that stop me on the way,
I will attack them like a falcon."

Semtay felt embarrassed to refuse the young man,
He could not say refusing words.
He thought, "If I do not give to him,
He will hate me and it will hurt his face."
He allowed Krichorao to wear his coat armor,
He allowed Krichorao to ride his horse.

Wore Akorlbok coat armor,
Rode on Buruler horse,
Buttoned twelve buttons on the coat armor well,
Fastened twelve fabric buttons on the coat armor well,
Krichorao turned in good spirit immediately.

The saddle skilled craftsmen made,
Had gold-beset pommel.
The saddle skilled craftsmen made,
Had silver-wrapped cantle.

Two fenders were made of whole pieces of iron plate,
Perfectly fitted the horse.

It was like the saddle of a galloping musk deer,
Saddled on the back of Buruler.

Breeching was exquisitely knitted,
They were decorated with gold patterns.
Billet strap was gorgeously knitted,
It was beset with silver patterns.

Breast collar was made of gold,
The triangle pattern shined with golden light.
The bit was made of gold too,
It could shine even at night.
Stirrups were made of iron,
They were shining in the sunshine.

Krichorao did not step on the stirrups,
He leaped on the horseback.
The hero turned the horse round,
Galloped away immediately.

Krichorao was full of vigour,
People all admired him,
Anyone who got him,
Would become powerful.

Semtay said at the moment,
"My dear eyeballs!
Please turn your head round and listen to me,
You are my capable assistant,
You should remember what I say.

"You have not made a horse exhausted,
You do not realize how precious a horse is.
You have not worn a coat armor out,
You do not know how precious a coat armor is.

"You have not used a sharp spear yet,

You do not know how to shout and defeat enemies.
You do not know the skills to use a weapon,
You have not experienced how to defeat formidable enemies.

"The crescent battleaxe my father left,
Let me tell you its story:
The iron-made crescent axe,
The thoroughly tempered crescent axe,
The axe with edges on its back,
Numerous singers once sang for it.

"The wound is hard to recover if it cuts you,
The wound is like a deep ditch,
Numerous enemies lost their lives under it.
If it cuts on the heads of enemies,
There is no chance to be alive.

"The crescent axe is made of pure copper,
It was quenched in a lake,
It sucked all water in the lake then.

"Numerous ox-hide bellows were broken to fire,
Lots of oxen were killed to repair the bellow.
Charcoal was not enough,
Many forests were cut down.
Hammers could not stand the severe force,
Numerous blacksmiths were tired out to death by the side of stoves.

"It cost a lot of time to make it.
Crippled blacksmith Bolikbai,
Was busy for it from spring to winter.
The back of the axe is beset with gold patterns,
It is only for making it beautiful.

"When it was the time for every battle,
Strong Ajibayi,
Put it on the horse with difficulty.

My heroic warrior, you also grew up with my mother's milk,
Please take this crescent battleaxe with you.

"Sire spear my father left,
Let me tell you about its story:
The point of the spear is very sharp,
It pierced the ferocious enemies once.
The spear point is made of clean steel,
There is one layer of red steel on the edge of the spear point.

"The barrel of the spear is made of white pine,
The point of the spear is made of white steel.
The barrel is made of green pine,
The point is made of black steel.
Smeared the point with venom from mosquitos' noses,
Cooled it down and then soaked with pig urine.

"There are twelve colorful patterns on the handle,
Painted with thirteen shining paints.
In order not to let it slide out of the hand,
Wrapped it with thin aluminum wire.
It rustles in the breeze,
The wound will suppurate once you hurt by it.
Your hand will not be cold when you use it in winter,
The handle is wrapped with cashmere.

"The spear point will not turn when you stab it to the rock,
The rock will be cracked into pieces.
Pull the feather of wild dove's wings off,
Stick them on the handle of the spear.
Smear the handle with gum,
Then wrap it with thin silk thread.
My brother Krichorao,
Take this spear with you.

"Achalbaris sword my father left,
Is a famous steel sword,

Let me tell you its origin.
This is a sharp sword,
Crippled blacksmith Bolikbai made it elaborately.
When he finished it,
It became a famous sword in the world.

"Its left blade can cut trees, and right blade can crack rocks,
Its upper blade can cut heads off, and lower blade can cut chests open.
The steel sword has very sharp blades,
Everything cut by it will injure severely.

"Put it back into the sheath,
It will shrink to seven-hand-span long.
Pull it out of the sheath,
It will become forty feet long.

"The point of the sword is as red as fire,
Gold-made body of the sword is shining golden light.
Except the steel body,
The sword is decorated with gold.

"God bestowed the sword to my father,
It cuts iron as mud.
Now you can wear it on your waist.

"Ackelty gun my father left,
Let me tell you its magic:
My father's Ackelty gun,
Is also made by skilled craftsman Bolikbai,
It was the unique gun in the world.

"The gunpoint used Russian skill,
The stock is made of rosewood from Khitan,
The gun barrel is made of Yisfan,
A spiral burr stuck out of the gun bore,
The bullets not only flies straight,
But also can chase the object in winding way.

"Iron wire twisted on the gun barrel for ten times.
The gun body is round, the gun head can turn round.
It can shoot the target no matter from the side or the front.
The front sight is the disaster and the bullet is the death,
The front sight of the gun is like human finger,
Bullets are as big as cobbles.
My dear warrior,
Put this gun on your shoulder.

"Bulerdurshun whip my father left,
Let me tell you its story,
Listen to me carefully:
You lash with the whip, it will make a deafening noise.

"Sixty castrated male goats were butchered to make the whip,
Spread and dried the goat hides on rocks,
Hammered the hides soft with wood hammers,
Tanned them into soft leather.

"One goat hide was cut into seventy strips,
Craftsmen that knitted the whip were all famous.
The point of the whip had a piece of lead tied tight,
The lead was one hand span long.

"The whip neck is extremely strong,
You can listen to what singers sing if you do not believe.
If you lash toward the enemies,
It will leave intractable wound on them.

"The whip handle is made of hard honeysuckle,
Then wrap it with a layer of elephant skin.
The little hole on the handle,
Is drilled with iron drill carefully.

"In order to knit the handle strap,
It used a whole piece of calf skin.

Tanned the calf skin into handle strap,
Tied it on the handle elaborately.
The whip knitted with the leather strips,
Then tied it on the handle with a firm knot.

"The solid whip has no equal in the world,
The giants all praise it.
Once you are lashed,
Your skin must be split and your flesh must be torn.
My dear warrior, we ate the same mother's milk,
You need take the whip with you.

"Akorlbok coat armor my father left,
It is a rare coat armor in the world.
Let me tell you its information:

"It is the most suitable coat armor for heroes,
It is made of white brocade,
It is silk weaved with gold and silver thread,
It is a gift to my father from Budayik Khan.
Its front and back,
Painted with gold and silver powder.

"A layer of steel is padded under the surface of the gown,
Inside of the gown is soft fur,
Surface of the gown is covered with Parbar[1] wool cloth.
Sharp spear could not pierce it,
Baran gun's bullet could not shoot through it,
It does not matter the sharp blue arrow hit it.

"The coat armor has gold edge,
Shows its majesty and power.
There is a pocket at the front edge of the gown,
Six-shot gun's bullets are in the pocket.
Such a special and rare coat armor,

① Parbar: It is one kind of hand-made wool cloth.

Everyone admires and feels jealous.
My good brother,
Put it on now!

"The horse you ride on now is Buruler,
Its fame spreads all over the world,
Let me tell you about it!

"When they attacked Basalick mountain in those years,
When they conquered Manget people,
When they drove herds of horses from Manget,
When Baran's evil servants wailed,
When they destroyed his firm castle,
When they captured countless war trophies,
A grey mare was captured,
When it foraged in the wilderness,
It gave birth to this magic horse.

"Its father is Toburchak① in the mountain,
Its mother is Muzburchak② in the wilderness,
It is like a horse with wings.
It was born on the plain and grew up in the desert,
It grew with male argali.
It can gallop among high mountains and lofty peaks,
It grew with wild horses,
Look, how strong its abdominal muscle is.
Its hooves are as big as basins,
Its tail is like a thousand willow twigs waving.

"Its white teeth are like steel,
Its back crotch is like a valley,
Its front teeth are like iron made,
Its red tongue is like a knife stone,
If you look at its plump mane,

① Toburchak: It is a famous horse in Kirgiz legend.

② Muzburchak: It is a famous horse in Kirgiz legend.

They are like tens of thousands of flowing silver strings.

"Its four legs are like copper posts when it stands,
It is as agile as a flea when it prances,
Its neigh is like a thunder,
Its forelock is like silk.
The place its hips connected,
Is seems big enough to set up a big pot.

"Big and tall Buruler,
Its body can block Yurkainichy river.
Its tail is short and hooves are big,
Buruler is a horse good at running.

"Its shanks are like female argali,
Its thighs are like male camels,
Its rump is wide,
Its forelock is like male camel,
Its neck is like an bull, its head shape is like a female deer,
Its belly is slim and breast is like a hunting dog,
The back of the neck rises and the neck is sunken.

"It never gets tired when it goes in the desert,
It never gets exhausted when it goes up the hill,
It goes steadily when it goes down the hill.
If it gallops forward,
It will disappear in a blink of an eye.

"It is a bold horse,
It does not fear of thunder and lightning.
Buruler has a good name, swift horse,
It can leap over all deep ditches and high bumps.

"Even it gets sixty-five years old,
Its teeth will not fall out,
Even if you ride it continually for six months,
It will not feel tired at all.

"Please ride Buruler.
The felt cushion sewed together with six layers of it.
I give you to my father's spirit,
That has gone to the heaven.

"The felt cushion of seven layers of felt and a pair of saddle clips,
I fold them to seven layers and sewed together.
I give you to my father's spirit in the heaven,
That shook hands with seventy celestial beings,
Always blessed by God,
Wish the spirits of our ancestors bless you with a safe journey!

"Go, start early and come back as soon as possible, my warrior,
I miss Chulek very much.
Go and cross the river,
To see whether she is missing me too.

"Go, my warrior,
To be cautious on the way.
Do not let others screw you out of Buruler,
Do not make trouble for me.
Do not let your big brother difficult to do anything,
Do not let me lose face.

"If someone nose about your information,
Do not make your mission widely known.
Young and promising Krichorao,
Find out the information from afar for me.
Do not let your big brother leave Buruler,
And wander all over the world."

Received Semtay's blessings,
Remembered big brother's words carefully.
The warrior whipped the horse and set out,
Its big and tall built was like Oboler mountain.

Buruler under him rose its head high,
The bit made of black iron,
Clacked in its mouth.
Buruler galloped like wind,
Its foam spittle splashed on the road.

Hot air surged out its nostrils,
The horse galloped to a slope,
Sweat ran down its armpit,
Wind whirred past its ears.

The horse galloped on the mountainside,
Krichorao watched both sides,
He licked his lips,
Like a hungry wolf found a herd of sheep.

Krichorao whipped the horse,
Came to Akyinek mountainside.
The lofty mountain stuck into the sky,
He need climb over a hill in front of him,
He put Abay horse cloak,
On the back of Buruler.

Eyes blinked, bit the bit in the mouth,
Clouds of hot air surged out of its nostrils.
The horse was like a whirlwind,
Galloped forward,
Dust rose behind it flew all over the sky.
The young man did not know the road,
He distinguished the direction nimbly.

Toward Ackerya plain,
He watched into the distance.
The crude and impetuous young man,
Reined his horse suddenly and watched the front.

The wilderness was boundless and lonely.

No gully that could stumble the horse,
No dust rose up,
No holes dug by marmots,
No ditches dug by the plough.
No riverbed washed out by flood,
No places were uneven.
Heroic warrior Krichorao,
How he could not whip his horse and gallop.
He did not bring forage,
For his horse Buruler,
How he could enjoy the scenery around him.

Krichorao whipped Buruler horse,
He arrived at the boundless prairie from the mountain.
No pebbles under the hooves made a sound,
He stepped on the leveled road.

"Brother Semtay praised the horse just now,
Usually Kanchorao leads it to drink water and forage,
He takes good care of Buruler.
If the brother's praise is true,
I will fight against enemies desperately.
If it is a real fine horse,
I will try its ability out in the real fight."

Krichorao thought about this,
He lifted the whip in his hand,
Lashed toward mountain-like Buruler,
The whip lashed right on the knee.

A stream of blood ran out along the leg,
From the knee of rear leg.
The blood flew out of the knee,
Fed the raven behind full.
At the moment he drew the whip back,
He sat back on the saddle steadily.

The horse crushed the dirt on the hill,
The leg was hurt like the thigh was cut off.
Buruler, got a severe lash,
In a blink of an eye,
Disappeared in the dust.
Crows and magpies in the sky,
Did not catch up with Buruler.

Its eyes were red as male argali,
Its neck was one-arm long.
When it galloped on the beach,
Its galloping paces were bigger and bigger.

Its eyes were red as female argali,
When it stepped on uneven places,
It minced forward steadily.
When it came to the highland,
Its legs gripped the ground like roe deer.

When it went down the hill,
Its mane and tail waved with wind,
The warrior tightened the bit in its mouth,
Its mouth opened as big as the fish in rivers.

Its hair was shining like the mink,
Its head shook like male argali.
Hooves stepped on rocks and sent a shower of sparks,
Made the sky shining behind it.
The magic horse was active like the morning sunshine,
Its bearing was as valiant as female argali.

If you say it's a thrown rock, it did not look like it,
If you say it's flying, it did not look like the bird in the sky,
But it made a sound like a rock thrown,
It made a sound like a flying bird chirping,
It could fly with birds wing to wing.
Its galloping hooves were like chasing the wind,

The name of wind-chasing horse spread all over the world.

Heroic warrior Krichorao,
Stuck his bottom tight on the saddle.
The horse galloped in the sky,
Competed with those birds.

Bit rope made of dressed leather,
Was held tight in his hand.
The horse spread its hooves,
Rocks of pot size,
Cracked under its hooves and flew away.
Steamer-sized hooves,
Made deep pit on the ground.

The bit made of black iron,
Had tightened to its throat,
Dirt on the road was thrown to the sky,
Dust rose behind was flying.
Clouds of yurt-size white foam,
Were splashed on both sides.

The toes of the blue battle boots pointed the sky,
The flag in his hand waved with the wind.
The helmet on his head was shining,
Arrow bag on his waist clanged.
Magic Ackelty gun,
Hung tight on his right shoulder.
Heroic warrior Krichorao,
Opened his eyes wide and watched around.

There was no life in the wilderness,
He felt scared suddenly,
Krichorao took heart of grace,
Whipped and galloped.

Magic horse Buruler galloped its hooves,

Left clouds of smoke behind them.
The magic horse was of nimbus,
As if it had sacred light on the forehead to direct the journey,
As if it had gods by the ears to shout.
The creature created by whirlwind,
Never felt tired.

Warrior Krichorao,
Was less than twelve years old.
He was fully armed,
No one saw him would not be jealous.

If anyone could occupy all these armaments,
He would be proud and not regret no matter he was alive or dead.
Look at this young man he was in his finest hour,
Heroes in the world all admired him.

As if battle drum beat by his side,
Crescent axe shined on his shoulder,
The sword rustled by him,
The spear in the hand shined cold light.

Buruler galloped forward,
Its coin-size white forehead,
Reflected the sun and shined.
Warrior Krichorao,
Finally got to the side of surging Yurkainichy river.

Krichorao reined his horse and looked around:
"Where are the girls my big brother saw?"
Brave heroic warrior Krichorao,
Licked his lips,
Looked around like a sparrow-hawk.
He had arrived at the surging river,
He met rapid streams with uncertain depth.

Krichorao would try his best to cross the river,

How such difficulty could stop the hero?
Let us put this aside,
Talk about the girls' information.

Ayichulek and Semtay Opened Their Hearts to Each Other

Thirty married ladies and thirty girls,
Princess Ayichulek sat in the center.
Forty married ladies and forty girls,
Ayichulek was like the bright moon.

Girls and married ladies gathered in groups,
Came to the tree,
Tied thick wool ropes on the tree branches,
Made swings and swung.

They swung in groups,
Made the poplar treetop sway.
They swung face to face,
Made the willow treetop sway.

They stood in two rows face to face,
Sang Akyinek①,
Their singing was loud and clear and one topped another.
They swung face to face,
Excited like fairies free from care.

Ayichulek stood by the side of the river,
Stared at the other side of the river fixedly.
She saw a young man coming from afar,
She thought: "Who is this young man?
How can he cross this big river?
What news does he bring?

① Akyinek: It is Kirgiz antiphonal singing of folk songs.

How can he return to his hometown?"

Wore a flowing dress,
That was colorful,
Wore grey mink hat,
Pretty face and dignified manner.

Ayichulek draped her left hand over Buruchali's shoulder,
Kanimujang stood close by her right side,
The two girls followed tight with her,
Like two lambs were sucking the mother sheep.

Almanbet's son Krichorao,
The lion warrior had extraordinary ability.
He was a hero did not fear of death,
He had great strength and he was as strong as a mountain.
He looked at the turbid surging waves,
Watched carefully about the depth of the river.

Yurkainichy river was surging,
Fog lingered, foam rolled.
Rapid streams moaned, waves roared,
It was amazing.

If you look at the other side of the river,
It glinted like Yisek lake.
If you look at this side of the river,
It was like two endless rivers.

On the muddy riverbed,
Noise of the waves was like a thousand brass trumpets blew together.
The quiet and dry riverbed in the past,
Now had a noise like tens of thousands of trumpets blew together.
Snow on mountain top melted and caused the flood,
The snow water roared ahead.
Flooding Yurkainichy river,
Even foxes dare not to go close to it,

Thirty feet long steel wire could not feel out the depth.
Rapid Yurkainichy river,
Fox felt scared when it stood by the side of the river,
Fifty feet long wool rope could not feel out its depth.
Only the treetop of willow tree,
Was flickering in the water.

On the wide beach,
Horse-size dead fish,
Lay on its back.
There was full of flood water in bushes,
The bush was like a vast ocean.

Krichorao looked at the surging river,
Quivered beyond his control.

Waves surged and became whirlpool,
Rushed to everywhere like ferocious beast coming down the mountain.
It rushed the river bank and made it collapsed,
Swallowed the rocks like a devil.

Waves surged and roared,
Like the thunder god came when it was raining.
The noises of the river waves had unending changes,
It rocked between valleys and mountains.

The surging flood washed the riverbank,
Like millions of troops shouted.
Flood peaks rolled and wave sounds echoed,
Like furious dragon turned and roared,
Like birds cooed.
Flood peaks ran rapidly and shook the earth,
Like tens of thousands of tigers rushed down the mountains.

The sound of the river was earthshaking,
The power of the river waves was boundless.
Trees were uprooted,

Tree trunks drifted on the surface of the river,
Waves rolled forward,
The tree trunks stabbed toward the riverbank as sharp arrows,
Pieces of riverbank collapsed into the waves,
Rocks of yurt size,
Swallowed by the surging waves immediately,
It made the warrior terribly frightened,
He felt the end of the world was coming.

The rapids washed and swallowed the riverbank,
Many kinds of trees drifted in the river.
Snow and foam drifted together,
Pine trees and willow trees were washed away together.

Even the forked segment of the river,
Formed a cliff of one arrow high.
Waves lashed the riverbank,
Tore it into wide openings one after one.

All places lashed by the waves,
Left deep gullies of five-spear long.
Made people want to cross the river complain,
Made the people see it worried,
Made people feel the world was too narrow for a road,
It was hard to find a ferry-place to cross the river.
If what I say is not true,
You can go to the river and take a look by yourself.

The snow having accumulated for many years at the upper stream melted,
Roared and mingled in the river,
Little streams near the rivers,
All mingled in the roaring flood.

Pine trees, birches and willows were washed away,
All trees were wiped out,
Grass on the riverbank piled by herdsmen,

Were drawn into the river like a runaway raft.

Giant rocks of yurt size,
Rolled down along the river,
Rocks knocked with rocks,
Sparks flew with mighty rumbling sound.

If you looked at the downstream of the river,
The hill opposite the river,
Was quivered in the roaring flood.

The horrible flood ran to the end of the earth,
The waves rushed to the other side of the river,
White foams piled up as a thousand mountaintops.
The flood flew like dragon,
Flowed down vigorously and never turned round.

The rapids lashed against the riverbank,
The riverbank could not stop the flood,
Even the immortal saw the rapid flood,
Dare not stay on the riverbank.

Mountains were moving and rocks were moving,
Where the flood passed.
The earth was shaken and the cliffs were shaken,
Where the waves lashed.

The river was like rolling mud,
People shouted to ask God for blessings.
The river was like the mud which killed creatures,
People all prayed to God for blessings.

The mud rolled and come,
Whirlpools took everything away.
It was more rapid than the ocean,
Its flow surpassed five times of Yili river's flow in summer time.
The swans dare not fly over it,

The eagles quivered in the sky.

If you watched the river carefully,
It even did not have a palm-size island.
The river should be punished by the heaven,
Who could guess how deep it was?

Observed the river up and down,
There was not a single coin-size island.
The river should be punished by the heaven,
When could it restrain itself?

Krichorao ran both the upstream and downstream,
No one told him where the ferry-place was.
Hero Semtay and Kanchorao,
They did not know Krichorao's worry at all.

The difficulty the warrior met,
Only the night without the moon knew it.
The view of the rapid and roaring river,
Who else could experience it except the warrior.

"Once I boasted that I am brave and doughty in front of my big brother,
Like an expert of swaying the crescent battle axe.
I said I am more capable than Kanchorao,
I volunteered to come here.
How can I cross this rapid river now?

"I will be ashamed if I go back with nothing.
If big brother asks me: 'Did you go?'
How I can answer him!
He is a hero the sages will help,
The blessings he gave me just now,
How do they work on me?
He is my respected big brother,
The prayers he gave me yesterday,

How do they work on me?"
Krichorao was agitated,
Stared at the rapids of Yurkainichy.

His eagle eyes, in a flash,
Saw the married ladies and girls on the other side of the river.
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Ordered to butcher a white mare.
Put the color-glazed tea bowls bought from Kashgar in a circle,
The strong tea had been drawn.
Thirty married ladies and thirty girls,
Ayichulek stood in the center.

The girl in red dress leading the game,
Was a tall girl from Khan's palace.
Tolhonayi was leading the girls,
The judge of the game was Oyisalhen.

Khan's daughter named Kamanli,
She was a beautiful girl,
She was a perfect beauty,
She was a flawless girl.

Bek's daughter named Begmjan,
She was a decent and beautiful girl.
Everyone passing them,
Was vying with each other to see these girls.

Alimhan, in a silk dress,
Was as pretty as a wild dove,
She wore a cyan lynx skin hat,
And a Eties dress,
No one did not turn round and look at her.

Kalabay's daughter Kasyet,
Was a girl without binding,
Among these beautiful girls,

She was an outstanding one.
Shaoruk's daughter Aklay,
She was so eloquent that everyone praised.
Akelbek's daughter Akbermet,
Ajikai's daughter Kezsherbet,
Kadekai's daughter Kashmjan,
They were all outstanding girls.

Pretty Buruchali,
She was a quick-witted and nimble-fingered girl.

Kalicha waddled closer,
She joined the girls.
The black-necked girl of the farmer,
Was an unlucky but stubborn girl,
She also came here.

Watering people's daughter was a greedy girl,
She was capable of catching fish,
She came to this place too,
She wanted the guests to taste the fresh fish.

Tenimhan was born plump,
Juzmhan wore a lynx skin hat,
Wurumhan was the most beautiful one,
Looked at these beautiful girls,
Even the sun and the moon in the sky,
Lost part of their lights.

If you looked at their pretty figures,
They lined like wild geese,
Gathered together and talked and laughed,
Stood on the cliff by the riverside orderly.

They saw Krichorao who was at the other side of the river,
They guessed, "How does he cross the river?"
They all felt worried about the young man.

They guessed, "Does he rein his horse and go back?"
Girls murmured.

Krichorao dare not go back,
He was afraid to be laughed at by the girls and married ladies.
He did not turn his head round and look at all,
He did not consider whether he would be in trouble.

He did not stay on the riverbank at all,
He jumped into the river with his horse.
He did not spare his life,
He did not look back either.

Krichorao was born brave,
Krichorao was a hero like a leopard,
He did not give a thought to his personal safety,
Fought in the roaring river.

Rapids roared and waves surged,
He was like a rock that was thrown into the river,
He disappeared at the place that he jumped in.
Buruler was almost turned over with the punch of the waves,
It stood up still after a stagger.

Krichorao pulled the iron horse bit,
On the horse's back that was submerged by the river,
He struggled to sit up straight.

Cyan steel weapon does not rust,
The magic horse that was considered as a heavenly horse,
Could it stand the test?
White steel weapon does not rust,
This magic horse that was rare to see in the world,
Could it cross the river smoothly?

It jumped in the waves,
Went against the current.

But magical Tayibruler,
Did not sink under the water,
It cut through the waves like a wooden boat.

Tayibruler crossed the rapid streams,
It was like a whale surfing in the water.
Among the surging wave peaks,
Tayibruler flickered and went ahead.

"I know Buruler is a swift horse,
Khan of Buhara once wanted to buy it with high price,
He apportioned charges and raised money forcibly,
From Buhara people of six cities,
But he begrudged spending so much money on a horse,
So he only could sigh and depress secretly.

"Even if he is willing to spend tons of gold,
Big brother Semtay will refuse to give it up!
When my big brother rides on Buruler,
Too many people are jealous."

As Krichorao was reminiscing the past,
Buruler leaped on the riverbank.
Buruler's gold horseshoes and silver nails,
Shined on its four hooves.
Leather seat and raw hide seat rise,
Had water dropped on the ground.

Strong and vigorous Buruler,
Galloped ahead without a rest.
It pranced its hooves and held out its tail,
Left a string of deep hoof indentations by the side of the road,
Its white mouth foam wetted the ground.
It crossed the rapid streams dripping wet,
All its equipment was soaked wet.

Steady and swift Buruler,

Ran faster and faster as an arrow.
The bottom of Krichorao's Kanidahay leather pants,
Had water flowed down.
But there was no even a drop of water on his body.

This young hero was terrific,
All his equipments were padded with silver.
Anyone who married this handsome and rich young man,
Would have a good life without regret.

Buruler watched the front,
Galloped as an arrow but was still steady,
Its ears were upright,
Its tail was down on the ground.
Its buttock was like a pot placed upside down,
Its loin was round and strong,
Its long mane was thick, smooth, and shining.

All girls and married ladies saw this,
Would be surprised and forget the time.

Thirty girls did not go out of the yurt,
They all circled round on the felt in the yurt.
Yellow-faced girl who was sent to stand sentry,
Black-faced girl who was sent to scout the situation,
Saw handsome Krichorao.
They rushed in and gasped for breath in a fluster:

"Sister, is he your lover?
Is he the groom,
You flew far and invited?
Does he come here from Talas,
Specially for finding the white eagle?

"The tall and strong horse he is riding on,
Is just the cream of the creatures,
The tail of the horse is rolled up high.

The arrow bag on the horse is as big as a barrel.

"He rides on Buruler horse,
The tail is rolled up from the middle part,
He wears pheasant feather hat and his voice is like a girl,
He is in good spirit,
He has a young man's red face.

"He has come to the door,
Sister, if you do not believe,
You just go out and take a look!"
Girls and ladies shouted as they heard this,
They were noisy like a group of sheep.

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
She reprimanded the girls and married ladies,
She asked the girls to shut up,
She asked the married ladies not to talk.

Chulek told the girls and married ladies:
"You spread the gossip without a reason,
You grumble casually,
You make fun of me jokingly,
You are disrespectful to me,
You are long-tongued and mindless.

"You, noisy ladies,
Shut all your mouths.
Semtay is not that kind of person,
He is not an imprudent fool.

"He will not come by himself rashly,
The coming young man is not him.
If he is Semtay,
How can he forgive Chulek?"

Ayichulek finished her words,

She walked out of the yurt charmingly,
Cyan mink hat,
Was on her head sideling.

She had a figure like a white deer,
Her silk skirt swayed gently.
Her face was pink and white like the moon,
She smiled with her white teeth exposed.

Aklayi followed her,
Aklayi was active and brisk.
She waggled like a drunk person when she walked,
Her brocade dress swayed with wind,
Her eyes were beautiful as female argali,
Her words were pleasant as brass harmonica.

Handsome and brave young man Krichorao,
Came to the front of these two girls,
Aklayi began to ask him,
He listened carefully.

"Strange young man,
Wish you a safe journey, my beacon,
Could you tell me where you are from,
And where you are going now?

"You ride on Buruler,
Roll the horsetail high up,
It seems you come from afar.
Look at your willow figure,
It will sway in a breeze,
You are young with a pink face,
Which city are you going to?

"Who are you, wretch?
If you do not tell the truth,
You will lose your life here,

If you burst in our place rashly,
You will lose your life with sorrow.

"Tell us what you are chasing,
Do you know our rules?
Look at you, such a little lad, you know nothing,
You are in front of the princess,
Do not trifle with us!

"Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
You will be out of luck once she gets angry!
You endured hardships on the long journey,
Tell us your purpose to come here!

"Tell us your hometown,
Who are your people and your Khan?
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
No one dare be rude in front of her.

"No one is still alive once he breaks our rule,
Once people see her,
No one does not want to see her again.
There are too many servants and warriors in the world,
Who on earth are you?
Baby, do not get excited,
Tell us your true story!"

Heard the questions from Aklayi,
The lion did not feel constricted in front of Khan,
The warrior did not fear in front of the king,
Krichorao talked with a surprisingly loud voice:

"To be honest, I am the messenger of my Khan,
I am the scout of that worried person.
Since you talk nonsense beyond your ability,
I am an escaped criminal if you say so,
I am whatever you think I am,

I will kill people in cold blood if you say I am a mob,
It is true if you say I am a lady-killer,
How I can let them go when I face so many beautiful girls.
Many girls' voices come out from the yurt,
Why do not you let me in?"

Krichorao stepped in the yurt as he talked,
He stood right in front of Begmjan.
He was an active young man,
He was born a cunning specimen.

Faced with beautiful Begmjan,
His eyes did not blink but glinted,
One of his hands reached into her bosom,
The other hand draped over the girl's shoulder.
Along the cock-smooth neck,
Grabbed the girl's top-like breast,
Tight in his hand.

When Ayichulek saw this,
She was so ashamed that she wanted to hide underground,
Faced with such a rude person,
She suppressed her irritation with an effort.

She smoothed her black hair on shoulder back,
She straightened her neck with anger and her face felt numb.
She felt embarrassed with the young man's levity,
She shouted to Krichorao severely with anger:

"You act so frivolous when you see girls,
You are like a wild falcon.
You are eager for action when you see girls,
Dare to stroke in the girl's bosom in front of everyone.
Why are you so rude?
Why are you so ignorant and crude?
If you do not get rid of this bad habit,
You must lead yourself to a fatal disaster.

"My father's name is Akun Khan,
His squad of bodyguards is right in the front.
I am the princess of the Khan,
You are so rude and courageous!

"Young man, do not lose your life in vain,
You should be careful of your head!
You will lose your life here in vain,
You will lead to unexpected calamity and disaster.

"You speak carelessly and arrogantly,
You are audacious and crude,
You are at a wrong place to molest the girl,
You cannot act so casually here."

Krichorao responded like this:
"By the lakeside full of waterweeds,
By the side of Arakoler lake,
By the river rapids full of cyperus rotundus,
At the bend of the river the ducks habitat,
Khan's white eagle flew away,
So I chased after it.

"I guess you caught the white eagle,
Sister-in-law! I know you excel in everything.
Ayichulek, you are Akun Khan's daughter,
You are a good sister-in-law of superb intelligence,
Please tell me, where is the white eagle?"

Ayichulek answered him:
"You are impolite,
How do I know where your white eagle is?
Why do you call me sister-in-law?
What you said is unpleasant to hear.

"Here is the road if you are a passer-by,

Here are the goods if you are going to the bazaar.
Here is the castle if you want to go into the city,
Do you want the wealth? Here are countless gold and silver!
Do you want to rob? Here is unlucky me!

"Who on earth are you?
I want you to tell me briefly.
Tell me about your ancestors first,
If you do not know the ancestors,
You are just a slave without foundation.
Please tell me your family,
If you do not know your family,
You are just a servant without a master.

"Tell me your family and background!
Tell me your grandfather's real name!
Tell me your natural father!
Do not use other's name!
Do not use the famous people in your homeland,
Say their names and deceive us!

"If your father is a hero of high prestige,
You do not need to refuse to say his name.
We respect you to ask for your name,
We respect you to ask about a man's information,
We like you so we ask about your information."

After the questions she proposed,
Ayichulek was burning with anxiety.
Warrior Krichorao became serious,
What he said to her was forceful:

"Good sister-in-law, do not say you never saw me,
You cannot joke about me.
Not long ago, in vast Talas plain,
At Arakoler lake,
You turned into a huge white silk handkerchief first,

You then turned into a white swan and honked.

"You also turned into a goldfish and swam in the river,
Shining brightly like the gold in the river.
I saw you for three times,
Your magic made me surprised.

"You transferred into a white swan,
It was this hand that let the white eagle go.
You caught the white eagle deliberately,
I followed you and chased the white eagle,
I mounted the horse and galloped on this road.

"You asked about my background again and again,
Do you think I am a person with no ancestors?
Are you worried for my ancestors?
You also asked about my people,
Do you think I am a person with no fellows?

"Do you really care about my people?
If you ask about my homeland,
Talas in Kankoler is my homeland,
If you ask about my people,
They are Arashi people Manas led.

"My ancestor is Boyan Khan,
After Boyan Khan is Chayan Khan,
Then it is Kara Khan.
Kara Khan's offspring,
Is respected Orozdu.

"Orozdu has ten sons,
His oldest son is Jagurp Khan.
Jagurp Khan's son,
Is the world famous hero,
His name is lion Manas.

"Hero Manas' son,
Became an orphan and grew up through hardships.
He is broad-minded like white steel,
He is hero Semtay.
I am lion Semtay's brother fed by same mother's milk,
You look down upon me, do not want the face I gave you,
How I dare come to you if I am not his brother?

"The sage is sacred and my heart is pure,
My throne is in Beygin city.
In order to save those unfortunate lives,
From the disasters like hell,
I wander everywhere till now.

"The master of the throne of Khan in Beygin city,
Is Sorandick Khan's son Almanbet.
He wore a gold crown in majesty,
He tied a gold belt and he was the offspring of a king,
I am his only son,
Please keep him firmly in your mind.

"In order to marry you, such a beauty,
My big brother has set out on the journey.
He asked me to chase the white eagle,
Sister-in-law Chulek,
You make me go through hardships.

"Six mares as our food,
Four horses for carrying our luggage,
And another fourteen horses,
We three and these horses set out on our journey.

"Spotted maroon swift horse,
Tied with cotton of wooden bowl size,
Specially drove those fourteen fine horses,
Bit brother urged us to set out that very day,
He said he has to find Chulek,

So we go on our journey and spare no pains.
We wish our coming to be the bad luck for the enemies,
For you, my sister-in-law, it must be good news."

Ayichulek responded him:
"Ah, What you are talking about!
You are such a bad boy!
How shameful you are to call me sister-in-law!

"How can Semtay talk about the marriage with me?
How he can be equal with me,
The person proposed to me is Chinkogeo,
He is not inferior to Semtay at all!

"I have thousands of camels,
I have proposed,
I have a man called Chinkogeo.
I have many horses with gold saddles.

"Start a battle for the sake of marrying me,
Jedigair's Khan,
My nephew Toltoy excels in martial arts.
Hero Toltoy is much better than you,
He will not present his cousin,
Chulek to anyone easily!
You will suffer terribly from Toltoy,
You will lose your life in Chinkogeo's hand.

"You do not have a powerful army behind you,
You do not have a reason to let Chulek marry.
Go back soon from here,
All what I said to you,
Word by word,
Report to Semtay!"

Krichorao told her like this:
"Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,

Let the dog listen to you!
Who else will believe your nonsense except dogs?

"Toltoy and Chinkogeo,
Do they accept the white eagle if you present it to them?
Chulek, your marriage was decided by pointing to the belly,
Let other people marry you,
Do you think my brother is a person who swallows insult quietly?

"He is a sharp shooter who never misses the target,
He is a real man who always keeps his promise,
He is a giant who never lets the rivals off,
He is a hero who comes out victorious in every battle.

"Once he shouts,
Once he roars,
If my big brother really gets mad,
How Toloty could compare with him!

"Shihay's son Chinkogeo,
Dare he make a rash act?
Does his face thicker than a sole?
Is he capable of battling my big brother?

"My dear Sister-in-law,
Do not let my big brother hear what you said,
Do not make him disturb your people.
Akun Khan's throne,
Do not lose it in your hand.

"The magic horse Buruler under me,
Do not let him carry you away on its back,
Do not let my pampered sister-in-law Chachykai,
Throw you into the kitchen,
And use you as a servant."
After Krichorao finished his words,
Girls and married ladies at presence,

Discussed and broke into a loud laugh,
They laughed till their necks tipped.

"You such a sad sack of red nose,
You such an ignorant idiot,
What you said and what you did,
Are in a complete mess.

Let me put this here,
Listen to the story,
Of the king on the hill.

It was still on the hill I mentioned before,
He held the telescope,
Twisted its lens continually,
Put the telescope in front of his eyes.
He adjusted the direction and got ready for the right eye,
He watched Oboler's situation in a hurry.

He saw lion Krichorao,
Who had crossed the surging river,
And had been among those girls and married ladies.
Warrior Krichorao ran wild,
He reached his hand into Begmjan's bosom.
His other arm,
Draped over the girl's thin and long neck.

When hero Semtay saw this,
He burst into a fury,
He lashed the horse suddenly,
Called Kanchorao loudly:

"Saddle my horse now,
Krichorao was born lucky,
It seems he has found the beauty Chulek.
The girls and the married ladies gather,
It seems they are looking forward to seeing us.

"We do not go to fight against them,
We just ask Chinkogeo and Toltoy to go home,
We go and marry her first,
It will make them lose their faces completely.

"The white eagle flew away from my hand,
It makes me lose my face,
If other people marries Chulek,
It will be a big humiliation to me.

"Warrior! Ride on your horse quickly,
Let us go now!
Those girls in the Khan's palace,
Let us play with them happily as early as possible.
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
If God allows,
I will marry her as soon as possible."

Semtay finished his words,
Then he led Aweikai's horse Aktilk.
The hero king left his homeland,
He would threaten bastard Chinkogeo.
They drove fourteen fine horses,
He ordered Kanchorao to catch up with him.

Horses galloped and climbed over the mountains,
The flag swayed over their heads.
Semtay galloped his horse forward,
Almabash① gun shined on his shoulder.

If you look at him in the front,
Golden mane waved in the wind,
The lion whipped continually,
The horse galloped faster than a gazelle.

1 Almabash: In Kirgiz language, Alma means apple, Bash means head. It refers to the gun that its gun barrel is as round as an apple.

Semtay's excited heart,
Had already flown to Ayichulek.

In a blink of an eye,
They had arrived at the side of Yurkainichy river.
The young king and Kanchorao,
Stood by the side of surging Yurkainichy river.

They looked at the rapid streams,
Even fox did not dare to get close to the river,
If people wanted to cross the river,
It was like to meet the death.

The fox did not dare to get close,
Wool rope could not measure its depth.
Seeing the huge waves that could swallow people,
Everyone would feel scared!

The thundering river was like the suona blasted,
The surging river flooded the river rapids.
Howling river was like the horn blaring,
The roaring river ripped through the river rapids.

The snow persisted throughout the year,
Now melted,
Thousands of streams gathered,
And made Yurkainichy river overflowed.

Rapids and waves clashed in every direction,
Howling and roaring.
Those cowards,
Were scared to limp all over their bodies.

The former ferry-place had disappeared,
The vast Gobi in the past,
Now became narrow banks.
Mud tossed and foam of waves whirled,

Dust fumes blanketed everything,
A castrated cow size fish,
Went up and down among the waves.

Seeing the astonishing view,
People all fled in panic.
Flood of Yurkainichy river,
Clashed and raged,
Like a dragon walking on the earth,
Like a tiger leaping in mountains.

When warrior Kanchorao saw this,
He shrank back with worry.
He was too scared to make a step forward,
He only felt everything turning dark before his eyes.

Kanchorao called his big brother repeatedly:
"My dear big brother Semtay!
Let us sleep here tonight.
It is safer to look for the ferry-place first,
After we find the ferry-place,
We can cross the river tomorrow,
And look for Akun Khan's daughter Chulek.

"Otherwise, my dear big brother,
Let us take off all our clothes,
Ride on the bare horses to cross the river.
Look at this rapid streams and high waves,
How cannot we be engulfed?"

After warrior Kanchorao finished,
Semtay exposed his white teeth,
And objected immediately:
"Difficulty cannot defeat the real man,
Wet clothes will dry again.
Facing a river which even a child could cross,
You just draw timidly back with fear.

It means you are a coward,
How you can stand the rough test.

"It is an unforgettable day today,
Let us leave everything to God,
Go forward and give up all concerns.
If it is our end today,
Even the vast and flat earth will make us lose our lives.

"Do not see on the other side of the river,
Krichorao is waiting for us eagerly.

"If we do not cross the river because of our fear,
Does not God punish your big brother?
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Does not she laugh at me?

"I would rather jump into the river,
Than let Ayichulek laugh at me.
Hey, Kanchorao, you are such a coward.
Does not you have a real man's manner:
To die for the reputation and honor willingly!

"If it is my end today,
God be there,
I will put my life under his charge.
If God blesses me,
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Let me see this beauty as soon as possible.

"Sacred God, I plead with you,
With god Shayli help,
We must be firm and decisive."
The lion's son Semtay,
He was a man of his word.
He made up his mind to cross obstacles,
He forced all horses to close to the river,

Drove all horses into the surging river fearlessly.

Bakay Khan's horse Surcholok,
It rushed in the front to clear the way.
Kanchorao was terribly frightened as he saw the river,
His heart almost jumped out of his chest.
Manas' son Semtay was a real man,
He whipped the horse and rushed into the waves without hesitation.

The horse was submerged as soon as it jumped in the river,
It was like falling into an abysmal pond.
The hero controlled the horse and they came out of the surface,
Drifted like a canoe.

His pants were wet all over,
He prayed to god Babeding[①].
His clothes was wet all over,
He prayed to the Ancestral soul.

He repeated the wishes of God's blessings,
Prayed to ancestors for help.
He prayed to Manas:
"The spirit of my father Manas,
Bless me not to lose my reputation,
In front of Ayichulek!"

He never prayed to him before,
He was a real man who feared nothing.
He beat Hogeo every time he saw him,
He never thought he would pray to Hogeo for help,
He swallowed Jagurp Khan once,
He killed his uncle Aweikai,
He sent Kobosh to the hell.
He showed the power of the black mane wolf anywhere,
He had patron along with him anytime.

① Babeding: The legendary protector of exorcism and disaster.

He was the offspring of king Manas,
His force was more and more powerful.
He was the offspring of elite Manas,
He was that very sword whose blade would not be turned.
He always mixed the strong alcohol and Boz wine together,
And enjoyed it with wild excitement.

He was young and in his prime time,
Before it,
He was a black mane wolf calf that feared nothing,
He did not ride horse to a long journey,
He did not ride a purebred horse yet.
He did not experience any hard work,
He did not cross such a roaring river either.

Once he did not stand up even he saw a devil,
He did not greet anyone.
He did not stand up even he met Hogeo,
He did not look him straight in the eye.

Once he beat Hogeo every time he saw him,
Once he beat Hogeo and made him have nowhere to hide.

This powerful and arrogant wolf calf,
Would never be scared or regretted for what he had done.

Now he prayed and prayed,
Furious fire burned in his eyes,
He counted the horses and yelled,
Heaped curses on Krichorao repeatedly:
"Krichorao, you son of a bitch,
I must kill this bastard slave!

"Why does not he find the ferry-place for me?
Since Chulek is willing to come and welcome us,
Why do not you come and report to me quickly?

Once I cross the river,
I will twist his neck off,
Like twisting a chick's neck off,
Make him disabled,
Make him remember his fault.

"If I am not buried under the water,
I will pull his head off his shoulders,
Like twisting the wild dove's neck.
Make him disabled,
Otherwise I, Semtay, am not a real Khan!

"I do not ride my horse Buruler,
How can I cross this surging river?
I do not plead with anyone else except God,
I would rather be drowned than shrink back,
There is no river in the world that cannot be crossed!
Fourteen horses I drive now,
Cannot be equal to one Buruler,
Kanchorao,
Is not as brave and agile as Krichorao!"

Manas' son Semtay,
A real man unrivaled in bravery,
Young tiger Semtay,
Talked to himself with feeling in the surging river.

The sky turned and the waves tossed,
The tiger fought against the waves.
At the moment, water god Yiliyas,
Picked up his rein quickly,
Pulled him onto the bank from the roaring river.

Hero's son, the young king,
Leaped onto the bank suddenly,
The horse under him neighed like a falcon,
Swords and knife he carried shined brightly,

Fourteen horses lined up,
He muttered and counted.

Right at the moment,
Girls and married ladies came to the riverside together,
Like birds chirping,
Like flowers blossoming,
To Chulek who had a shining necklace,
They talked endlessly:

"Good sister, tell us,
Is he Semtay?
The white eagle you caught,
Is it from him?

"Chinkogeo is just a rat in front of Semtay,
My brother-in-law is a handsome Khan.
He is really a hero,
He is really a peerless brave man.

"Our clever sister Chulek,
Facing such a handsome young man,
You do not want to marry Chinkogeo,
You are absolutely right!"

All girls were so happy,
When they saw Semtay's figure,
They all burst with joy and admired,
They fantasized and their love burned in their heats:

"How good it is if our Ayinlas are together,
Manas' son Semtay,
Will accompany me everyday.
It is better even if let us only play for a while,
How sweet it is if we can stay together all day long everyday."

Girls and married ladies burst with joy,

They were eager to see Semtay,
Girls could not control themselves,
They were dizzy and squint like they were drunk.
Married ladies also stared at him,
And lost their minds to his charm.

Brave king came at the moment,
Majestic and impressive.
His shoulders were wide and strong,
Two giants could stand on his shoulders.
His big and red face,
Could feed two hungry giant dogs full.

His vigor was like a fierce storm,
It was exactly like Manas being alive again.
He was agile like a leopard hunting the prey,
He was vigorous like a tiger coming down the mountain,
He was broad-minded like vast Talas prairie,
He was warmer than the sun in summer,
He was colder than winter.

Looked at the king's expression,
It was like a wild male camel which was ready for an attack.
If you look at him in the front,
He was like an irresistible Tinar[①],
Look at his stalwart body,
It was like a prosperous phane tree.

If you saw he attacked from the right side,
It seemed he could destroy enemies that invaded from the right.
If you saw he attacked from the left side,
It seemed he could wipe out enemies that invaded from the left.
If the enemies that invaded were caught by him,
He must twist their spines off.

① Tinar: It is a kind of falcon, black and white, with bright fur, wide and thick back, short and thick legs, very strong.

He could make his people satisfied,
He could make girls and married ladies,
Dare not to look at him in the front.

Seeing Semtay's angry expression,
Clever Chulek was quite confident,
Prudent Chulek had read his mind,
He was extremely angry.

She turned round and walked into the yurt,
Rapped all the married ladies,
All the girls were too scared to talk anymore.

"Manas's son Semtay,
He will not come back once he gets angry,
He never let the ferocious enemies off,
This powerful hero can make the mountains shaken.

"He is never kindhearted toward enemies and his people,
Even devils feel scared seeing him.
He is a crude man who is angry now,
Do not provoke him.
I will deal with him in person,
I will go and welcome him in person.

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Walked out of the yurt to welcome this Khan.
She was in good fettle and as pretty as an argali,
Her pink cheeks were like apples.
Her slim and flexible figure,
Was like the thin willow twig swaying in the breeze.

She wore a long dress and walked gracefully,
Like a prancing colt in high spirit.
She wore a lynx coat,
A mink hat stuck on the side of her head.
Ayichulek was born pretty and gentle,

With graceful and dignified posture.

She walked out of the yurt,
As arrogant as a white male sheep,
As pretty as a white male argali.
Her posture was perfect,
Her figure was slim and charming,
Her beauty was rare in the world.
She was the only fairy born in the human world,
There was no second one like her in the world,
She walked toward Semtay gently.

Before she could take a breath,
Lion hero Semtay,
Came to Krichorao furiously.
He was angry beyond all control,
Shouted and complained repeatedly:

"Are you dead, you such a shameless guy?
Do you forget your mission?
Are you dead, you such an undignified guy?
When do you go and scout?
Why do not you report the information here in time?
You forgot my words and you let me down.

"You are a crude silly boy,
You meet girls on the way,
Then you only remember to play with them,
You are such a guy without knowing what is important,
You will bring me disaster sooner or later.

"When do you go to find the ferry-place?
When can you give me a result?
You are an extremely arrogant daredevil,
When do you go to Akun Khan's city?

"How do you report the news?

How do you help us with the cooperation?
As long as you see girls playing swings,
You become overjoyed and frivolous.
Once you meet playing married ladies,
You just forget yourself and have fun.

"There is no such a conceited young man like you,
God will punish you one of these days!

"You have stepped out of the line too much,
You have lost your mind and went crazy.
You did not put up the yurt for receiving me,
You did not ask about the Khan's information.
You do not have any right opinion,
You do not have your king in your heart at all.

"You do not prepare the tea when I am thirsty,
You do not butcher the lamb when I am hungry,
You do not arrange anyone to make pilau for me,
You do not prepare the resting place when I am tired.

"You did not finish any work that makes me satisfied,
What on earth are you doing?
Akun Khan's stubborn daughter,
You do not guard against her fleeing.
You have fallen into a wrong path and are beyond cure,
You are even not as good as a poor lamb.

"You are a silly boy short of wisdom,
You still play around till now!
Silly boy, ride on your horse now,
Let us leave this damn place right away!"

When Semtay talked like this,
Ayichulek started to talk to him:
"Strange guest, please wait,
I will show you my true feeling.

"Please turn your horse round to me,
Listen to my poor complaints patiently.
You cannot mix lead and aluminum with pure copper together,
Semtay, you are here,
It is not a place you can play god,
Here are no Nuoyi people to escort you imposingly.

"Your leopard father Manas,
Once occupied Wurum,
Took Tarim and occupied six cities,
Captured countless wealth and respected by all.

"Here are no flattering Hohan people,
Here are no people with deep eye sockets and high noses.
Here are no tribes paying tribute and taxes to you every month,
Here is not your father's territory.

"Six cities and Andijan,
Beside it is Samarkand,
Tashkent and Namangan are on its opposite side,
Margalan and Hohan are in the middle of it.
Senchybek of Hohan is not here.
People who pay taxes and tribute to you,
Their subjects are not here either!

"Ride the horse and battle continuously,
Fight against each other,
Chasing enemies without rest.
People crowded to welcome when they hear you are coming,
They are Kirgiz people who wear white felt hats,
They are not here either!

"Gather together and sing all day everyday,
Their singing echoes among mountains.
Grind rice with rocks,
Praise wives as praising girls,

Play the game Girl's Chasing all day long,
Live on both sides of Yili river,
Butcher lamb to treat you,
Kazakh flattering you are not here!

"Live by the side of Lop Nur lake,
They herd tens of thousands of livestock there.
Leave the yogurt bad and milk curd moldy,
Noyhut people flattering you are not here!

"We never talk too courteously,
There are no your slaves here,
Facing the girls and married ladies here,
You do not have the right to rap!

"You drive fourteen horses,
And only two companies come with you.
Do you know your rival is hero Toltoy?
Do you know you will fight against ferocious Chinkogeo?"

Heard what Chulek said,
Semtay turned his horse round.
Born-smart Krichorao,
Came up quickly and grabbed the rein in his hand:

"My dear big brother Semtay,
Where is your ability as a lion?
Ayichulek, proposed with you through pointing the belly,
She is right standing in front of you!
"My dear big brother Semtay,
Where is your ability as a leopard?
Your beloved Ayichulek,
Is right standing here!

"What you lost is your beloved white eagle,
Who you are expecting to find is fairy Ayichulek.
Who you will contest with is ferocious Chinkogeo,

Who you will deal with is giant Toltoy.

"You are looking forward to seeing Chulek,
She has come and welcome you on the way in person.
The lover you asked me to find is princess Chulek,
She is right in front of you,
Who else do you want me to look for?

"The lost white eagle is in my hand,
Distinguished Chulek welcomes you.
I find your white eagle, please let it go!
I find your Chulek, you can marry her!

"If her beauty and charm,
And her majesty and wisdom,
Are not as good as Chachykai',
Or do not fit the spot with you,
You just show clearly that you do not want to marry her,
Let her marry other people,
You can go and tell Akun Khan!"

Semtay heard what Krichorao told him,
His anger was blown away like clouds suddenly.
How he could let Chulek go?
How could he part with his lover?
He controlled hard his excitement,
Then he expressed his heart to Chulek:

"Beautiful Chulek!
You encouraged me to leave Arashi.
Precious Chulek!
You attracted me and made me leave Talas.
Since you lure me to come here,
Why do you treat me so cold?

"From my beautiful hometown where I can play as much as I like,
From my numerous Nuoyi fellow people,

I come here through thousand miles journey,
Since you lured me to come.
Since you wait me here in person,
Why do not you welcome me respectfully?"

Chulek heard what the king said to her,
She exposed her white neck and said surprisingly:
"A passer-by should go on his own way,
Strangers should be treated well.
Instigator likes to picks a quarrel,
Courteous people treat others with courtesy.
You are incapable of harping here,
Your words are unpleasant to ears.

"You said Chulek is your lover and you two engaged,
How do you prove it is true?
I have a nephew called Toltoy,
I have my man called Chinkogeo.
Semtay, you look here and there,
What can bring us together?"

Heard Chulek's words,
She mentioned about Toltoy and Chinkogeo,
It was beyond Semtay's endurance.

He talked wildly with rage,
He could not stop from talking:
"Akun Khan's daughter Chulek,
Give my white eagle back to me, I will set out.
Why do I marry you, Chulek?
How you can comfort my loneliness!

"You are a servant that puts up pots by the side of the road,
You are only qualified to welcome passers-by.
You are a servant that puts up pots on the hill slope,
You are only qualified to serve the slaves from the caravan.

"Till your teeth are frayed to wheat size,
Till your face wrinkles and hair turns white,
You will still hold the whip made of white hide,
You will still be looking for your man!

"Let you sit in Akun Khan's boudoir,
Till you become rusted,
Till your hair turns white and falls,
You will still be a woman no one wants to marry!

"Give me my white eagle, I will go,
How I can marry Chulek, I found the wrong person!"

Chulek felt angry and resented to his words,
She poured out her complaints:

"Semtay, do not talk rubbish!
Set out now if you want to go,
Go back to your Kankoler now!
You dislike me and said I am old,
Do not stain Chulek's moral quality.
Go away right now if you think I am old,
I am not the person you can stain,
Chinkogeo is my man.

"When khan Manas was alive,
When my father Akun Khan mounted his throne,
When your father got treasure from Kashgar,
And came to my father's castle.
When your father drove sixty two single-hump camels,
Filled the white pouch full with brocade.
When your father drove sixty maroon horses,
Tied white cotton on their mane.
Your father Manas arranged the marriage with my father,
Almanbet Khan was a matchmaker,
And arranged the marriage for us.
You never come to find me from then on,

How many years have passed?
Ayichulek, standing in front of you,
I must look older.

"Your father and my father,
Arranged the marriage by pointing to the belly,
Though your father passed away,
But I respect and admire,
Your father Manas' spirit all the time.
I respect more the arrangement,
Your father and my father made for us.
Otherwise I will have Toltoy,
And Chinkogeo who is courting me.
Chulek, standing in front of you,
Is becoming older a sin?

"To the late father-in-law Manas,
I respect and love him solemnly all the time.
I admire my father-in-law Manas,
I always worship his spirit.

"After my father-in-law Manas passed away,
His fellow people came and buried him.
Aweikai and Kobosh could not wait,
They robbed of his treasure crazily.
Poor mother-in-law Kanikai was forced to run back to her parents',
She suffered the hardships and grievance.

"You wandered in strange place as a tramp,
Poor Chulek, I looked forward with eager expectation.
You went to your grandfather for a shelter,
You experienced hardships when you were too young
I, Chulek's heart was like burning in the oil!
Recalling father-in-law's spirit makes me turn older,
Is it Chulek's fault?

"Keep the marriage arranged by our fathers,

Becoming old in waiting for you,
Is it Chulek's fault?
Do not marry your woman,
Do not you prick by your conscience?

"I am getting old in the eager waiting,
But you do not come and find me.
When you married Chachykai,
Did you know how I endure the loneliness?

"Giant Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
Besieged the city and intended to marry forcibly,
I went out because of this.
I risked my life and transferred into a swan,
I flew everywhere to look for you!
I went to ask for your help,
Does it mean I appear in public regardless of face?
Does it mean I am shameless to look for a man?
It seems I took the pain in vain.

"My king, do not waste your breath,
Take your white eagle,
Ride your horse and leave now!
Before meeting and negotiating,
You are scared away by Toltoy and Chinkogeo,
Look at your fearful and worried manner!

"You are so crude and rash,
You treat your guard so bad,
You do not have the late king's broad mind!
Look at you, you are scared out of your wits,
You do not have the late king's heroic manner.

"I flew following the wind,
Along the bank of Sire river,
I tested you deliberately,
My lion, please tell me the truth,

Do you believe my bosom words?

"I followed the rainbow in the sky,
Flew slowly to this place,
Your awful behavior,
I have experienced in your Ayinla.

"Why do I marry such a person?
How good it is to marry?
If you continue to talk rubbish here,
The man will marry me is Chinkogeo,
I will go and marry him now.

"Toltoy from Jedigair,
He commands thousands of troops,
His subjects can cover the whole Jetsu river.
Toltoy is my nephew,
I do not have to expect you anymore!
If you want to leave here as soon as possible,
I will not stop you at all!

"As long as God gives me a chance,
I must revenge!
Here you are, this is your white eagle.
My lion, wish you a wide road in front of your life,
Chulek stands in front of you,
This is all that I want to tell you.

"What you said is true,
I flew in the sky and looked for the man I would marry,
Then I lured you to come here.

"I could not express my heart to you then,
I always worship my father-in-law's promise,
So I consider Chinkogeo and Toltoy,
As absolutely irreconcilable enemies.

"I heard it long ago,
Kara Khan's castle,
Was the place where you wandered,
Your mother Kanikai who was in mourning,
I have heard,
You wore split pants at the time,
Your mother carried you and hid and wandered everywhere.

"Do not let me catch you on the raw,
I have transferred into a swan and observed:
Bull neck, raised forehead,
Stubby neck, huge head,
An idiot with two legs,
That is the lady you married,
Ah, I have seen her.

"Hero Kokcher's son Wumaitoy,
Among Karamark and Khitan people,
None could compare with his braveness,
He is also a lion with long hair and black ears,
I did not agree to marry him.
The king, I always long for you,
I have already guessed,
You will say strange words of how old I am!

"Khan Kunwuerbayi,
Drove plenty of horses and herded them along the river,
Mares of empty embryo were on the other side.
He worships god Bushirhan,
He wears stately costume,
He burns incense and kowtows everyday solemnly.

"This warrior has an impressive appearance too,
His eyebrows are like two crouched hunting dogs,
His head is of the size of a field caldron.
He has a long and thick plait on his back,
It is more than one foot long.

"He holds golden brass tobacco pipe,
Kunwuerbayi is a famous Khan,
I never want to marry him too,
I always put my whole heart into you, my Kangkoer!

"Semtay, I have known for long,
You will dislike me because I get old!
I pierced through wind and rains in the sky,
I looked down the earth from above with tears.
If it is not because your father Manas,
Who knows and recognize you as a Khan?"

Poured out her own difficulties,
Ayichulek felt extremely sad,
Her tears ran like flood.
Semtay did not know what to do,
He lost his usual toughness,
He reined his horse helplessly.
Born-smart Krichorao,
He got a smart brain and sweet mouth,
He showed good and soothed both of them:

"Forget it, big brother, do not say angry words,
Do not take what sister-in-law said seriously,
A great man knows when to yield and when not.
For your fellow people back in your homeland,
For numerous Nuoyi people,
How do you face them if you go back?"

Krichorao advised Chulek:
"My respected sister-in-law, wait,
You are the most reliable beauty,
I am your family member and come to visit you.

"You treat your kinsfolk with cold words,
Why do you hurt your lover like this?

You and Semtay crossed verbal swords with each other,
It means you two are destined to be together.
Do not act like you have no virtue of patience,
Do not part with each other in a moment of anger.

"In the face of your respected Manas,
In the face of famous uncle Bakay Khan,
In the face of wise and amiable mother Kanikai,
In the face of numerous Nuoyi people,
In the face of girls around you,
How you can fail to live up to their painstaking work!
You just return back after the quarrel,
How you can be a smart person!"

Chulek felt pain in her heart,
Sad words flowed out her mouth:
"Damned Kangkoer!
You said I become old and cannot bear a baby,
He has full of jeering and complaints toward me.
I would rather suffer the disaster alone,
Than suffer from his neglect.
I would rather return to my white palace,
Than suffer such torment.
After people go to sleep,
I do not let anyone notice,
No one will notice it,
I will go back to my father's city,
Live there quietly and do not come out anymore!"

Look at her falcon-like black eyes,
Aggrieved tears ran down as she talked.

Krichorao continued to say,
With a smile on his face:
"Sister-in-law, let it go, do not complain anymore,
Among Kirgiz wear white felt hats,
There is not such an idiot like him,

The black mane wolf just slips his tongue."

"Once he could not control his anger,
His uncle Aweikai and Kobosh,
He killed them regardless of the family love.
You will understand as long as I remind you,
Sister-in-law Chulek, I know you are extremely smart.
Please forgive us,
I know you are broad-minded and you will let it go."

Semtay and Chulek were rendered speechless,
Krichorao's advices filled their hearts,
Facing the reasonable truth,
They nodded quietly.

Krichorao tried his best to persuade,
Finally they two were on good terms as before,
They were struck by the sincere advice.

Semtay Married the Beauty Ayichulek

Fourteen fine horses from Nuoyi,
Were driven into Akun Khan's city.
Girls' wishes were carried out,
They talked and laughed together with three young men.

From that luxurious white city gate,
The lion stepped into the palace he longed for.

In order to fete the heroes came from afar,
The host butchered fat lamb and cows.
In order to fete thirsty heroes,
The host took out fragrant horse milk wine.
The host poured strong liquor,
Took out white cubic sugar,
Took out honey in the leather bag,
Took out nang made of crème,
Carried strong tea out,
Cut lamb neck fat and horse intestines into pieces.

They have all delicious food they desired,
All kinds of food were there.

After the rich feast,
When they threw the blames away,
Finally they came to the comfortable place,
Started their heart-to-heart talk,
Expressed good wishes to each other.

Cast the past resentments away,

Their annoyance disappeared in a flash.
Unyielding Semtay and Chulek,
Felt as sweet as the honey.
They became amorous to each other,
Their love toward each other filled their hearts up.

Looked at charming Chulek,
Many thoughts thronged Semtay's mind,
The fire of love burned in his chest:

"My dear lover, I miss you all the time!
I finally got the chance to see you,
I always want to marry you,
I always love and miss you.
I do not know the reason,
Why my mother hide this thing from me."
In the face of Ayichulek,
Semtay begged for her forgiveness.

Heard the bosom words of Semtay,
Chulek had a ball of fire burn her heart.
She was an educated and reasonable woman,
Affection toward Semtay stirred up in her heart.
"In order to look for his lover,
He has endured hardships.
He goes through mountains and rivers,
Fourteen horses are hungry and exhausted.

"He suffered a lot for the sake of me,
Frayed his precious Brum coat armor.
He is the offspring of the hero,
I really made him suffer a lot.
He went a long hard journey day and night,
He could not rest for many nights,
He came to me without considering the hardships.

"The power of the spear depends on the flag,

Heroic man is the graceful bearing of a woman,
Man and woman in the world,
No one does not want a passionate love.
If I throw myself in his arms rashly,
I will be guilty and the world will sneer at me.
Do I need to send someone secretly,
To invite Molerdo?[1]"

Ayichulek was wraped in her thoughts,
Krichorao appreciated her thought well,
He said loudly with a smile:
"My respected big brother Semtay,
You come here from afar,
You carry Ackelty magic gun on your shoulder,
You are longing for Ayichulek.

"You carry the crescent battle axe on your waist,
You love Ayichulek in your heart,
But you feel shy to express your love,
The surging fire of love burns in your chest,
Maybe you have expected to spend the night,
You have longed for beautiful lover Ayichulek.

"There are no Molerdo and Hogeo on the way,
And none of Molerdos can defeat me.
I was born with a quick tongue and never hide anything from others,
It is my character to talk without thinking about the result.

"My respected brother and sister-in-law Chulek,
You two are of one mind now,
And love each other,
Krichorao and Kanchorao,
Now have annoying fire burning in the heart!"

1 To invite Molerdo: Kirgiz people always invite Molerdo as the chief witness when they get married.

Krichorao brought it up directly,
Kanchorao showed a witty smile,
Akun Khan's daughter Chulek,
Had already read their minds.

Krichorao played the part of Molerdo,
Kanchorao played the part of the best man.
Wise and virtuous people acted as their matchmakers,
Numerous girls and married ladies wanted to be their witnesses.
Semtay and Ayichulek,
Their pure wedding ceremony held lively.

They spent a sweet night,
Until the earth was transfused with sunlight.
Girls and married ladies outside the window,
Played and laughed till the morning.

The sun rose and it was sunny,
They got up.

Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Her pink face turned pale,
It was extremely like a guy cursed,
She clumped forward shaking,
Stepped off the bed with difficulty.
Akun Khan's daughter Ayichulek,
Wore a wide cloak,
And strolled out of the palace.

Young lion Semtay,
Got out of the bed with a handsome bearing,
Washed with water,
He was full of energy.

Krichorao and Kanchorao came early in the morning,
Ayichulek smiled to the lion like a blossoming flower.

"Since God created women,
They should marry men.
Since there are men in the world,
They should have their wives.

"A grown-up man ought to marry and vice versa,
This is the rule our ancestors passed down.
Waste your springtime,
It is sad for both man and woman."

Ayichulek thought for a while,
Then she said with a smile:
"Krichorao and Kanchorao,
They are like the king's two eyes,
They are Alman① and Chuwak,
These two heroic Khans' sons.

"Although they are young,
They assist their king loyally.
Because they are adept with both the pen and the sword,
You always take them with you.

"Although they are very young,
They are bold and able to fight,
They are like your, Semtay's two wings,
Let them marry and settle down,
Let them fulfill their goals."

Ayichulek took this into consideration,
Turned round and said to two girls:
"I will pay if you two die,
I collect money if I sell you two.
You have grown up,
For your marriage,
I will arrange for you by no means.

① Alman: It is the nickname of Almanbet.

"Kamanli and Begmjan,
You two marry these two young men.
Krichorao and Kanchorao,
Which one of you is older?
Which one of you is younger?
I do not know.

"Khan's daughter Kamanli,
Krichorao will be your husband.
Bek's daughter Begmjan,
Kanchorao is the best choice for you!"

Two girls had no complaints,
Actually they were as happy as larks.
All other girls who were not called,
They all frowned with a cold heart.

Like Chulek and the handsome king,
Who could have such a glory?
Krichorao and Kanchorao,
Were the strong backbone,
Of king Semtay.

"My respectful and lovely warriors,
My trustful fellows,
Elites from Kirgiz,
You have a heavy responsibility on your shoulders.

"Young fellows, listen carefully!
You should stand sentry day and night,
Be cautious of invading enemies all the time,
Protect all roads and paths of the palace.

"Your sister-in-law will boss it,
You hold engagement ceremony ceremony with the girls today.
When the day we wipe out the enemies that invaded comes,

I will hold a grand wedding for you.

"We will not trouble the fellows here,
We must keep an order of priority of everything.
You marry beautiful girls on your journey,
Young leopard, think about it,
What else do you feel unsatisfactory?
What else is happier than this?"
Semtay told them like this,
Girls all applauded,
Young lads felt satisfactory.

Let us put this aside,
Start from the story,
Of Krichorao and Toltoy's contest.